# The Sūtra of the Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha's Kindness Is Repaid

Toh 353 · Derge Kangyur

ཐབས་མཁས་པ་ཆེན་པ་སངས་རྒྱས་དབྱེ་ལན་བསབ་པའ་མདོ

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness, in Tibetan Tabkhepa Chenpo Sangyé Drinlen Sabpé Do, is a Mahāyāna discourse that was translated into Tibetan from Chinese rather than Sanskrit, and so it carries a Chinese title in place of the usual Sanskrit one. Set on Vulture Peak near Rājagṛha before a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, it unfolds over nine chapters on how the Buddha, through great skillful means, repaid the kindness he had received, with themes that include compassion, the arising of the mind set on awakening, and the duty to honor and repay one's parents and teachers. It ends with bodhisattvas pledging to uphold the teaching and asking that the sūtra be entrusted to them, and with the Buddha naming it, among other titles, The Compendium of All Grounds of Virtue. It is Toh 353 in the Kangyur, where it is placed among the general sūtras.

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In the language of China: dei phāṅ bya na phhur pou in kyeng sū phim dei yir. In the language of Tibet: The Sūtra of the Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha's Kindness Is Repaid.

The first section.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great saṅgha of monks, twenty-eight thousand monks, all of whom had done what was to be done, had practiced the holy life, had entirely exhausted the fetters binding them to existence, and had attained mastery over their minds like great nāgas. They were Mahākāśyapa, Subhūti, Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, Fair Goodness, Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra, Mahāpanthaka, Śāriputra, Mahākātyāyana, Ānanda, Rāhula, and other such thoroughbreds.

He was also together with thirty-eight thousand bodhisattva great beings. All these bodhisattvas, having long generated roots of virtue, had always practiced the holy life under countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of buddhas. They had fully perfected great aspirations, had penetrated and realized hundreds of thousands of samādhis, had perfected the dhāraṇīs, never forsook great compassion, strove to benefit all great beings just as they

are, sustained the lineage of the Three Jewels so that it would not be broken, raised high the banner of the Dharma, had become unbidden spiritual friends to ordinary people, and, having reached the shore of great wisdom, were utterly beyond counting. They were the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta, the bodhisattva Nityodyukta, the bodhisattva Sublime Qualities, the bodhisattva Melody of Qualities, the bodhisattva Lightning Light, the bodhisattva Universal Sameness, the bodhisattva Foremost Qualities, the bodhisattva King Meru, the bodhisattva Gandhahastin, the bodhisattva Mahāgandhahastin, the bodhisattva Holder of Strength, the bodhisattva Exalted in the Three Realms, the bodhisattva Ever Compassionate, the bodhisattva Ratnapāṇi, the bodhisattva Mighty Light, the bodhisattva Sublime Glory, the bodhisattva Ratnacandra, the bodhisattva Great Strength, the bodhisattva Boundless Intelligence, the bodhisattva Bhadrapāla, the bodhisattva Lion's Roar, the bodhisattva Lion's Deed, the bodhisattva Siṃhavijṛmbhita, the bodhisattva Fulfilled Aspiration, the bodhisattva Ratnakūṭa, the bodhisattva Maitreya, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī the Youthful, and others. He dwelt together with this great retinue as well.

Besides these, countless hundreds of thousands of gods of the desire realm also came, bearing divine flowers and incense, and, playing divine music, they took their places in the sky above. Besides these, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, nonhumans, and others came, each with a retinue of hundreds of thousands; they bowed their heads at the Buddha's feet and sat down to one side. At that time the Blessed One was surrounded by a great retinue, who served and worshiped him and, with reverence, praised him.

At that time, through the blessing of the Blessed One, Ānanda entered Rājagṛha in the morning and went for alms from house to house. At that time there was a brahmin, greatly devoted in his filial service to his parents, whose household had fallen to ruin so that he owned nothing at all. Carrying his aged mother on his back, he went begging from house to house. If he obtained food that was delicious and flavorful, or good fruit, he fed it to his parents. If he obtained poor, tasteless food, or dried fruit, he ate it himself. When Ānanda saw this, a mind of great joy arose in him, and he praised the man in pleasing words, saying, "Excellent! Excellent! Son of good family, it is most wonderful that you serve your parents with filial devotion and honor them. Well done!"

Then there was a man who inclined toward the teachings of the six teachers of the wandering ascetics and had become their ally. He was of sharp faculties,

learned in the treatises and in the four Vedas, skilled in the stars and in calculation, sharp in reading omens of good and ill, able to know the minds of others through the sciences of divination and the treatises, a teacher of many, and honored by all. Attached to wrong views, he was destroying the sacred Dharma for the sake of gain and fame. Envious of the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and in order to disparage them, he spoke to Ānanda as follows:

"Your teacher, Gautama, son of the Śākya clan, says, 'I am virtuous and possess great qualities,' but that is merely a name, with no true substance. Your teacher Gautama is in truth an evil man. Seven days after he was born his mother died, and that shows that he is evil. While living in the royal palace, he fled from within it, so that his father the king was overwhelmed by grief. His mind disturbed, the king fainted and was sprinkled with water; when seven days had passed he regained his senses and, beating his breast, wept piteously, crying, 'Today I have lost my one divine son!' He was driven to lament, 'My land and my rule are for you alone to command, and you are my only son, so why have you abandoned us and gone off to the mountain hermitage?' Your teacher Gautama is ungrateful: heedless of everything, he rose up and left, and that shows that he lacks filial piety. His father the king built him a palace and took a wife for him, yet he did not do a husband's duty toward his wife but tormented her with grief, and that shows that he is shameless as well."

When Ānanda had heard those words that the man spoke, he was ashamed and embarrassed. Having collected his alms, he returned to where the Buddha was, bowed his head at his feet, and, standing to one side with palms joined, bowing low, he addressed the Blessed One as follows:

"Blessed One, in the Dharma taught by the Buddha, is there no such thing as filial service to one's parents?"

The Buddha said to Ānanda, "Who taught you to ask this question? Was it taught to you by a god, a human, or a nonhuman? Or did you come to ask the Tathāgata this from your own understanding?"

Ānanda replied, "No one taught me, neither god, nāga, preta, human, nor nonhuman. But this morning, when I went for alms, I met a naked wandering ascetic of the following of the six teachers, and he spoke harsh words to me." And he told it in full.

At that time the Blessed One smiled, and from his mouth there came forth light of many different colors, which illuminated, in the eastern direction, beyond countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of buddha fields, a world system called Highest Supreme. In that world system dwelt the Buddha called King of Joy, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, the Buddha, the Blessed One, in the buddha field called Perfectly Arrayed.

That buddha field was perfectly level. Its ground was made of beryl and marked out in a checkered pattern with lines of refined gold. Trees of the seven precious substances grew there, and those trees were as tall as the range of an arrow's flight and beautifully adorned with flowers, fruits, branches and leaves. When they were stirred by a gentle breeze, a sweet sound arose, and ordinary beings who heard those sounds could never have enough of them. Here and there were springs, ponds and bathing pools, filled to the brim with water endowed with the eight qualities. The floors of the pools were strewn with golden sand. On the four sides of the pools, lotuses, puṇḍarika and pāruṣaka flowers with a sublime fragrance, and other flowers, blue, yellow, red and white, each as large as a chariot wheel, covered the surface of the water entirely. In that water birds of many kinds also sang sweet and most delightful songs. In the pools there were boats made of the seven precious substances, in which many beings played and enjoyed themselves as they pleased.

Between those jewel trees, lion thrones one league high and wide were set up and adorned with the seven precious substances. On a throne layered with divine cloth, wafting the scent of divine incense and strewn with divine flowers, the Tathāgata King of Joy was seated in the cross-legged posture. Countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of bodhisattvas arrayed themselves before him, and joining their palms and bowing, each of them addressed that Tathāgata with the same words:

"Blessed One, through what cause and what condition has this excellent light, blue, yellow, red and white, brilliantly clear and beyond compare, shone from the western direction upon this great assembly, so that all whom the light touches become happy in body and mind? Out of your loving concern, may the Blessed One please explain it."

That Blessed One then spoke as follows: "Sons of good family, listen well and keep it firmly in mind, and I shall explain and set it out for you. Beyond

countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of world systems from here in the western direction, there is a buddha field called Sahā. There the Buddha called Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, the Buddha, the Blessed One, surrounded by a great retinue, is teaching the whole great assembly the sūtra on repaying kindness through great skillful means. This light has shone for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings; in order to pull out by the root the thorn of wrong views of all sentient beings; in order to make the beginner bodhisattvas irreversible and steadfast on the path to awakening; in order to establish all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas on the path of the one vehicle that leads to the ultimate; in order that the great bodhisattvas swiftly attain full awakening and repay the kindness of the Buddha, and so that all sentient beings remember great kindness; in order to deliver all sentient beings from the ocean of suffering; and because he wishes all ordinary people to serve their parents with filial devotion."

At that time, in that assembly, some ten thousand bodhisattvas, who had become leaders and teachers of great assemblies, rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, placed their right knees on the ground, and addressed that Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, please bless us so that, through the blessing of the Blessed One, we may go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to and honor the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, and listen to the sublime Sūtra of the Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha's Kindness Is Repaid."

Then that Buddha said to those bodhisattvas: "Sons of good family, go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to and honor that Buddha, the Blessed One, and give rise to the perception that he is extremely hard to meet. Why is that? The Buddha Śākyamuni, for countless koṭis of niyutas of eons, practiced what is extremely difficult to practice, and out of great compassion made this aspiration:

'When I attain full awakening, may I attain perfect and complete buddhahood in a world system full of wrongdoing, in a place where there are mountains, ravines, gravel, pebbles, thorns and the like, where the beings too are full of afflictions and fully engage in the five acts of immediate retribution and the ten nonvirtues. There, for their benefit and happiness, may I cut off all suffering entirely, make them fully endowed with every happiness, perfect the Dharma body, and pass into nirvāṇa without remainder.' Such was the

aspiration he made. Because that Buddha, the Blessed One, first made that aspiration, you should go to that world system and conduct yourselves just as the Buddha himself goes and just as the Buddha himself abides."

When he had spoken, all those bodhisattvas replied with one voice, "We shall do as the Blessed One commands." Then each of those bodhisattvas, surrounded by a retinue of some hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, set out for where the Sahā world system was. In whatever world systems they went to, those world systems quaked in six ways, and a great light shone everywhere. From the sky above, the gods rained down mandārava flowers and great mandārava flowers. Illuminated by the great light, world systems as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River also quaked through miraculous power. Besides this, countless hundreds of thousands of divine instruments, unplayed, sounded of their own accord in the sky above. Those bodhisattvas arrived at Vulture Peak Mountain, in the presence of the Tathāgata; they bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated the Buddha three times, and sat down to one side.

At that time the light of the Tathāgata illuminated, in the southern direction, beyond eighty koṭis of niyutas of buddha fields, a world system called Light of Qualities. In that world system dwelt the Buddha called Attending to Signs, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, unsurpassed, teacher, victor, the Buddha, the Blessed One, in the buddha field called Utterly Pure.

That buddha field was perfectly level. Its ground was made of beryl and marked out in a checkered pattern with lines of refined gold. Trees of the seven precious substances grew there, and those trees were as tall as the range of an arrow's flight and adorned with flowers, fruits, branches and leaves. When they were stirred by a gentle breeze, a sweet sound arose, and ordinary beings who heard those sounds could never have enough of them. Here and there were springs, ponds and bathing pools, filled to the brim with water endowed with the eight qualities, and the floors of the pools were strewn with golden sand. On the four sides of the pools, lotuses, puṇḍarīka and pāruṣaka flowers with a sublime fragrance, and other flowers, blue, yellow, red and white, each as large as a chariot wheel, covered the surface of the water entirely. In that water birds of many kinds also sang sweet and most delightful songs. In the pools there were boats made of the seven precious substances, in which many beings played and enjoyed themselves as they pleased.

Between those jewel trees, lion thrones one league high and wide were set up and adorned with the seven precious substances. On a throne layered with divine cloth, wafting the scent of divine incense and strewn with divine flowers, the Tathāgata Attending to Signs was seated in the cross-legged posture. Countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of bodhisattvas arrayed themselves before him, and joining their palms and bowing, each of them addressed that Tathāgata with the same words:

"Blessed One, through what cause and what condition has this light of excellent color, blue, yellow, red and white, brilliantly clear and beyond compare, shone from the northern direction upon this great assembly, so that all whom the light touches have become happy in body and mind? Out of your loving concern, may the Blessed One please explain it."

Then that Blessed One spoke as follows: "Sons of good family, listen very well and keep it in mind, and I shall explain and set it out for you. Beyond eighty koṭis of niyutas of world systems from here in the northern direction, there is a buddha field called Sahā. There the Buddha called Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, the Buddha, the Blessed One, surrounded by a great retinue, is teaching the whole great assembly the sūtra on repaying kindness through great skillful means. This light has shone for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings; in order to pull out by the root the thorn of wrong views of all sentient beings; in order to make the beginner bodhisattvas irreversible and steadfast on the path to awakening; in order to establish all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas on the path of the one vehicle that leads to the ultimate; in order that the great bodhisattvas swiftly attain full awakening and repay the kindness of the Buddha, and so that all sentient beings remember great kindness; in order to deliver all sentient beings from the ocean of suffering; and because he wishes ordinary people to serve their parents with filial devotion."

At that time, in that assembly, some ten thousand bodhisattvas, who had become leaders and teachers of great assemblies, rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, placed their right knees on the ground, and addressed that Blessed One as follows:

"Through the blessing of the Blessed One, please bless us so that we may go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to and honor the Tathāgata

Śākyamuni, and listen to the sacred sūtra The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness."

Then that Buddha spoke to the bodhisattvas as follows: "Sons of noble family, go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to that Buddha, the Blessed One, and honor him, and give rise to the perception that he is extremely difficult to meet. Why is that? For countless eons, for koṭis of niyutas of eons, the Buddha Śākyamuni practiced what is extremely difficult to practice, and with great compassion he made this aspiration: 'When I attain full awakening, may I attain full awakening in a world system full of evil, a place with mountains, ravines, gullies, gravel, thorns, and the like, a place where sentient beings are full of afflictions and fully engage in the five acts of immediate retribution and the ten nonvirtues. For the sake of their benefit and happiness, may I cut off all their suffering and endow them with all happiness, perfect the Dharma body, and pass into nirvāṇa without remainder.' Thus he made his aspiration. Since that Buddha, the Blessed One, made such an aspiration at the very beginning, when you go to that world system, you should act just as you would if the Buddha himself had come and as if the Buddha himself were present."

When he had said this, all those bodhisattvas said with one voice, "We shall do as the Blessed One commands." Then each of those bodhisattvas, surrounded by a retinue of hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, went to where the Sahā world system was. In whatever world systems they passed through, those world systems shook in six ways and were completely illuminated by great light. From the sky above, the gods rained down mandārava flowers and great mandārava flowers. Illuminated by great light, world systems as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Ganges also shook through miraculous power. In addition to that, hundreds of thousands of countless divine instruments resounded of their own accord in the sky above without being played. Those bodhisattvas arrived in the presence of the Tathāgata on Vulture Peak Mountain, bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated the Buddha three times, and sat down to one side.

At that time, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, with light rays of five colors, illuminated a world system called Pure Abode, which lies to the west beyond hundreds of thousands of countless koṭis of niyutas of buddha fields. In that world system, a buddha named Sun, Moon, and Lamp Light, a tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, buddha, blessed one, dwells in a buddha field called

Sukhāvatī.

That buddha field is perfectly level. Its ground is made of beryl, laid out in a checkered pattern with lines of refined gold, and trees of the seven precious substances grow there. Those trees are about an arrow's flight in height, beautifully adorned with flowers, fruits, branches, and leaves. Stirred by a gentle breeze, they give forth a pleasing sound, and the individual beings who hear those sounds never tire of them. Here and there are springs, ponds, and bathing pools, filled to the brim with water possessing the eight good qualities. The beds of the pools are covered with golden sand. On the four sides of the pools, lotus flowers, white lotuses (puṇḍarīka), pāruṣaka flowers, and other flowers of blue, yellow, red, and white, endowed with sublime fragrance and each the size of a chariot wheel, completely cover the surface of the water. Within that water, too, many kinds of birds give forth exceedingly delightful, melodious sounds. In those pools are boats made of the seven precious substances, in which many sentient beings play and enjoy themselves as they please.

Between those jewel trees are set up lion thrones, each a full league in height, adorned with the seven precious substances. Divine cloths are spread in layers upon the thrones, the scent of divine incense wafts about them, and divine flowers are strewn over them. On such a throne the Tathāgata Sun, Moon, and Lamp Light sits with legs crossed, and before him are arrayed hundreds of thousands of countless koṭis of bodhisattvas. Joining their palms and bowing, each of them addressed that Tathāgata with one voice as follows:

"Blessed One, for what cause and for what condition has this excellent light, blue, yellow, red, and white, brilliantly clear and beyond compare, appeared from the east to these great assemblies, so that all whom the light has touched have become happy in body and mind? Out of your loving kindness, Blessed One, please explain it."

Then that Blessed One spoke as follows: "Son of noble family, listen well and keep it thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain it to you in detail."

"To the east of here, beyond hundreds of thousands of countless koṭis of niyutas of world systems, there is a buddha field called Sahā. There a buddha called Śākyamuni, a tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, buddha, blessed one, surrounded by a great assembly, is teaching the sūtra The Great Skillful

Means of Repaying Kindness to all of that great assembly. This light has appeared for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings; in order to pull out by the root the thorn of wrong views of all sentient beings; in order that bodhisattvas who have newly given rise to the mind of awakening not turn back from the path of awakening but become steadfast; in order to establish all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas on the path of the one vehicle that leads to the ultimate; in order that the great bodhisattvas swiftly attain full awakening and repay the kindness of the Buddha; so that all sentient beings remember great kindness; in order to deliver all sentient beings from the ocean of suffering; and because he wishes ordinary people to serve their parents with filial devotion."

At that time, in that assembly, some ten thousand bodhisattvas, who had become leaders and teachers of great assemblies, rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, placed their right knees on the ground, and addressed that Blessed One as follows: "Through the blessing of the Blessed One, please bless us so that we may go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to and honor the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, and listen to the sacred sūtra The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness."

Then that Buddha spoke to those bodhisattvas as follows: "Sons of noble family, go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to that Buddha, the Blessed One, and honor him, and give rise to the perception that he is extremely difficult to meet. Why is that? For countless eons, for koṭis of niyutas of eons, the Buddha Śākyamuni practiced what is extremely difficult to practice, and with great compassion he made this aspiration: 'When I attain full awakening, may I attain full awakening in a world system full of evil, a place with mountains, ravines, gullies, gravel, thorns, and the like, a place where sentient beings are full of afflictions and fully engage in the five acts of immediate retribution and the ten nonvirtues. For the sake of their benefit and happiness, may I cut off all their suffering and endow them with all happiness, perfect the Dharma body, and pass into nirvāṇa without remainder.' Thus he made his aspiration. Since that Buddha, the Blessed One, made such an aspiration at the very beginning, when you go to that world system, you should conduct yourselves just as you would if the Buddha himself had come and as if the Buddha himself were present."

When he had said this, all those bodhisattvas said with one voice, "We shall do as the Blessed One commands." Then each of those bodhisattvas, surrounded by a retinue of hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, went

to where the Sahā world system was. In whatever world systems they passed through, those world systems shook in six ways, and great light completely illuminated them. From the sky above, the gods rained down mandārava flowers and great mandārava flowers. Illuminated by great light, world systems as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Ganges also shook through miraculous power. In addition to that, hundreds of thousands of countless divine instruments resounded of their own accord in the sky above without being played. Those bodhisattvas, too, arrived in the presence of the Tathāgata on Vulture Peak Mountain, bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated the Buddha three times, and sat down to one side.

At that time, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, with light rays of five colors, illuminated a world system called King of Mighty Renown, which lies to the north beyond five hundred koṭis of niyutas of buddha fields. In that world system, a buddha called Crimson Lotus Light, a tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, buddha, blessed one, dwells in a buddha field called Stainless.

That buddha field is perfectly level. Its ground is made of beryl, laid out in a checkered pattern with lines of refined gold, and trees of the seven precious substances grow there. Those trees are about an arrow's flight in height, beautifully adorned with flowers, fruits, branches, and leaves. Stirred by a gentle breeze, they give forth a pleasing sound, and when individual beings hear that sound, they never tire of it. Here and there are springs, ponds, and bathing pools, filled to the brim with water possessing the eight good qualities. The beds of the pools are covered with golden sand. On the four sides of the pools, lotus flowers, white lotuses (puṇḍarīka), pāruṣaka flowers, and other flowers of blue, yellow, red, and white, endowed with sublime fragrance and each the size of a chariot wheel, completely cover the surface of the water. Within that water, many kinds of birds give forth exceedingly delightful, melodious sounds. In those pools are boats made of the seven precious substances, in which many sentient beings play and enjoy themselves as they please.

Between those jewel trees are set up lion thrones, each a full league in height, adorned with the seven precious substances. Divine cloths are spread in layers upon the thrones, the scent of divine incense wafts about them, and divine flowers are strewn over them. Upon such a throne the Tathāgata Crimson Lotus Light sits with legs crossed, and before him are arrayed hundreds of

thousands of countless koṭis of bodhisattvas. Joining their palms and bowing, each of them addressed that Tathāgata with one voice as follows:

"Blessed One, for what cause and for what condition has this excellent light, blue, yellow, red, and white, brilliantly clear and beyond compare, appeared from the south to these great assemblies, so that all whom the light touches become happy in body and mind? Out of your loving kindness, Blessed One, please explain it."

Then the Blessed One spoke as follows: "Sons of noble family, listen well and keep it thoroughly in mind, and I shall explain it to you in detail. To the south of here, beyond hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of world systems, there is a buddha field called Sahā. There a buddha called Śākyamuni, a tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, buddha, blessed one, surrounded by a great assembly, is teaching the sūtra The Great Skillful Means of Repaying Kindness to all of that great assembly. This light has appeared for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings; in order to pull out by the root the thorns of all sentient beings; in order that bodhisattvas who have newly given rise to the mind of awakening not turn back from awakening but become steadfast; in order to establish all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas in the one vehicle that leads to the ultimate; in order that the great bodhisattvas swiftly attain full awakening and repay the kindness of the Buddha; so that all sentient beings remember great kindness; in order to deliver all sentient beings from the ocean of suffering; and because he wishes ordinary people to serve their parents with filial devotion."

At that time, in that assembly, some ten thousand bodhisattvas, who had become leaders and teachers among the great assemblies, rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, placed their right knees on the ground, and addressed that Blessed One as follows: "Through the blessing of the Blessed One, please bless us so that we may go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to and honor the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, and listen to the sacred sūtra The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness."

Then that Buddha spoke to those bodhisattvas as follows: "Sons of noble family, go to that Sahā world system, make offerings to that Buddha, the Blessed One, and honor him, and give rise to the perception that he is

extremely difficult to meet. Why is that? For countless eons, for koṭis of niyutas of eons, the Buddha Śākyamuni practiced what is extremely difficult to practice, and so with great compassion he made this aspiration: 'When I attain full awakening, may I attain full awakening in a world system full of evil, a place with mountains, ravines, gullies, gravel, thorns, and the like, a place where sentient beings are full of afflictions and fully engage in the five acts of immediate retribution and the ten nonvirtues. For the sake of their benefit and happiness, may I cut off all their suffering and endow them with all happiness, perfect the Dharma body, and pass into nirvāṇa without remainder.' Thus he made his aspiration. Since that Buddha, the Blessed One, made such an aspiration at the very beginning, when you go to that world system, you should regard it just as you would if the Buddha himself had come and as if the Buddha himself were present."

When he had said this, all those bodhisattvas said with one voice, "We shall do as the Blessed One commands." Then each of those bodhisattvas, surrounded by a retinue of hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, went to where the Sahā world system was. In whatever world systems they passed through, those world systems shook in six ways, and great light completely illuminated them. From the sky above, the gods rained down mandārava flowers and great mandārava flowers. Illuminated by great light, world systems as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Ganges also shook through miraculous power. In addition to that, hundreds of thousands of countless divine instruments resounded of their own accord in the sky above without being played. Those bodhisattvas arrived in the presence of the Tathāgata on Vulture Peak Mountain, bowed their heads at his feet, circumambulated the Buddha three times, and sat down to one side.

In the same way, all the great bodhisattvas who came from the four intermediate directions, from above and below, from the ten directions, each together with countless hundreds of thousands in their retinues, came to where the Blessed One was, made offerings and showed honor, and offered praise. Then all of them with a single voice extolled the Blessed One in some hundred thousand verses. Having thus praised the Buddha, they too sat down to one side.

At that time the Sahā world system also became completely pure. There were no rugged mountains, no great or small mountains, no rivers, streams, ponds, pools, lakes, ravines, or chasms. The sentient beings living there, illuminated by the light, came to where the Buddha was. With joyful and delighted minds

they joined their palms, bowed, and touched their heads to the ground, and they sat gazing at him without blinking, with hearts full of devotion.

Then the Blessed One drew the light rays back in. Those light rays circled his body seven times and then vanished into the crown of his head. Ānanda saw this happen, and he understood in his mind that doubt had arisen in all of the great assembly. In order that the Tathāgata's deeds of skillful means be revealed, that the eye of wisdom arise in people of the future, that all ordinary people cross the river of craving, reach the far shore, and be established in happiness, and that ordinary people remember and recognize the great kindness of their parents, teachers, and gurus, he rose from his seat, arranged his robes properly, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his palms, bowed, and addressed the Blessed One as follows:

"Venerable Blessed One, I, Ānanda, attending upon the Buddha, have seen you smile. If there is surely some intention behind this, then in order to cut through the net of doubt of the great assembly, may the Blessed One please teach it. May the Buddha please explain it."

This concludes the first chapter, called "The Introduction," of The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

At that time, in that great assembly gathered there, a lotus made of the seven precious substances arose from the very ground. Its stem was made of silver, its petals of gold, and its base of precious crystal, and it was adorned all over with nets of pearls. Then the Blessed One Śākyamuni rose from where he was seated and sat on that lotus with his legs crossed. As soon as he had sat down on it, he manifested a completely pure body.

From that body he displayed multitudes of bodies of the five destinies of rebirth. In each multitude of bodies, too, he displayed different forms of some ten thousand hundreds of thousands of kinds. In each of those kinds of forms, too, he displayed some hundred thousand multitudes of bodies. In each of those multitudes of bodies, too, he displayed multitudes of bodies as numerous as the grains of sand of four Ganges rivers. In each of those multitudes of bodies as numerous as the grains of sand of four Ganges rivers, too, he displayed multitudes of bodies as numerous as the atoms of the four continents. In each of those multitudes of bodies as numerous as atoms, too, he displayed multitudes of bodies as numerous as the atoms of a great trichiliocosm, a world system of a billion worlds. In each of those multitudes of

bodies as numerous as atoms, too, he displayed, in each of the ten directions, multitudes of bodies as numerous as the atoms of hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of buddha fields. Thus he manifested multitudes of bodies of sentient beings, filling the whole expanse of space, equal to the realm of phenomena, inconceivable in number.

At that time, having manifested so many multitudes of bodies, the Tathāgata spoke as follows to Ānanda, to the great bodhisattvas gathered and assembled from the ten directions, and to the great assemblies:

"Sons of noble family, today the Tathāgata will speak, through the wisdom of omniscience, words that are true. Although the Dharma cannot be expressed in words, the Tathāgata, by the power of skillful means, will teach with names and signs the Dharma that has neither signs nor names.

"It is like this. When the Tathāgata first took birth and circled in saṃsāra, he fully experienced all those different kinds of multitudes of bodies, inconceivable, as numerous as atoms. Since he has thus experienced all those multitudes of bodies, there is no sentient being that has not been the Tathāgata's father or mother, and there is no sentient being whose father or mother the Tathāgata has not been. For the sake of all who have been his parents, he constantly practiced what is extremely difficult to practice. Of what is extremely difficult to give, there was nothing he did not give: his head, the supreme limb, his eyes, his brain, lands, cities, wives, sons, daughters, elephants, horses, chariots of the seven precious substances, vehicles, clothing, food, drink, bedding, medicines for illness, and all the necessities he was asked for. With intensely strenuous diligence he guarded moral discipline, practiced generosity, gained great learning, cultivated meditative concentration, and practiced wisdom; he carried out every difficult practice. He strove in diligence without weariness or fatigue and without interruption, in order to serve his parents with filial devotion, to recognize their kindness, and to repay it; to establish all sentient beings swiftly in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening; to bring the Tathāgata's former aspirations to complete fulfillment; to make it known that, this being so, all sentient beings have received the great kindness of the Buddha; so that the great compassion of the Tathāgata never abandons sentient beings; so that, constantly and with great skillful means, he might cultivate even and impartial loving-kindness, for inconceivable eons, toward all sentient beings dwelling in the twenty-five states of existence of the three realms, and act with skillful means endowed with equanimity; so that, realizing all sentient beings to be empty, the Dharma

to be empty, and the five aggregates to be empty, without retreating, without sinking, and without agitation, he might meditate with skillful means on emptiness, the true characteristic; and so that, skilled in the means of training to master the three vehicles without abandoning any of them, he might be skilled in practicing the sublime and most profound domain of activity.

"He realized the characteristics of phenomena with perfect clarity, and he realized and understood that the teachings of the Buddha, from beginning to end, are not of only one kind. Yet ordinary people, intoxicated and corrupted, are tormented by the three torments and sink into the ocean of suffering. Obscured by the four inversions, they become inverted with regard to contaminated phenomena. Wholly conceiving what is untrue, they view what is without self as a self, what is impermanent as permanent, what is unsatisfactory as pleasant, and what is impure as pure. Afflicted by birth, aging, sickness, and death, and by momentary impermanence, they are entangled by the five obscurations and the ten entanglements. They circle in the three states of existence and experience birth and death without beginning or end."

"Therefore the Tathāgata, according to what suits each and every being, has taught the three baskets, distinguishing them into the nine divisions of the scriptures and up to the twelve divisions of the scriptures. In accordance with the wishes of each, he has spoken many sūtras. Some who are attached to the words hold, 'This alone is enough for me; I have attained nirvāṇa.'

"Moreover, through the force of the Tathāgata's former aspiration of great compassion, all those of concordant karma in the world systems of the ten directions have been gathered together. Intending to teach the sacred Dharma, the sūtra, in that maṇḍala of the great assembly where all those of concordant karma have thus gathered, he ensures that the semblance of the Dharma will never be cut off and that all ordinary people will attain great happiness.

"Therefore the Tathāgata knows how to tame and teach without missing the right time, and he passes into nirvāṇa without missing the right time. In some world systems, the Tathāgata is renowned as the one called Vairocana, the arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, buddha, blessed one. At some times he goes to the abode of Tuṣita and becomes the teacher of the gods. At other times he

descends from the abode of Tuṣita and shows himself living in Jambudvīpa for a lifespan of eighty years.

"Therefore the Tathāgata is inconceivable. The world systems, too, are inconceivable. The maturation of karma, too, is inconceivable. The intentions of sentient beings, too, are inconceivable. The samādhis of meditative concentration, too, are inconceivable. The power of the nāgas, too, is inconceivable. This is the inconceivability of the Buddha: if all sentient beings wish to know what the Buddha has in mind, he lets everyone, down to the lowest beings of weak faculties, know it completely. Whoever among all sentient beings wishes to see the Buddha, he lets them see him at once. If he does not let them see him, then even though he is right before their eyes, they do not see him. Therefore, even though śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas have the higher knowledge of the divine eye, they are unable to see him. Beyond that, even though the Buddha radiates great light and illuminates everything from the Peak of Existence down to the hell of the beings who committed the acts of immediate retribution, those who have the good fortune to be tamed will see it, while those without such fortune will not see it even though it is right before their eyes. At some times the Tathāgata deliberately urges beings on; at other times he says nothing at all. Therefore the Buddha, the Blessed One, is inconceivable, extremely difficult to fathom, extremely difficult to know and realize. How, then, did you find the courage to ask the Tathāgata about something so profound and so difficult to practice? This question you have asked is truly an act of love and compassion toward all sentient beings: it blocks the path to the three lower realms and opens the path to gods and humans. Ānanda, I shall now teach you briefly about the difficult practice of serving one's parents with filial devotion. Listen well and keep it in mind."

Then the Blessed One spoke as follows to Ānanda, to those great bodhisattvas, and to the great assemblies:

"Long ago, countless, boundless, measureless eons in the past, in the land of Vārāṇasī there appeared in the world a buddha called Vipaśyin, a tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor, lord of the world, teacher of gods and humans. The lifespan of that buddha lasted twenty intermediate eons. The sacred Dharma also remained for twenty intermediate eons. The semblance of the Dharma also remained for twenty intermediate eons.

"During the time when the semblance of the Dharma was being practiced, there appeared in the world a king of men called Rāja, who ruled the land of Vārāṇasī. That king had twenty thousand queens, some four thousand ministers, and five hundred elephants. He ruled over sixty minor kingdoms and had some eight hundred cities. That king had three sons, and each of the three ruled a minor kingdom.

"At that time, the king of Vārāṇasī was learned and endowed with wisdom. Since he always governed the land with just Dharma, no one could be said to go without. Through the power of the king's merit and good qualities, the rains never failed to come in their season, the harvests were always good, and so the people who lived there were happy and content.

"At that time the king of Vārāṇasī had an evil minister called Rāhu. The minister Rāhu rebelled against the king and drew up the four divisions of an army: a division of elephants, a division of chariots, a division of cavalry, and a division of foot soldiers. Having drawn them up, he attacked the king of Vārāṇasī and took the king's life. Having thus killed the king, he deployed the four divisions of the army and killed the eldest prince as well, who ruled a minor kingdom on the border. Then he overthrew the middle prince too, and drew up his army to march upon the minor kingdom on the border ruled by the youngest prince.

"That youngest prince was wonderfully handsome in form and features, nobly beautiful, virtuous by nature, and gentle. He smiled as he spoke, and whatever he said, he said for the sake of benefit, never causing harm. He always governed his land with just Dharma and did not live by wrong means, and so the people of his land were happy, content, and prosperous, rich in possessions, wealth, and precious things, their storehouses full. All praised and extolled the good qualities of that king, and all the gods of the sky and the gods of the world rejoiced in him and honored him.

"At that time that king had a single son, a prince called Sujāti. He was very gentle and bright, possessed a mind of loving-kindness, and delighted in giving. His body was golden in color, his seven places were full and even, and he possessed in full the marks of a great being. He was seven years old, and his father the king loved him dearly and held him most precious.

"At that time a god who guarded the palace spoke to that king as follows:

"Does the king know? The minister Rāhu has rebelled and seized the kingdom, and he has killed the king your father. He has also sent out his fourfold army,

and he has deprived your two elder brothers, the kings, of their life force. His troops will arrive here before long, so why does the king not save his life and go away?"

When the king heard these words, all the hairs on his body stood on end. His body trembled, he was dejected, and his mind was tormented with grief. He rolled on the ground and fainted. After a long while he came round a little, and slowly he spoke to the god in the sky: "Who are you, whose voice speaks like this but whose form cannot be seen? Are these words you have spoken really true?"

The god said, "I am the god who guards the king's palace. King, because you are wise and endowed with merit and good qualities, and rule the kingdom by the Dharma of uprightness, I spoke to you just now. You should flee quickly, before you are afflicted by suffering."

Then the king went into the palace and thought, "Now I must go to another country." And he thought further, "There are two roads that lead to the neighboring country. If I take the near road, I will reach that country in seven days; if I take the long road, I will arrive in fourteen days. I will certainly go by the near road." Having thought this, he provided himself with provisions for seven days and went outside the palace. Then he turned back into the palace, took Prince Sujāti on his lap, and gazed at him without blinking; and he stood up as if startled, and sat down again.

At that time the queen, seeing him so ill at ease and seemingly afraid, said to the king, "Great king, why do you show a look of fear and alarm? Your body seems covered in dust, your hair is tangled, and your breathing is uneasy, as if you had come to the loss of your kingdom, or had been parted from those you love, or had met with a hated enemy; and there are inauspicious signs. Please tell me what this is."

The king said, "You do not know what has gone wrong for me, so do not speak."

The queen said, "The king and I have two bodies but one mind, like the two wings of a bird, the two legs of a body, or the two eyes in a head. Since it is so, why do you keep this secret and not tell me?"

The king said to the queen, "Do you not know? The minister Rāhu has conceived an evil intent and rebelled against the king. He has killed the king my father and cut short the lives of my two elder brothers, the princes, and

now he is coming with an army to attack me. So I am going to flee to another country." Having said this, he took Prince Sujāti on his lap and set out on the road, and the queen too followed after the king.

At that time the king, overcome by grief and with his mind confused, took the fourteen-day road and so lost his way. That road was hard to travel and the grass was coarse, and there was not even a little grass or water. After many days had passed, their provisions ran out. At the start he had kept it secret, meaning to go alone, and had taken no more than seven days' provisions; but he had lost his way, three people had been eating, and he had taken the fourteen-day road, so there was still a long way to go when the provisions ran out.

Then the king and the queen cried aloud and wept: "Alas! Alas! How wretched! From the time we were born until now we have never experienced anything like this, and now we are experiencing it. Now we are miserable and destitute!" So saying, they beat their heads with their hands. They rolled on the ground, their bodies covered with dust, and lamented in these words: "What evil, unwholesome karma did we do in a former life? Did we kill a father, a mother, or an arhat? Did we disparage the sacred Dharma? Did we cause a schism in a harmonious Saṅgha? Were we hunters or fishermen? Did we falsify scales and measures and plunder others? Did we make use of the Saṅgha's property? What did we do, that we should experience suffering like this?"

So they lamented. If they rested even a little, then when the enemy arrived they would surely lose their lives; and if they went on along the road, they were tormented by hunger and thirst and were on the point of death. The king and queen, tormented by such suffering, cried aloud and wept, fell to the ground, and fainted.

After a long while they came round, and the king thought, "All three of us together will die right here. I will kill the queen and so save my own life and my son's." Having thought this, he drew his sword and made ready to kill the queen. But Prince Sujāti caught the king by the hand and said, "What are you thinking of doing now?"

His father the king, his eyes brimming with tears, said to the prince, "I mean to kill your mother, the noble queen, and so keep you alive. Even if she is not killed, she will die anyway. Whether I die or live, I mean to kill your mother the queen in order to keep you, my son, alive."

Then Prince Sujāti said to his father the king, "If the queen is killed, I will not eat her flesh, for nowhere is it possible for a son to eat his mother's flesh. Since I too will then die, why does my father the king not kill me instead and so save the lives of my father and mother?"

When his father the king heard him say this, he at once staggered and fell, rolling on the ground, and said to the prince, "You are like my own eyes. Who would gouge out his own eyes and eat them? I would rather die than kill my son. I cannot kill my son and eat his flesh."

Then Prince Sujāti spoke again to his father the king: "If my father and mother kill me, my flesh and blood will rot and spoil before long and will be of no use. If you will not grant me one request, you are not loving parents; so please do not go against my wishes."

Then his father the king told his son the prince, "I will not go against your wishes, so tell me quickly whatever you ask." And Prince Sujāti said to his father the king:

"Out of love for me, my father and mother, cut three measures of flesh from my body each day. Offer two portions to my father and mother, and if I myself eat one portion, it will serve to sustain body and life."

Then the king granted what the prince had asked. Each day he cut three measures of flesh and divided it into three portions: the king and queen ate two portions, and the prince himself ate one. Sustaining body and life in this way, they set out on the road and went on and on. When they were still two days short of the neighboring country, the flesh of the prince's body was used up. Only his joints and sinews held together, and with only a remnant of life left in him, he fell to the ground.

Then the king and queen took the prince on their laps, cried out loudly, wailed greatly, and said, "In our ignorance we two have eaten your flesh and made you suffer the pain of such sickness. The road is still long, and the flesh of your body is used up. Now let us lay down our corpses together in this place."

Then Prince Sujāti said to his father the king in a faint voice, "From here to the other side there remains no more than a day's journey. I cannot stir or move, so I will give up my life here. King and queen, do not say, like base and lowly people, 'Let us lay down our corpses together in this place.' If you think of me with love and affection, please do not go against what I have in mind. Please strip off whatever flesh there still is between my bones, leaving none, and go

on to the neighboring country."

Then the king did as the prince had asked. He stripped off all the flesh there was between the joints and the bones and divided it into three portions. The king and queen ate two portions, and the prince himself ate one. Then the king and queen set out on the road and went.

Prince Sujāti got up and, standing there, watched the king and queen go. The king and queen went off crying aloud and weeping, and Prince Sujāti, with a mind of attachment to them, gazed and gazed at them without blinking until they were out of sight. After a long while he fell back to the ground. Drawn by the smell of flesh and blood, many flies and gadflies gathered from the ten directions until they covered the prince like a blanket, eating and stinging his body, and he was tormented by suffering.

At that time, while the last remnant of his life had not yet been cut off, the prince cried out and made this aspiration: "May my past unwholesome karma be purified and exhausted by this. From this day on I will not commit it. Since I have offered my body to my father and mother as an act of giving, may my father and mother have eleven merits greater than before: may they sleep in happiness, wake in happiness, have no bad dreams, be protected by the gods, and be honored by people; may they be free of disputes, thieves, enemies and robbery, and may they be fortunate at all times. Since I have given the flesh and blood remaining on my body to the flies, may they all be filled and satisfied, and in a future time may I attain buddhahood. When I have attained buddhahood and gained the Dharma body, may that Dharma body dispel for all beings the famine of hunger and thirst and the grave disease of saṃsāra, of birth and death."

When the prince made this aspiration, heaven and earth quaked in six ways. The sun lost its brightness. The wild beasts and game animals took fright and ran in all directions. The ocean was violently churned. Mount Meru shook and swayed, and everything up to the sky of the Thirty-Three quaked violently.

At that time Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, came down to Jambudvīpa with the gods of the desire realm. In order to frighten Prince Sujāti, they emanated bodies of lions, tigers, wolves and the like. Glaring with their eyes, their jaws gaping and their fur bristling, they let out great roars, and as if leaping upon the prince, they menaced him.

At that time Prince Sujāti, seeing those ferocious beasts, spoke in a low voice and told them, "If you want to eat me, eat as you please. What need is there to

frighten me with such a show of power?"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said, "We are not lions or wild beasts. I am Śakra, lord of the gods, and I have come to test you and to examine you."

At that time, when the prince saw Śakra, lord of the gods, he was overjoyed and delighted. Then Śakra said to the prince, "You have given what is extremely hard to give, offering your body's flesh and blood to your father and mother. Through the merit of this, do you wish to become a king of māras? Or do you wish to become a king of Brahmās? A lord of the gods, a king of men, or a wheel-turning king?"

The prince said, "I wish to be none of these: neither a king of māras, nor Brahmā, nor a king of the gods, nor a king of men, nor a wheel-turning king. I wish for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in order to liberate all sentient beings."

Śakra said, "You seem to be utterly deluded. Unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening is achieved only after practicing extremely difficult austerities for a very long time. Can you bear such intense suffering?"

The prince said, "Even if a blazing iron wheel were to spin continually on the crown of my head, such suffering would not turn me back from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Śakra said, "Who would believe these empty words of yours?"

Then the prince made a vow and spoke this aspiration: "If the words I have spoken are false, and I have deceived the lord of the gods, may the wounds on my body never heal. If the words I have spoken are true, may my body be restored and my blood turn to milk."

No sooner had he said this than the wounds on his body were restored as they had been before, and his blood turned to milk. The prince's form became even more fine, lovely and beautiful than before. He rose and bowed his head at the feet of the lord of the gods.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said: "Prince, excellent! Most excellent!

"Through supremely heroic diligence you will without doubt attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. When before long you attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, may you act first for my benefit." Having said this, Śakra, lord of the gods, vanished into the sky right where he was.

At that time the king and queen reached the king of that neighboring country, and that king came out from afar to meet them and provided them with whatever necessities they wished. Then the king and queen told that king in detail how the prince had offered his body's flesh and blood to his father and mother. When that king heard all that had happened, he repaid the kindness of the prince, who had shown such great devotion by offering his body's flesh and blood to his father and mother: he arrayed a fourfold army and led it, together with that king, against the land of Vārāṇasī.

At that time that king, equipped with the fourfold army, set out on the road. When he reached the place where he had parted from the prince, he thought, "My son must surely have died right here. I will gather up at least my son's bones and carry them back to my own country." With this thought he cried aloud and wept, and went on to gather his son's bones. But from afar his own son came up to him, the wounds on his body healed, finer and more beautiful even than before.

Then the king took him on his lap and said, "Are you still alive?" And the prince told his father the king and the queen what had happened. The king and the queen rejoiced greatly. They all mounted elephants and went back to their own country, and through the power of the prince's merit he regained his own country. He empowered Prince Sujāti as king and set him on the throne.

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "If you think that the one who was the father king at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so. Why is that? The father king at that time, on that occasion, has now become my father, called Śuddhodana. If you think that the one who was the mother at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so: she is now my mother, called Māyā. If you think that the one who was called Prince Sujāti at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so: that prince at that time, on that occasion, is now I, called Śākyamuni. The one who was Śakra, lord of the gods, at that time, on that occasion, is now the one called Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya."

When the Blessed One taught this chapter on devotion to one's parents, in that assembly some two hundred thousand bodhisattvas attained eloquence of speech skilled in what benefits and brings happiness to all beings. A hundred and twenty thousand bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the Dharma that phenomena are unborn. Moreover, śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas gathered from the ten directions, as numerous as the finest

atoms, abandoned the mind of the two vehicles and reached the final goal through the one vehicle. Laymen and laywomen as numerous as the finest atoms attained fruits ranging from the first fruit up to the fruit of the two vehicles. Some hundred thousand gods and humans generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Among the many other hosts of gods, nāgas, pretas, asuras, gandharvas, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, nonhumans and so on, some generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening, and others generated the mind set on the awakening of śrāvakas or of pratyekabuddhas.

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "This is how bodhisattvas, for the sake of all sentient beings and in order to show devotion to their parents, offer even the flesh and blood of their bodies to their parents and practice what is extremely hard to practice."

When the whole great assembly had heard what the Buddha said, each of them gained what brought them benefit and happiness. Delighted and overjoyed, they bowed their heads, circumambulated him to the right, and departed.

This concludes the second chapter, called Devotion, from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness, second fascicle.

At that time, on that occasion, the Blessed One sat amid the great assembly, blazing and radiant with light: like the disk of the sun outshining the many stars; or like a rainbow coiled like a nāga, glittering and bright, so that one can never gaze at it enough; so dazzling that the mind reels merely to think of it. Nothing can serve as an example for it. The light of the firefly vanishes the moment the sun rises. The sun and moon have hundreds of thousands of rays, yet beside Śakra they are like a heap of charcoal. Śakra has a clear radiance, yet beside the light of the Great Brahmā he is like a potsherd or a shard of stone, or like night compared with the light of a precious jewel. And all the light of the great king Brahmā, with his hundreds of thousands of supreme rays, became like a heap of charcoal beside the light of the Tathāgata.

Why was this? Because the color of the Tathāgata's light illuminated all the world systems of the ten directions. When that light touched the beings dwelling in them, the blind saw forms with their eyes, the hunchbacked became straight in body, those with impaired faculties had their faculties

made whole and possessed all their major and minor limbs, and the intoxicated regained their mindfulness. In short, they were freed from everything unpleasant and obtained whatever they wished.

At that time, in that very assembly, some seventy bodhisattva great beings rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the Buddha's feet, circumambulated him a hundred thousand times, and sat down to one side.

All of them, with one voice, praised the Tathāgata in a hundred thousand verses. They were the bodhisattva Inconceivable, the bodhisattva Melody Free of Conceptions, the bodhisattva Mind of Pure Bliss, the bodhisattva Vimalakīrti, the bodhisattva Boundless Melody, the bodhisattva Great Fame, the bodhisattva Crown Light, the bodhisattva Steadfast Lion, the bodhisattva Sole Delight, the bodhisattva Abandoning Conceptions, the bodhisattva Heaped Wisdom, the bodhisattva Intelligence Abiding in Virtue, the bodhisattva Utterly Signless, the bodhisattva Radiant Intelligence, the bodhisattva Intelligence That Calms Anger, the bodhisattva Well Guarded, the bodhisattva Mighty Faith, the bodhisattva Exalted Flower, the bodhisattva All-Blissful, the bodhisattva Work of Noble Wisdom, the bodhisattva Ready Exposition, the bodhisattva Unthinkable, the bodhisattva Brahmadatta, the bodhisattva Jewel Work, the bodhisattva Abode of Divine Flowers, the bodhisattva Excellent Mind, the bodhisattva Immeasurable Dharma, the bodhisattva Mind of Fame, the bodhisattva Heaped Eloquence, the bodhisattva Gate of Sovereignty, the bodhisattva Ten Powers, the bodhisattva Holder of the Ten Powers, the bodhisattva Guarded by the Great Noble One, the bodhisattva Unsurpassed, the bodhisattva Delighting in Peace, the bodhisattva Abiding There, the bodhisattva Countless Gods, the bodhisattva Meru Light, the bodhisattva Trunk of Great Weight, the bodhisattva Exalted Above Causes, the bodhisattva Going Alone, the bodhisattva Exalted Splendor, the bodhisattva Skilled with the Great Host, the bodhisattva Protector of Lineages, the bodhisattva Upholder of the Three Worlds, the bodhisattva Possessed of Readiness, the bodhisattva Proclaimed Fame, the bodhisattva Clear Sunlight, the bodhisattva Mighty Lion, the bodhisattva King of Seasons, the bodhisattva Lion Essence, the bodhisattva Revealer of Existence, the bodhisattva Far-Shining Light, the bodhisattva Lion Mountain, the bodhisattva Giver of Rebirth, the bodhisattva Jinadatta, the bodhisattva Supreme Banner, the bodhisattva Delighted, the bodhisattva Steadfast Diligence, the bodhisattva Undiminished, the bodhisattva Renowned, the bodhisattva Fearless, the bodhisattva Unattached God, the bodhisattva Great Lamp, the bodhisattva Light of the World, the

bodhisattva Sublime Melody, the bodhisattva Power of Great Means, the bodhisattva Dispeller of Darkness, the bodhisattva Peerless Quarter, and others.

All these bodhisattvas made this vow in the presence of the Buddha: "After the Blessed One has passed into nirvāṇa, we will protect the Buddha's Dharma, spread it throughout all the world systems of the ten directions, and keep it from being cut off. Why is that? Because, having seen the inconceivable, sublime light of the Tathāgata, from that light we have also come to hear the inconceivable Dharma of the Buddha. Having heard that Dharma, we are freed from the obscurations of the mind, and all afflictions are purified; our minds have become utterly pure, like divine precious gold, and so everything appears clearly.

"Recalling such qualities of benefit and happiness, we have come to regard the Tathāgata as the great Teacher. Regarding him as loving parents, we always remember the Buddha's kindness and acknowledge the Buddha's kindness. Why is that? Because by hearing the sublime Dharma, before long one will sit at the seat of awakening, turn the wheel of the sublime Dharma, and liberate all sentient beings; and they too, by hearing the Dharma, will attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then the Tathāgata said to the great assembly: "These seventy bodhisattva great beings, long ago, as many countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons in the past as there are finest atoms, attended upon buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the finest atoms in world systems as many as hundreds of thousands of times the sands of the river Ganges. They always practiced pure conduct under those buddhas and pleased those victors with untiring minds. Guarding their own bodies with loving-kindness, they uphold the Buddha's Dharma, and with great compassion they continually work for the benefit and happiness of all in the ten directions.

"Whatever sentient being, at the very moment of death, hears the name of one of these bodhisattvas, or of two, or three, or four, up to all seventy, and goes for refuge to them with his whole life, will, as soon as he passes from that life, be born miraculously from a lotus in a world system where a buddha dwells. He will be entirely free of desire, will not be born from a womb, and will be free of filth and impurity. His body will be completely pure and fragrant, and he will be pleasing to all and honored by them. Because he is pleasing to all and honored by them, his mind will be filled with joy. Because his mind is

filled with joy, he will generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"By generating the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he will generate a mind of loving-kindness and great compassion toward all sentient beings. By generating such a mind of loving-kindness and compassion, there will arise in him a mind that does not abandon any being to indifference. Moreover, there will arise in him the mind to bring benefit and happiness to all sentient beings; the mind to accomplish the aims of self and others; the mind to remove what becomes an obscuration or an obstacle; the mind to pacify afflictions; the mind to attend upon spiritual friends and always honor them; the mind to listen to the Dharma with eager interest; the mind to keep it in attention without forgetting and to retain its excellent meaning; the mind that, hearing little, understands much meaning; and the mind that does not want to hear much without understanding the meaning.

"Then there will arise in him a mind of clear faith in reality itself, and a mind of faith in the true meaning of suchness. Having generated a mind of faith in the true meaning of reality, there will arise in him the mind to practice yoga just as it has been taught. Having generated the mind to practice yoga just as it has been taught, there will arise in him a mind that does not turn back. Having generated such a mind that does not turn back, there will arise in him the mind of equality toward all those sentient beings, which is the antidote.

"Just as I do not delight in being born in the twenty-five states of existence of the three realms, so it is too for all living creatures, those with form and those without form, the four-footed and the many-footed, down to ants and beetles. Therefore a bodhisattva, even at the cost of his own body and life, does not do the deed of taking the life of another.

"Just as I guard and take care of my possessions, my wealth and goods, grain, clothing, food, drink, elephants, carriages and vehicles, lands, towns, wife and children, down to the limbs of my body, and do not like others to carry them off and steal them, so it is too for all sentient beings. Therefore a bodhisattva, even at the cost of his own body and life, does not give rise to the thought of stealing the wealth, clothing, food, drink and possessions of sentient beings.

"Just as I do not want others to behave improperly toward my beautiful sister, wife or daughter-in-law, so it is too for all sentient beings. Therefore a bodhisattva, even at the cost of his own body and life, does not give rise to a wrong mind with a base notion toward another's beautiful woman, let alone

commit an improper, base act.

"Just as I do not like slander and harsh words that lead to strife, so it is too for sentient beings. Therefore a bodhisattva, even if his own body and life should perish, does not tell lies or speak words that set people at strife with one another.

"Just as I do not like being struck with stones and sticks, beaten with whips, or treated with force, so it is too for all sentient beings. Therefore a bodhisattva, even if his own body and life should perish, does not harm sentient beings with stones and sticks, whips, or acts of punishment.

"Just as I do not like the harms of being fettered with iron chains, stocks and weapons, of being seized, tied and bound with bonds, so it is too for all sentient beings. Therefore a bodhisattva, even if his own body and life should perish, does not inflict the harms of iron chains, stocks, seizing, binding and the like.

"Just as I do not like others to despise me, to lord it over me and treat me violently, or to presume on their power, act tyrannically, look down on me and treat me badly, so it is too for all sentient beings. Therefore a bodhisattva, even if his one body and life should perish, does not harm sentient beings by improper, unfitting means.

"Just as I delight in happiness when others honor me, make offerings to me, or praise me with pleasing words, so I too give to sentient beings clothing, food, drink, bedding, medicine for illness, and all the requisites of comfort.

"Suppose I am carrying out a great undertaking, whether for the sake of the Buddha, for the sake of the Dharma, or for the sake of the Saṅgha, and my intelligence is not equal to accomplishing the aim, so that it is not accomplished, and I am unhappy and tormented with grief. If a wise and intelligent person sees that I am unhappy and grieving because the aim I was pursuing has not been accomplished, and says to me, 'Son of good family, do not be unhappy. I will be your companion in accomplishing your aim, and we will accomplish it as you wish,' then a mind of great joy arises in me toward him. Therefore I shall be a companion in the work that is done for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings.

"Suppose I am harmed by the king, by thieves, by water or by fire, or am seized, tied or bound by ministers and the like, and am tormented by unhappiness and grief. If a wise and intelligent person sees me thus tormented

by grief and says to me with gentle words, 'Do not grieve. For your sake I will petition the king or the chief minister, and if need be I will give them a bribe, or by all sorts of means I will somehow free you from the suffering of your distress,' then merely hearing those words, my mind becomes joyful. Therefore a bodhisattva trains with diligence to master everything that is to be known, even the arts and crafts.

That is, he trains to become skilled in what is to be known: the fields of learning, the fields of craft, music, sports, numbers, calculation, the spells of illusion, medicine, elephants, horses, riding, the ways of dealing with enemies, the leading of armies, investigation, and so on. Having thus trained to be skilled in every art, he does not act against the wishes and intentions of the many beings, of kings, great ministers and the rest.

Apart from that, he may also have the conditions for enjoyment: clothing, wealth, food, things to eat, things to drink, jewels, bracelets, ornaments for the body, gold, silver, beryl, coral, crystal, agate, pearls, amragarbha stones, precious gems, elephants, horses, carriages, servants, laborers, wives and maidservants as well; springs, bathing pools, fine jeweled pavilions, and all the various kinds of articles of enjoyment. Yet though he has them, that bodhisattva has no conceit or pride about them.

Thus he is skilled in every art, he possesses hundreds of thousands of treasuries of jewels, he has elephants, horses and carriages, he has countless lovely young women, he has fine pavilions, and he has whatever pleasures of the senses there are, springs, bathing pools and the like. Yet he is not attached to them. He always delights in having few desires and in contentment, and he longs to dwell peacefully in meditative concentration in remote wildernesses, on mountains, in groves, and at the foot of trees. Though he talks and converses with many people, his mind always enters the door of the antidotes. Though he behaves in keeping with the conduct of ordinary people, he gives away precious jewels for the benefit of sentient beings, and he does nothing that harms sentient beings or does them no good. When those who are poor, destitute and wretched come to the bodhisattva to beg, the bodhisattva gives them whatever they wish.

Some sentient beings, inclined toward the Dharma of the buddhas and having faith in it, serve and wait upon the bodhisattva in order to honor him and make offerings to him. They do the work of washing his feet, or of washing and massaging his body; or they sprinkle water and sweep; or they provide tooth

sticks and bathing water; or they do the work of spreading his bedding and shaking out his bedclothes; or they light the lamps at dusk and at dawn; or in the early morning and the forenoon they offer foods, pana, pushena and khadane; and they prepare drinks such as yulishi, a drink made from the fruit of the bulashaka, grape juice, and black sugar water. If, with such provisions, they make offerings to the bodhisattva for seven days and up to ninety days because they long for the Dharma, at that time the bodhisattva has no feeling of delight at that offering of provisions. Why is that? Because for a long time, for countless eons, the bodhisattva has sought the Dharma of the buddhas; because he has no partiality, favoring some and slighting others, toward any sentient being; because he possesses a mind of loving-kindness and compassion; and because he abides in a mind of equanimity.

Therefore at certain times he becomes a wheel-turning king, and he always works for the benefit of sentient beings through the Dharma of the ten virtues. Those sentient beings, for their part, rejoice and act in accordance with the king's wishes, and so when they die they are endowed with the supreme and excellent enjoyment of the five sense pleasures in the worlds of gods and humans, and they are born into great and high families. Just as they wish, they lie down, rise and go about without harm. Wherever they go they have horses to ride and carriages, and in pleasure groves they play at games and music and enjoy themselves. Though they enjoy excellent food and drink and every delight, in the end they meet with impermanence. Afflicted by old age and sickness, they die, and the family of the household, tormented by grief, cry aloud and weep. Some beat their heads with their palms; some tear out their own hair, shed tears and roll on the ground. Then they lay the dead on a litter or a cart and carry them to the charnel ground. And having carried them there, the family come back home tormented by grief. Some faint and fall to the ground; some fall ill because of it; some lose their wits and become deranged; some die before their time. Yet even though they do all this, it does no good to the living and greatly harms the dead.

At that time, on that occasion, the wheel-turning king was traveling through the land with his retinue, and when he saw sentient beings afflicted by grief, a feeling of tender compassion arose in him and he said this: "One who is called a king rules over many beings by his power over the land. Even if, having thus tamed beings by the path of the ten virtues, they have obtained the result, the supreme and excellent five sense pleasures, still, if they are not freed from the terror of birth, old age, sickness, death and impermanence, then although I

rule the realm by the upright Dharma, it is of no benefit. If it is thus of no benefit to beings, how can one be called a great wheel-turning king? How can one be named a father of great loving-kindness, or a great king of physicians, or a great guide and teacher? One called a great guide and teacher leads onto the right path and shows the path to nirvāṇa, bringing about the attainment of the supreme bliss of the unconditioned. Our name and our conduct do not match.

"It is like this: a man tormented by thirst and on the verge of losing his life runs here and there in search of water. He comes upon a dry well, great joy arises in him, and he thinks, 'Now this body of mine has come back from death. Why? Had I not found water, this life of mine would not have been far from death. But now that I have found a good well, I shall surely find a pool of cool, clean water, quench my thirst and be satisfied, and my life will be saved.' Thinking this, he hurried as fast as he could to the well. When he reached the well, he took off the clothes he was wearing, hid them to one side, and, wanting water, climbed down into the well.

When he reached the bottom of the well, there was no water. All he saw were venomous snakes, centipedes, scorpions, lizards, frogs, potsherds and the like, gravel, sticks and matted grass. Then the man, worn out by thirst, found no water as he had first hoped, and he was bitten by many venomous creatures. He meant to climb back out of the well, but the well was old and ruined, and as deep as an arrow's flight. Inside it there was no ladder, no rope or cord, not even a tree to climb. He tried to leap up from below, but he was so worn out and weak that he could not jump high enough. He fell back to the bottom, and the venomous snakes and the rest bit him and sucked at him. While his life was not quite cut off, he said this: "Had I known before that there was no water in this well, I would not have dared even to look at it, let alone climb down into it. Now, because of this well, I am undergoing the suffering of suffering." So he lamented.

In the same way, the wheel-turning king saw that when one ordinary person died, the family and relatives of the household were tormented by the suffering of separation from someone dear, and he said this: "This body of mine is like that dry well. It has only the name of a well, but there is no water in it. So although there is a going in, there is no gaining anything, and one undergoes the suffering of losing body and life. Now I wield the power of a wheel-turning king and possess the seven precious things. I tame beings through the actions of the ten virtues and rule the realm by the upright

Dharma. I have established many people in the higher realms of gods and humans and let them enjoy the supreme and excellent qualities of the five sense pleasures. Yet they cannot be freed from the suffering of birth, old age, sickness and death, of separation from those dear to them, and of meeting with hated enemies. That they weep and wail over one another is my fault; it is not the fault of sentient beings. Why is that? Because I have no Dharma that transcends the world, which would bring benefit to many beings. Though they seek from me the Dharma of virtue and long for perfect happiness, they cannot cross the ocean of suffering."

Then the wheel-turning king also thought, "Now this body of mine is like an ignorant, deluded donor, for example."

At that time, on another occasion, no rain fell for seven years, and a great drought came about. The trees and plants withered, and grain became very scarce. A great famine arose, and people seized and ate one another. They ate one another's flesh and blood. Some parents ate the flesh and blood of their children; some children ate the flesh of their parents. Parents, brothers and sisters, husbands and wives, sons and daughters all ate one another's flesh.

At that time a great donor was walking about and strolling here and there, and he saw many sentient beings starving, their strength gone, emaciated and dried up, feeble and of poor color, their hair matted, their bodies blackened and gaunt, carrying human corpses on their shoulders as loads. Some carried human heads, hands, feet, limb joints, forearms, shoulders, joints, backs, thighs and calves, every major and minor limb. He saw others carrying entrails: livers, spleens, lungs, intestines and rectums. When the donor saw such things, he asked them, "What are these things you carry as loads?"

They said, "These things we carry as loads are human corpses: human heads, hands and feet, thighs and calves, every major and minor limb."

He asked, "Why do you need these human heads and limbs, major and minor, that you are carrying? What will you do with them?"

They said, "Don't you know? A great famine has come and grain has become very scarce. Everyone is starving, and now people eat one another. So these loads we carry are our food."

When the great donor heard them say this, he was terrified. His hair stood on end, he trembled and fell to the ground. Cold water was sprinkled on his face, and after a long while he came back to his senses and asked, "Well then, if this

is your food, whose flesh is it?"

They cried out loudly and wept, and said, "It cannot be told to the donor. Alas, how wretched we are! Alas, how wretched we are! Alas, alas, yet it is not right not to speak to you plainly. Of these things we carry, some is the flesh of a father, some the flesh of a mother, some the flesh of a child, some the flesh of a brother or sister, and some the flesh of relatives and friends." So each of those starving people spoke plainly to the householder: "Because we are so terribly starved, we have come to eat the flesh of one another's kin."

Then the donor, drawing a deep breath, said this to the starving people: "From this day on, do not eat the flesh of one another's kin. Whatever requisites you need, clothing to wear, food, drink, medicine for sickness, whatever requisites you need, I will give you all of it. In seven days, come to my door, and I will satisfy you as you wish with clothing, food, medicine for sickness, whatever you desire." When he had told them this, they were overjoyed and praised him, saying, "Excellent, excellent! How wonderful!"

Then the donor went back home and gathered his wife, his children, his servants and his laborers. With a joyful countenance, and with gentle, pleasing and sweet words, he instructed his family, servants and laborers, saying, "Understand this, and listen well to what I say. Do you know that because of the great drought a famine has arisen, everyone is starving, and countless people have died? In my house all the storehouses are full to overflowing, and there is countless grain. So let us make merit without letting the time slip by."

When the whole family heard him instruct them in this way, they said, "Excellent, excellent! Even giving away our lives and bodies we would not begrudge, so what need is there to speak of storehouses, wealth and food?"

Then the donor too was overjoyed and said, "How good it is that you are truly my companions for attaining unsurpassed awakening! Excellent!"

"Each of you, too, whatever has to be done, whatever has to be prepared, do at once what is needed for the cooking, and quickly accomplish what needs to be accomplished, so that in seven days from now it will certainly all be ready."

Then the donor, having given each of them their instructions, went outside the house. He looked for a place where the ground was level, spacious and pleasant, and at once he had the ground cleaned, cleared of litter, earth and stones, and swept, and he had seats arranged. Having thus prepared a place where many could gather, a ground for giving gifts, he loaded food onto five

hundred elephants and had it brought to the place of giving. The food was heaped up like mountains, and curd was gathered like lakes. Butter, oil, flatbreads and all sorts of foods with a hundred flavors were prepared in great abundance. Besides these, he also prepared clothing, bracelets, garlands, all kinds of ornaments for the body, elephants, horses, the seven precious things and more, everything in perfect abundance.

When seven days had passed, at daybreak on the seventh day, bells and drums were struck and conches blown, and it was proclaimed in a loud voice, "Everyone, gather and come to this place of giving!"

At that time, when everyone heard the call, a feeling of great joy arose in them, as though by the blessing of a noble one, and all came to the place where the gifts were being given. They took, just as they wished, clothing, bedding, food and drink, all kinds of ornaments for the body, many medicines for sickness, elephants, horses, the seven precious things and whatever else they desired, and between them they carried off every last thing there was to give.

Then the donor, delighted, came back home and, together with his wife and children, enjoyed the five sense pleasures as they pleased.

About seven days later, people said, "Those who ate the food when that donor gave away clothing, food, drink and so on have been poisoned, and all of them have died." Because they had died in this way, everyone said, "How astonishing, how astonishing!" So it was proclaimed that although the great donor, out of compassion for all, had satisfied them with food and the rest just as they wished and had kept their bodies and lives alive, afterward, before many days had passed, they had been poisoned and all had died.

At that time, when the great donor heard what had happened, he became dejected and unhappy, and he asked his wife, his children and the others, "How did you prepare your food, that deadly poison got into it?"

His wife, children, servants and laborers said, "There cannot have been any poison. Look carefully into where this poison came from."

Then the donor, looking after the household, went round from place to place and saw a well whose top had been covered over and concealed. He asked, "Why has this well been covered?"

He was told, "This well, householder, was dug when you were a small child and were raising three venomous snakes, and the three venomous snakes were

put into it. This well is the well where the venomous snakes live. Its water is poisonous too, so whoever drinks this water falls sick and dies."

When the donor heard these words, he asked the laborers, "When you were cooking the food the other day, did you not draw water from this well and cook the food with it?"

The laborers said, "Because we were cooking so much food we were in a hurry, so we drew this water as well and used it to cook the food."

The householder was unhappy and said, "How astonishing! I am like someone deluded and without wisdom. Why did I raise venomous snakes and dig a poisonous well?" Filled with remorse, he instructed his wife and children, "Fill in the well of the three venomous snakes at once! And I myself will burn the three venomous snakes." When he had given this instruction, the laborers immediately filled in that well and did away with it.

Then, having done away with the well of the venomous snakes, the donor went out for a walk, and with one voice all said of those who had died from the donor's poisoned food, "This donor gave us poisoned food, and so we died before our time. Had we known this, it would have been better not to go there." So remorse arose in them.

In the same way, that wheel-turning king tamed sentient beings by means of the ten virtues, and those beings were born in the higher realms of gods and humans and enjoyed the five sense pleasures to their hearts' content; yet that they were not freed from birth, old age, sickness and death is just like that.

Then the wheel-turning king at once made a vow: "I shall accomplish the unsurpassed Dharma of the buddhas, the Dharma that transcends the world, and sentient beings too shall read it, recite it, inquire into it and make themselves familiar with it, so that they completely abandon the cycle of birth and death, saṃsāra, and attain nirvāṇa."

At that time the wheel-turning king, in order to seek the Dharma of the buddhas, had it proclaimed everywhere throughout Jambudvīpa, "Who knows the Dharma of the buddhas?" But although the wheel-turning king, longing for the Dharma, had it proclaimed everywhere, no one who knew it appeared. When the proclamation reached a small border land, it was said that there was a brahmin there who knew the Dharma of the buddhas.

So he sent a messenger to that brahmin. The messenger went to where the brahmin was and asked, "Venerable sir, do you know the Dharma of the

buddhas?" and he said, "I know it." Then the messenger bowed his head at the brahmin's feet and said, "Venerable sir, the wheel-turning king has sent me to invite you. Please come to where the wheel-turning king is."

Then the brahmin came there, and the wheel-turning king went out a long way to meet him. He bowed his head at his feet and greeted him, asking, "Did you travel well? Were you not troubled on the road? Are you not weary?" Then he led him into the palace and seated him on the royal throne in the middle of the palace. The brahmin sat down on the seat with his legs crossed. When the brahmin was comfortably seated, the king offered him all the requisites he needed as gifts, and then, joining his palms, he asked the brahmin, "Great teacher, do you know the Dharma of the buddhas?" The brahmin said, "I know the Dharma of the buddhas."

Then the king said to the brahmin, "Great teacher, please teach it to me and explain it."

The brahmin said, "King, you are very foolish. When I studied the Dharma of the buddhas, I mastered it only after long undergoing suffering and hardship. And now does the king expect to hear it for nothing?"

The king said, "Great teacher, what then do you want?"

The brahmin said, "Make offerings to me."

The king said, "Great teacher, what offerings do you want? Do you want clothing, or bedding, or food, or drink? Or do you want gold, or silver, or jewels?"

The brahmin said, "I do not want offerings like those."

The king said, "If you do not want those offerings, then do you want elephants, or horses, or carriages? Or do you want a country, or a city, or wives, or children? Do you want musicians, or singers, or dancers?"

The brahmin said, "I want none of these. If you cut a thousand wounds in your body, pour butter into the wounds, set wicks in them, and make offerings to me with a thousand burning lamps, then I will teach and explain the Dharma of the buddhas. If you cannot do that, I shall get up and go." Having said this, before the king had answered for even a moment, he got down from the throne.

Then the king caught him in his arms and said, "Great teacher, please wait a little. Because my understanding is weak and my merit small, let me think a

little, and I will make the offering."

At that time the wheel-turning king thought, "Since beginningless time this body of mine has undergone death countless times, yet it has never died for the sake of the Dharma. And now this body of mine too will in the end perish and rot, so it is of no use. Now the time has come." Having thought this, he said to the brahmin teacher, "Great teacher, I will make the offering as you wish."

Then the king went into the palace and said to the queens, "Now we are to be parted."

When the queens heard him say this, they were frightened and trembled, and not knowing what was wrong, they said, "King, what are you now thinking of doing?"

The king said, "I am thinking of setting a thousand lamps in this body of mine and making an offering to the brahmin teacher."

When the queens heard him say this, they rolled on the ground, wailed and fainted. After a long while they came back to their senses. "Great king, in the world nothing is dearer than one's own body. Fearing that harm may come to it, one takes great care to nourish it. Why then would you injure and harm your own body? The king is endowed with a wise mind; has he now become deranged? Or has he been possessed by a hungry ghost? What is wrong?"

The king said, "It is none of these."

"Then why would you do such harm and think of making offerings to the brahmin?"

The king said, "I long for the Dharma of the buddhas, and I mean to work for the benefit of all sentient beings."

"If you are thinking of all sentient beings, then why are you casting us aside?"

The king said, "In the world, all who are dear and beloved are in the end parted. Therefore I shall make the offering of my body, intending to light the lamp of great wisdom in the dark house of yourselves and all sentient beings, to illuminate the darkness of ignorance that circles through birth and death, to cut the knots of the afflictions that bind on every side, to free you from the faults of saṃsāra, and to establish you in the state of nirvāṇa. So do not hinder me or put obstacles in my way."

When the queens heard him instruct them in this way, they were struck speechless as though choked, then cried out aloud, wept, and tore their own hair. "We have no merit," they said. "Because we are ill-starred, we have lost our lord while we are still alive."

That king had five hundred princes, all handsome and lovely, sincere and endowed with wise minds, perfectly possessed of the marks of a man. The king cherished and loved them as his own eyes.

At that time the king said to the princes, "Now that I mean to perform an act of offering, I fear my body and life will be put at risk, and I think I shall be parted from you. Take charge of the government of the realm and the welfare of the subjects in order of seniority." So he instructed them.

When the princes heard him instruct them in this way, they were tormented by suffering as if the limbs and veins of their bodies had been cut, and like a man choking who can neither cough up nor swallow, they said to the king, "Why do you abandon us and leave us without a refuge?" Some embraced the king around his neck; some held his hands and feet, crying aloud and weeping. "Alas, alas! Why must we be left without protector or refuge?" they said.

Then, to give the princes heart, the king told them, "In the world, all who are dear and beloved are in the end parted."

Though they heard him say this, their hearts clung to him, and unable to bear the parting, they said, "Please grant us one request. Let us offer our bodies and lives to the king, and with them, please make the offering to the brahmin teacher."

The king said, "My sons, you are still young and your strength has not yet developed, so you could not endure such an offering. As for me, I sought out the teacher from far away, and it would not be right to go against the intention with which I promised to make the offering. A dutiful son does not go against his father's wishes; will you go against mine?"

When the princes heard him say this, they cried out and wailed, so that even the gods of the land were frightened, and like mountains toppling, they all threw themselves down upon the ground.

At that time all the lesser kings of the border lands too paid homage to the king. Then he went to where the great teacher was within the palace. When he had come before him, he took off all the ornaments of his body, removed his clothes as well, laid them to one side, and sat with his body held upright. As

soon as he had sat down, he gave instructions to the lesser kings, the ministers, the five hundred princes and the twenty thousand queens.

He said, "Which of you is able to cut a thousand wounds in my body?"

The queens, the princes, the ministers and the people of the lesser kings said with one voice, "Even if we were to take a knife to our own bodies and gouge out our eyes, we would not dare to make a wound in the body of our sovereign king."

Then the king became unhappy and said, "Now I am left all alone. Among all this great retinue, is there not a single person who will be my companion?"

At that time the king had an executioner of low caste, by nature wrathful and fearsome to all, and he summoned him. The executioner came. When the executioner had come, he said to the princes, "Do not grieve. I have a way to make sure the great king's aim does not succeed. And if it does not succeed, you will simply keep the king's rule as before." When the princes heard him say these words, a feeling of great joy arose in them.

Then the executioner came before the king and said, "Great king, what are you now thinking of doing?"

The king said, "I mean to set a thousand lamps in my body and make an offering to the great teacher, the brahmin."

The executioner said, "In that case, I can cut your body."

When the king heard him say this, he was filled with great joy and said to the executioner, "You are truly my companion in accomplishing unsurpassed awakening."

Then the executioner, standing before the king, said to him in a loud, sobbing voice, "Does the king know? By the law for putting people to death, first the head must be cut off: the neck is chopped through, the hands and feet are severed, and the sinews and tendons are pulled out as well. Great king, can you bear the suffering of such pain?"

When the king heard him say this, he was filled with great joy. Then the executioner took up a knife shaped like an ox's tongue and, without delay, cut a full thousand wounds in the king's body. The executioner had thought that the king's resolve would waver, but since his resolve did not waver, he threw the knife on the ground and fled.

Then into the thousand wounds cut in the great king's body melted butter was poured, wicks of fine cotton were set, and a thousand lamps were placed.

At that time, when the brahmin, the great teacher, saw this done, he thought, "If I do not explain the Dharma quickly now, there is no telling whether his body and life will survive or not. If his life is not spared, who will hear the Dharma?" Having thought this, he said to the king, "Because, longing to hear the Dharma of the buddhas, you have performed this difficult deed with heroic diligence, listen well and keep it firmly in mind. Now I shall teach the king the Dharma of the buddhas."

When the king heard him say this, he was filled with great joy. Just as a dutiful son is deeply unhappy when his parent dies, and tormented by suffering, and then, when the parent comes back to life, that son is overjoyed, so too was the king overjoyed.

Then the brahmin said to the king:

"Where there is birth, there will be death.
This cessation is happiness."

So he taught this half verse.

When the king heard the sublime Dharma taught, he was filled with great joy, and he instructed the princes and ministers: "If you have any love and affection for me, keep this Dharma in mind without forgetting it, and in every region, wherever there are places where many gather, in villages, towns and marketplaces, proclaim this to the many beings: 'The great wheel-turning king, in order to draw out the many sentient beings who are sunk in the ocean of suffering, and having given rise to great compassion for all sentient beings, set a thousand lamps in his body and heard this half verse. So that this great king's loving-kindness and compassion may be fulfilled, all should write it down, recite it, learn it by heart, inquire into it and make themselves familiar with it, reflect on its meaning, and diligently practice it as it teaches.'"

At that time, when many people heard this proclamation, they were overjoyed and delighted, and all with one voice praised the king in great joy: "The great king is truly our father of great compassion! For the sake of all sentient beings he has done what is extremely hard to do." So all extolled him. All of them wrote it down on paper, silk, bark, wood and stone, and learned it by heart. They also wrote it up in places where many people gather, so that all might see it, and they inspired them to give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed

awakening.

At that time the light from the great king's setting a thousand lamps in his body and making an offering to the brahmin, the great teacher, illuminated the world systems of the buddha fields in the ten directions. From the light of those lamps, too, the sound of the Dharma of the half verse resounded, and all gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

The light of those lamps illuminated even the dwellings of the gods of the Thirty-Three in the heavens, and the light of the lamps outshone all the light of the gods. Because the gods of the Thirty-Three were completely bathed in the light of those lamps, they thought, "Through what cause, through what condition, has such a light appeared?" Looking with their divine eyes, they saw that in the world a great wheel-turning king had given rise to compassion and, for the sake of all beings, had set a thousand lamps in his body and made an offering to a brahmin, a great teacher.

A feeling of great joy arose in those gods. They descended to the world, took on the bodies of ordinary men, went to where the king was, and said to the great king, "Great king, what is the use of setting a thousand lamps in your body, doing something so extremely hard to do, just to hear half a verse?"

The king said, "Son of good family, it is in order to lead all sentient beings to give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then that emanated man changed back into the body of Śakra, lit up everything with the light of his body, and said this to the great king: "Great king, by making such an offering as this, do you wish to be king of the gods? Do you wish to be king of the māras? Do you wish to be king of the Brahmās?"

The universal monarch said to Śakra, "Lord of the gods, I do not wish for any of the enjoyments of gods or humans. I wish for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. I wish to establish all ordinary beings who are without happiness in a state of happiness, to free those who are not free, to bring across those who have not crossed over, and to bring those who have not attained awakening to attain it."

Śakra said, "Great king, you are an utter fool. Unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening is attained only by practicing what is extremely hard to practice for a very long time. How then would you attain unsurpassed awakening?"

The king said to Śakra, "Even if a blazing iron wheel were to spin ceaselessly on the crown of my head, I would not turn back from unsurpassed awakening because of that much suffering."

Śakra said, "Who would believe you when you say such words?"

Then the universal monarch said to Śakra, "If I do not wish for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and I have deceived you, lord of the gods, then may these wounds on my body never heal. If that is not so, may my blood turn into milk, and may my wounds be healed." The moment he made this vow, his wounds were healed.

Śakra, lord of the gods, praised the king, saying, "Excellent, excellent! Great king, you are truly endowed with great compassion; this is the conduct of great compassion. Since by practicing such hard practices you will before long attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, when you attain unsurpassed awakening, may you first act for my benefit." Having said this, Śakra, lord of the gods, lit up the whole of the king's body with the light rays of his own body, and together with a retinue of a hundred thousand gods he gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

When the five hundred princes saw that the wounds on the body of their father the king had thus healed and that he was as he had been before, they were overjoyed. They bowed their heads at the king's feet, sat down to one side, bowed with joined palms, and said in unison, "Such a deed is a great wonder. Our father the king truly has great compassion for all beings." So they praised him.

The king said, "Sons, if you truly honor me, all of you give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." When he had commanded them thus, the princes gave rise to the mind set on perfect and complete awakening. Likewise his twenty thousand queens and some hundred thousand palace attendants also gave rise to the mind set on awakening.

At that time, beings dwelling in that assembly as numerous as the sands of seventeen Ganges rivers gave rise to the mind of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Countless gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, nonhumans and others, having seen and heard all this, every one of them gave rise to the mind set on awakening, and departed overjoyed.

This concludes the third chapter, called "The Antidote," from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

At that time, in the circle of that assembly, the bodhisattva great being King of Joy rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed with joined palms toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "How does a bodhisattva know kindness? How does he repay kindness?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva King of Joy, "Son of good family, listen well. For a bodhisattva great being, to know kindness is to give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. To repay kindness is to lead all other beings to give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

He asked, "As for what is called giving rise to the mind set on awakening, how does one give rise to that mind? Through the condition of what thing does a bodhisattva come to give rise to the mind set on awakening?"

"Son of good family, when a bodhisattva great being first gives rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he makes this great pledge: 'When I attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I vow that, for the benefit and happiness of all beings, I will surely establish all beings in great nirvāṇa.' Further, he should vow to bring all beings to complete the Perfection of Wisdom.

"That is called accomplishing one's own benefit and the benefit of others. Therefore, having first given rise to the mind set on awakening, he is called one who possesses the cause of awakening. He is called one who possesses the cause of beings. He is called one who possesses the cause of the true goal. He is called one who possesses the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening. He is called the basis that gathers all virtuous qualities. Therefore a bodhisattva is called virtuous. He is called greatly virtuous, and he is also called the root of virtue of all beings. He is called the one who purifies the actions of body, speech and mind of all beings. Because he has purified the three evil kinds of action, no aspiration in the world surpasses giving rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening: it is the supreme, holy, unsurpassed aspiration.

"When a bodhisattva great being first gives rise to the mind set on awakening, he should be endowed with five things. What are the five? Nature, conduct, sphere of activity, qualities, and generation."

"When a bodhisattva gives rise to the mind set on awakening in this way, he is called a bodhisattva great being, and he will without doubt attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and come to practice the Great Vehicle. Therefore, by first giving rise to the mind set on awakening, he gathers all virtuous qualities. Having given rise to the mind set on awakening, a bodhisattva great being attains unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in accordance with how he practices. If he does not give rise to the mind set on awakening, he will never attain awakening. Therefore, when he gives rise to the mind set on awakening, he obtains the foundation of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"When a bodhisattva great being sees beings tormented by suffering, a mind of love and compassion arises in him. Therefore a bodhisattva, with the mind of love and compassion as the cause, gives rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. By the cause of giving rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he accomplishes the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening. By the cause of accomplishing the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening, he attains unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Therefore giving rise to the mind set on awakening is called the foundation, or the root.

"By giving rise to the mind set on awakening he comes to practice the moral discipline of a bodhisattva; therefore giving rise to the mind set on awakening is called the root. It is also called the limb, the gathering, the sequence, and the seed.

"The bodhisattva's giving rise to the mind set on awakening may also be carried through to the end or not carried through to the end. When he brings it all the way to the attainment of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, it is carried through to the end, since he never turns back or slackens. What is not carried through to the end turns back and declines. Turning back is of two kinds: turning back in the end, and not turning back in the end. Turning back in the end is being unable to accomplish or to practice earnestly whatever qualities keep one from turning back from the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Not turning back in the end is, having given rise to the mind set on awakening, accomplishing and earnestly practicing whatever qualities there are.

"The conduct of a bodhisattva is of four kinds. When any son or daughter of good family hears of or sees the inconceivable things that buddhas or

bodhisattvas do for others, at that time a mind of faith and aspiration arises, and he thinks, 'The things the buddhas and bodhisattvas do for others are inconceivable. Since those inconceivable things that the buddhas and bodhisattvas do for others can be attained, I shall attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.' Therefore he keeps awakening in mind single-pointedly and gives rise to the mind set on awakening.

"Some, though they have not seen the inconceivable things that buddhas and bodhisattvas do for others, merely by hearing the essence of what the buddhas and bodhisattvas have taught with intent, give rise to a mind of faith and aspiration; and with faith arisen, they give rise to the mind set on awakening in order to attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and omniscience.

"Some, though they have neither seen the inconceivable things that buddhas and bodhisattvas do for others nor heard the Dharma they have taught with intent, see that the holy Dharma is about to perish. They think, 'This unsurpassed Dharma of the Buddha, which pacifies the countless afflictions of beings and serves their happiness and benefit, is kept abiding long and from declining only by the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Now I too shall give rise to the mind set on awakening, and in order to remove completely the afflictions of all beings, even if this body of mine undergoes great suffering, I shall make the Buddha's Dharma abide long in the world.' Thinking this, they give rise to the mind set on awakening.

"Some, though they do not see the Buddha's Dharma perishing, see that the beings of this evil age have extremely heavy afflictions: desire, aversion and delusion, shamelessness and lack of conscience, avarice, envy, anger, quarrelsomeness, lack of faith, doubt, laziness and other such afflictive states. They think, 'Because the age is so very evil, these beings do not practice virtue. If, the age being so evil, they cannot even give rise to the mind of the two vehicles, what need is there to speak of giving rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening?' Thinking this, they give rise to the mind set on awakening. Having given rise to the mind set on awakening in this way, they strive to bring all beings too to give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Then the bodhisattva King of Joy said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if it is said that for a bodhisattva knowing kindness is giving rise oneself to the mind set on awakening, and that for a bodhisattva repaying kindness is

leading other beings to give rise to the mind set on awakening, then when the Tathāgata was formerly wandering in saṃsāra, by what cause did he first give rise to the mind set on awakening?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, in the past, for countless eons, while wandering in saṃsāra through birth and death, because of great afflicted actions of body, speech and mind I experienced the eight great hells, namely: the Ahaha hell, the Alala hell, the Achacha hell, the Copper Cauldron hell, the Great Copper Cauldron hell, the Black Stone hell, the Great Black Stone hell, and on to the Fire Chariot hell.

"At that time I had fallen into the Fire Chariot hell, and we were made to pull a chariot of fire, one or two of us together. The hell guardian Abang sat upon the chariot, eyes glaring and teeth bared, breathing out fire. Flames blazed from his mouth, his eyes, his ears and his nose, and smoke billowed forth. That guardian's body was enormous and black. Sitting cross-legged on the chariot, he held an iron club in his hand and beat me with it. Then, unable to bear the pain, I pulled the chariot with all the strength I had. One of my companions was weak and could not pull, so the hell guardian Abang took up an iron trident and drove it into his chest, and beat him with an iron hammer, so that blood fell like rain. Then that man, unable to bear the pain, let out great cries of agony; at times he called out, 'Father! Mother!' and at times he called, 'Wife! Child!' But it was of no use.

"At that time, seeing him undergo such great suffering, a mind of compassion arose in me. Through the condition of that great mind of compassion arising, I came to give rise to the mind set on awakening. Then, for the sake of the one undergoing that suffering, I pleaded with the hell guardian Abang, 'Have a little compassion for this man who is suffering!' The hell guardian flew into a rage and, with a mind of aversion arisen, took up the iron trident and drove it into my neck. I died there, and so I was freed from the Fire Chariot hell, and the unwholesome evil of some hundred eons was purified. In this way, because I gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I was freed from the Fire Chariot hell."

The Blessed One said to the King of Joy, "The one who pulled the fire chariot at that time is I myself now. Because I gave rise to the mind set on awakening, I swiftly attained buddhahood. Therefore, the grounds on which all sentient beings give rise to the mind set on awakening are not just one. For some it arises through the condition of compassion. For some it arises through the

condition of aversion. For some it arises through the condition of generosity. For some it arises through the condition of avarice. For some it arises through the condition of joy. For some it arises through the condition of sorrow. For some it arises through the condition of being parted from what they desire. For some it arises through the condition of meeting a hated enemy. For some it arises through the condition of relying on a spiritual friend. For some it arises through the condition of an unwholesome friend. For some it arises through the condition of seeing a buddha. For some it arises through the condition of hearing the Dharma. Thus the ways in which sentient beings give rise to the mind set on awakening differ from one another in this way. King of Joy, the matter of how bodhisattva great beings know kindness and repay kindness should be understood in this way."

When this Dharma was taught, some hundreds of thousands of myriads of people gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Among that great assembly, some attained the fruit of stream entry, and so on up to the fruit of arhatship. Gods, nāgas, hungry ghosts, humans, nonhumans and all the rest set their minds on becoming śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Greatly rejoicing at having heard the Dharma, they bowed their heads, circumambulated keeping him to their right, and departed.

This concludes the fourth chapter, called Giving Rise to the Mind Set on Awakening, from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness, fascicle three.

At that time, for the sake of his mother Māyā and the gods, the Tathāgata had gone to teach the Dharma to the gods for ninety days, and for those ninety days the people of Jambudvīpa did not know where the Tathāgata was staying. Even the great Maudgalyāyana, who was supreme in miraculous powers, searched in the ten directions, exerting his miraculous might, yet he did not find out. Even one such as the noble Near Protector, with his supreme divine eye, looked throughout the worlds of the great trichiliocosm in all ten directions, yet did not see him. Likewise, all the noble ones, down to the retinue of five hundred, searched, yet did not see him. Not seeing the Tathāgata in this way, they were unhappy, and their minds were tormented with sorrow.

At that time King Udayana, not seeing the Tathāgata, grew unhappy, and in order to remember the Tathāgata he made an image of the Tathāgata from

oxhead sandalwood. He bowed before it and made offerings to it, and he made those offerings imagining that the Tathāgata was present before him in person.

At that time the great king summoned the six teachers of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and asked, "Where is the Tathāgata staying now?" The six teachers said this to the king: "Great king, do you not know? The śramaṇa Gautama is a conjurer; that is what he is like. The illusions of a conjurer have no true reality. Our treatises explain, 'In a thousand or two thousand years an illusory conjurer will appear,' and so the śramaṇa Gautama is just that illusion."

Then the noble Near Protector went to where the great king was, and said this to the king: "Great king, do you know? Seven days from now the Tathāgata will come from the heaven of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa."

When the king heard him say this, his mind was filled with great joy. He gathered the people of the land, and they sprinkled water and swept. They laid out incense and flowers, hung silk streamers, banners and parasols, and set out and arranged many kinds of food, music and every sort of offering article. The six teachers of the non-Buddhists came there and asked, "These many kinds of offering articles that you have set out and arranged like this, are they to invite a king? Or are they to invite a prince?" When the people said, "It is not that," they asked, "Then are you summoning a great minister? Are you summoning a brahmin or a householder? If not that, are you holding a feast for your relatives and friends?" The people said, "It is not that. We are inviting the Buddha, the Blessed One, to come."

The six teachers asked, "Who is this one called the Buddha?"

They answered, "He is the Omniscient One."

"And who is this one called the Omniscient One?"

They answered, "He is the father of loving-kindness and great compassion. Do you not know? The lineage of King Śuddhodana is high, noble and supreme. From the very beginning, from the first eon, a single son of the chief queen has carried on the line and become a universal monarch. In between, for two generations, they did not become universal monarchs, yet they were kings of Jambudvīpa. That king had three sons. The eldest was called King Śuddhodana; the middle one was called Droṇodana; and the youngest was called Amṛtodana. King Śuddhodana had two sons: the elder was called Siddhārtha and the younger son was called Nanda. King Droṇodana had two

sons: the elder was called Devadatta and the younger son was Ānanda. King Amṛtodana had one daughter, a girl called Taste of Nectar.

"At that time the eldest of the brothers, Prince Siddhārtha, went out beyond the palace to stroll and to see the sights, and there he saw old age, sickness and death. He became unhappy and would not even eat his food. Moved by a mind of compassion, he fell to reflecting, and thought, 'Among those born as human beings there is no high or low: all who have taken on a body have such sickness and faults as these, and not a single one escapes them.' At night he fled the palace, and for six years he practiced austerities at the foot of the tree of awakening. He became the one called the Omniscient One: he awakened fully as one possessed of the wisdom of omniscience. Endowed with the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses and the eighteen unshared qualities, he became the one called the Omniscient One. Seven days after he was born, his mother Māyā passed away and was reborn among the gods of the heaven of the Thirty-Three. For ninety days he has been teaching the Dharma to his mother, and seven days from now he will come to Jambudvīpa."

When the six teachers of the non-Buddhists heard this said, jealousy arose in them, and tormented by a bitter, joyless sorrow, the six teachers and their followers sat down together and deliberated as follows: "If the śramaṇa Gautama comes here to Jambudvīpa, all the people will abandon us and make offerings to the śramaṇa Gautama instead, and we shall be ruined and destitute, and our very lives will be at stake."

When they had deliberated in this way, the six teachers of the non-Buddhists further thought, "Let us go quickly to the place where many people gather, and proclaim this among the crowd."

So they proclaimed: "Let everyone know this! The śramaṇa Gautama in truth knows nothing at all. As a little boy he left the palace of the Śākyas all alone, and sitting and sitting at the foot of the tree of awakening, he declares, 'I have attained the wisdom of omniscience.' Those words are false, not true. Why is that? King Agnidatta invited him to receive alms, and then gave him nothing but horse fodder and treated him badly; yet he did not know this beforehand and went there, so he is not omniscient. Moreover, when he asked Ānanda, 'How many days from now until the observance begins?' Ānanda said, 'Seven days remain.' And again, when he asked Ānanda, 'Why are so many birds chattering in the park?' Ānanda said, 'Because the many birds are looking for food.' Seven days after he was born his mother also died, and putting all this

together, he is not omniscient.

"He is inauspicious and exceedingly sinful. How is that evident? As soon as he was born, his mother died. Again, a son ought to serve his father, yet instead of serving him he went off to the mountains, so he does not know kindness. His father the king took the queen Prajāpatī for him, yet he did not treat her as a wife, and made the queen Prajāpatī undergo great suffering, so he neither knows nor remembers kindness.

"The following of the śramaṇa Gautama makes no distinction between good and bad. Each of his five hundred disciples says, 'I am the foremost.' Since the preceptor himself has no proper system of Dharma, the disciples too have no system of Dharma or proper conduct. Even the lowliest, such as the monk Dravya, a man who lays out seats, says, 'I am the foremost of all.' Someone such as Śāriputra, upright of mind, great in wisdom and foremost in sharpness of intellect, is there; and the monk Panthaka, dull of wisdom and without understanding, is also admitted. The lowly nun Yaśodharā, of little desire, is also admitted. In Śrāvastī, the wicked courtesan Utpalavarṇā is also admitted. The lowly Cunda, a feeble and ignorant child, is also admitted. Among them, a decrepit old man called Subhadra, a hundred and twenty years old, is also admitted. The Śākyas, of great and noble lineage, are also admitted. And in Śrāvastī, a man of low caste, a sweeper who carries away refuse, is also admitted. Therefore the Dharma of the śramaṇa Gautama gathers a crowd with no distinction between good and bad, and it is neither worthy of offerings nor a proper object of honor and respect. Just as, when a great wind rises, all the leaves and petals of the trees are blown away together, so too is the Dharma of the Buddha. Just as many birds gather around food or scraps thrown out by people, so too is the following of the śramaṇa Gautama: they take whatever they get and eat it. So why do you all intend to make offerings to the śramaṇa Gautama?"

At that time, although the many people heard them say this, their minds, devoted and bowing to the Tathāgata as one tormented by thirst longs for water, did not waver, just as the great earth cannot be shaken.

The minds of the great crowd did not waver at the words spoken by the six teachers of the non-Buddhists; they became as firm as a vajra, neither increasing nor diminishing, and with devotion and faith, like one tormented by thirst, toward the Tathāgata, they waited until seven days had passed. Then the Tathāgata came back from the heaven of the Thirty-Three to Jambudvīpa.

He was surrounded by countless hundreds of thousands of gods in his retinue, and illuminated everything with the light rays of the Tathāgata, and was honored with hundreds of immeasurable divine musical offerings. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, and so on down to humans and nonhumans, all gathered, bowed to him and made offerings. At that time King Udayana too, together with his retinue, went out from afar to meet the Tathāgata, bowed his head at the feet of the Tathāgata, and sat down to one side.

Then the six teachers of the non-Buddhists also gathered to one side, and this thought came to them: "The one we call our bane has come here. Although we proclaimed what we did among the crowd, it did nothing to sway their belief. Now, even if we proclaim it amid the assembly of gods and humans, it will make no difference." Having thought this, the six teachers of the non-Buddhists, leading some hundred thousand followers, came into the midst of the great assembly and sat down to one side.

At that time a gandharva youth called Garland of Dharma, carrying a lute made of the seven precious substances, came to where the Tathāgata was, bowed his head at his feet, and sat down to one side. Seated there to one side, he played music accompanied by song, and the exceedingly sweet sound of that music delighted the minds of the whole assembly. Even śrāvakas such as Śāriputra, without realizing it, began to sway and move their bodies as if dancing, and even Mount Meru, king of mountains, trembled and shook.

At that time the Tathāgata entered the samādhi called Possessing Signs, and through the power of that samādhi the sound of the lute resounded throughout the worlds of the great trichiliocosm. From the sound of the lute came forth the sounds of suffering, emptiness, impermanence, impurity and no-self. And from that music all sentient beings heard resound the sounds of recognizing the kindness of the Tathāgata, of repaying that kindness, and of serving one's father and mother through immeasurable, countless eons. All the beings who heard that sound came to Jambudvīpa, to where the Buddha was, bowed their heads at his feet, and sat down to one side.

At that time, while the Tathāgata remained in samādhi, the great assembly sat gazing at the Tathāgata without blinking, and without saying a word. Then, in the very midst of the circle of the assembly, a stūpa made of the seven precious substances, adorned with countless victory banners and pennants, hung with hundreds of thousands of precious bells that rang out most sweetly

when stirred by the wind, emerged from within the earth, rose into the sky, and remained there.

At that time the whole great assembly was filled with doubt about the precious stūpa that had come forth from the earth. They wondered, "Through what cause and what condition has a precious stūpa such as this come forth from the earth?" Śāriputra and the others searched with all the power of their understanding, yet did not comprehend it. Even the bodhisattva great beings dwelling in the Sahā world itself, up to Maitreya, did not comprehend it.

Then the six teachers of the non-Buddhists thought, "Through what cause and what condition has a precious stūpa such as this appeared? If someone else should ask us, and we do not know, how could we be called all-seeing and all-knowing? Now, what harm would there be if the śramaṇa Gautama quickly showed and explained it to the great assembly?"

Then the Blessed One arose from that samādhi, and Śakra, lord of the gods, together with the gods of the heaven of the Thirty-Three, set out a lion throne and spread it with divine cloth. Then the Tathāgata sat cross-legged on the lion throne, like Mount Meru, king of mountains, standing in the midst of the ocean.

At that time the bodhisattva Maitreya knew in his mind that the great assembly had fallen into doubt, and he too was in doubt. Not comprehending it, he rose from his seat, went over to where the Buddha was, bowed his head at his feet, and with palms joined in reverence he asked, "Blessed One, through what cause and what condition has a precious stūpa such as this appeared?"

The Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva Maitreya: "In the past, countless inconceivable eons ago and beyond, there appeared in the world a buddha called Vipaśyin, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, the Teacher and King, and he established countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of ordinary beings in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"After that buddha had passed into nirvāṇa, during the time when the semblance of the Dharma was being practiced, there was a land called Vārāṇasī. The great king of the land called Vārāṇasī was endowed with a wise intellect and always governed the land according to the righteous Dharma, so that the people too were happy and content. That great king held sway over

sixty vassal kingdoms, and although he had eight hundred cities, the king had no son. Because he had no son, for twelve years, without weariness or discouragement, he worshipped and served the gods of the world and all the gods, and so the chief queen conceived a son. When ten months were complete, she gave birth to a son. That son was lovely and handsome and perfectly endowed with the marks. As soon as he was born, the great ministers and the kings and vassal kings of the borderlands all assembled and examined the prince's marks, and they found that the prince by nature did not know anger and was virtuous; so they named him Prince Forbearance. When Prince Forbearance grew up, he delighted in giving gifts and was endowed with a wise intellect, and great compassion arose in him for the many sentient beings."

"At that time that great king had six great ministers who were angry by nature, who lived by deceit and guile, and who imposed punishments on the innocent; no one wanted them, and no one held them dear. Those six great ministers, knowing that they themselves were at fault, were constantly jealous, and they disliked the prince.

"At that time the great king was struck by a grave illness and tormented by it. He grew weak and emaciated and came close to death. Prince Forbearance asked the ministers, 'Is my father the king gravely ill? Will his life not be cut short?' The ministers, angered, said to the prince, 'The king's life will not last long. Why is that? Because good medicine cannot be found, and therefore his life will not last long.' When the prince heard them say this, his mind became deeply unhappy; he fainted and fell to the ground.

"The six great ministers went to a secluded place and deliberated as follows. They thought and deliberated, 'Unless we do away with this Prince Forbearance, we shall never be at ease.' One minister said, 'If this prince has no fault at all, how can we do away with him?' Another minister said, 'I have a means of doing away with the prince.' Having said this, he went to where the prince was and said this to the prince: 'We have searched for medicine in the lands of the sixty vassal kingdoms of the borderlands and in the eight hundred cities, but we have not found it.'

"The prince said, 'What is needed for the king's medicine, that it cannot be found?'

"The minister said, 'Does the prince know? What is precious as medicine for the king is the eyeballs and the marrow of a person who, from the time of first

being born until the last, has never known anger. If such medicine is found, the king will live; if it is not found, he will not live. But such a thing has not been found anywhere.'

"When the prince heard him say this, he was unhappy, and sorrow arose in his mind, and he said to the ministers, 'I myself am such a one now. Why is that? From the time I was first born until now, I have never experienced anger.'

"The minister said, 'Even if the prince is such a one, this is an extremely difficult thing to do. Why is that? Because in the world there is nothing one holds dearer than one's own body.'

"The prince said, 'Minister, it is not as you say. If my father the king could live and recover from his illness, I could give up even a hundred thousand bodies; it would not be hard. What need is there then to speak of giving up this impure body of mine?'

"The minister said, 'Such matters are for the prince to do as he sees fit.'

"Then Prince Forbearance was overjoyed, and joy arose in his mind. Thinking, 'If this medicine will cure my father the king's illness, the time has come to act quickly,' he went into the palace, came before his mother, bowed his head at his mother's feet, and with palms joined in reverence he said this to his mother: 'Now I am to divide up this body of mine as medicine for my father the king. Since I fear I may not survive, I have come to bow to you, mother, in farewell. Mother, please do not be unhappy.'

"When his mother heard him say this, she fainted, and lost all sense of direction. Terrified, like a choking person who can neither swallow nor vomit, she took the prince onto her lap and fell to the ground. Then cold water was sprinkled on her face, and after a long while she came to again. The prince said this to his mother once more: 'My father the king's life will not last long. I shall quickly accomplish this aim of mine and keep the king alive.'

"Then Prince Forbearance said to the ministers, the vassal kings and the many in the retinue, 'I am going; I bow to you in farewell.'

"At that time the great minister summoned a low-caste butcher, and he broke the prince's bones, extracted the marrow, and gouged out the eyeballs of both his eyes as well. Then those ministers pounded and compounded those medicines and gave them to the king. The great king ate the medicine, and his illness was cured.

"When the king's illness was cured, he said to the ministers, 'Where did you find such good medicine, which cured my illness and saved my life?'

"The ministers replied, 'This medicine was provided by Prince Forbearance. It was not we who found and prepared it.'

"When the king heard them say this, he was shocked and collapsed, and the hair on his body stood on end. Softly he asked the ministers, 'Where is Prince Forbearance now?'

"The minister replied, 'Prince Forbearance is now outside, having his wounds tended, and we fear he will not survive.'

"When the king heard these words, he let out a great cry, saying, 'Alas! Alas!' He flung himself to the ground, so that his body was covered with earth and dust, and said, 'I am truly shameless! Why did I eat my son's flesh as medicine?' Having said this, he set out to where his son was, but before he arrived the prince had passed away.

"The king, the queen, the ministers and the whole great retinue gathered around him, and his mother flung herself upon the prince's corpse and lamented, 'What evil did I do in the past, that this son of mine should undergo such suffering? It would have been easier had this body of mine been ground to dust. Why has this son of mine died?'

"Then the father, the king, and the vassal kings heaped up fragrant oxhead sandalwood and cremated the prince's corpse. They gathered the prince's bones and built a stūpa of the seven precious substances."

At that time the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva Maitreya: "Sons of good family, understand this. If you think that the great king of Vārāṇasī at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so. The king at that time, on that occasion, is now my father, King Śuddhodana. If you think that the queen at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so: the queen at that time, on that occasion, is now my mother Māyā. Prince Forbearance at that time, on that occasion, is now I myself. For immeasurable, countless eons, in order to serve his father and mother, the bodhisattva gives clothing, food, drink, dwellings and bedding, and even the flesh, blood and marrow of his own body; and through that cause and that condition, he goes on until he attains full awakening."

"This precious stūpa that has now come forth from the earth is the one that, long ago, when I had given up my body, its marrow and even my life for the

sake of my father and mother, was built in this very place and honored with offerings. Now that I have attained full awakening, it has emerged and become visible."

At that time, when the great assembly of countless gods, nāgas, yakṣas, humans and others heard him say this, joy and sorrow arose in them mingled together. All of them shed tears, and with one voice they praised and extolled the hundreds of thousands of qualities of the Tathāgata, and at one and the same time they gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. In addition, some immeasurable hundreds of thousands of sentient beings set their minds on becoming śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Besides these, immeasurable numbers of other people attained the fruit of stream entry, and so on up to the fruit of arhatship. Moreover, some immeasurable hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattva great beings, before long, fully awakened in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Therefore the Tathāgata truly serves his father and mother.

Moreover, the bodhisattva knows the good qualities of his father and mother, and knows that it was through her former aspiration that his mother gave birth to the body of the Tathāgata. Thus, in order to fulfill the Tathāgata's aspiration, and because he did not wish his mother to bow down to him, she passed away.

At that time the whole great assembly said with one accord to his mother Māyā, "Excellent! Mother Māyā, it is most excellent that you gave birth to the Tathāgata, the teacher of gods and humans, who has no equal in the world."

Then the gandharva youth Garland of Dharma rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the Buddha, and said this to the Blessed One: "What merit did this mother Māyā make? Through what cause and what condition did she come to give birth to the Tathāgata?"

The Blessed One said, "Listen well, and bear it carefully in mind, and I shall explain it to you. In the past, countless inconceivable eons ago and beyond, there appeared in the world a buddha called Vipaśyin, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, the Teacher, the Victor.

"After the true Dharma of that buddha had declined, and even the period of practicing the semblance of the Dharma had declined, there was at that time, in the land called Vārāṇasī, a mountain called Abode of Noble Ones. On that mountain dwelt some hundred thousand of those called pratyekabuddhas. Countless sages endowed with the five superknowledges also dwelt on that mountain. Because so many noble ones and sages dwelt there, that mountain was named Abode of Noble Ones.

"On that mountain one sage dwelt on the southern side of the mountain, and one sage dwelt on the northern side. Between the dwellings of those two sages there was a spring, and beside that spring there was a fine flat boulder. Then, on one occasion, the sage who dwelt on the southern slope of the mountain washed his clothes and his feet on that boulder and went back to his dwelling. Not long afterward, a doe came to the spring to drink. After drinking from the spring, she drank the water in which the sage had washed his clothes on the boulder. After drinking the water from the washing of the clothes, she turned around, looked behind her, and licked her genitals.

"Then the doe conceived a child in her womb, and when the months were complete, since by the way of wild animals they give birth in the very place where they first conceived, she came to the edge of the spring, and there on the boulder, crying out and rolling about, she gave birth to a girl. At that time the sage of the southern slope heard the doe crying, and a mind of compassion arose in him. He went over toward the doe and saw that a girl had been born to the doe, and the doe was licking her. When the sage arrived, the doe abandoned the child and went off.

"Then the sage, seeing that the girl born of the doe was beautiful and lovely and endowed with the marks, wrapped her in a garment of grass out of compassion, took her up in his arms, and came back to his dwelling. He gathered fruits and berries and fed and raised her, and gradually she grew up, until she reached fourteen years of age. The sage, too, loved the girl dearly, and had her tend the fire constantly, without ever letting it go out. But one day she was lazy and the fire went out. The sage scolded her in words: 'From the time I first raised you until now, the fire has never gone out. Why did you let the fire die?' And he sent her to the sage dwelling on the northern slope of the mountain to fetch fire.

"Then the girl, as her father had instructed, went toward the northern slope of the mountain, and at every single step a lotus sprang up from beneath her

feet. Following her footsteps, lotuses sprang up in an even row, and so she went to the northern slope of the mountain to fetch fire. At that time, when that sage saw that the girl was greatly endowed with merit and that lotuses sprang up from beneath her feet, he said this to the girl: 'If you want fire, circle this hut of mine seven times, with your steps even and at a proper distance, so that lotuses spring up beneath your steps.' When she had circled it seven times in this way, he instructed the girl again: 'If you want fire, circle once more, keeping it to your right, and then go, and I shall give you fire.' At that time, because the girl wanted the fire, she did as the sage instructed, took the fire, and went back.

"Not long after the girl had gone back, the king of the land of Vārāṇasī, with his great ministers and a retinue of some hundred thousand, came to that mountain to stroll and to hunt wild animals. Then the king of Vārāṇasī, riding his royal elephant, came to where the sage of the northern slope of the mountain was. When he arrived there and saw the sage's hut ringed all around with lotuses, a mind of great delight arose in him, and he praised the great sage, saying, 'Excellent, most excellent! Virtuous indeed is the sage endowed with great qualities, endowed with the qualities of teaching and guiding!'"

Then the sage said to the king, "Great king, you should know that these lotuses are not my own power." The king said, "Then who made them?" The sage replied, "Great king, the sage who dwells on the southern slope of the mountain has a daughter, born of a deer, fair of face and lovely, endowed with the marks of a human being, rare in the world, and wherever she walks lotuses spring up beneath her feet."

When the king heard him say this, his mind was filled with delight, and he went over to where the sage of the southern slope of the mountain was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at that sage's feet. The sage came out to the door, welcomed him, and asked, "Great king, having come from so far away, are you not very weary?" Then the great king spoke to the sage: "Venerable one, you have a daughter, and I wish to take her in marriage." The sage said, "Great king, I am poor and have only one daughter. She is young and knows nothing at all. Since she has been raised on the mountain from childhood, she understands nothing of the ways of human beings; she eats nothing but the roots of grasses and fruits. How could she be fit to be offered to the king? Moreover, this girl was born of a deer and is not fit to be offered." And so he went on, telling the king in detail the whole story of how it had come about.

The king said, "Even so, that is no matter. Show me where she is." The sage said, "She is in the hut right now." Then the great king went into the hut and looked at the girl, and a mind of great delight arose in him. He had the deer girl bathed in scented water, dressed her in priceless garments, adorned her with all kinds of jeweled ornaments, and set her upon the royal elephant. Then, surrounded by a retinue of some hundred thousand, with music playing, he returned to his own land.

At that time the deer girl, who since her birth had never seen so many people, was alarmed and afraid. Then the sage climbed to the top of a high mountain and gazed at the girl without blinking, thinking, "Now my daughter is going farther and farther away; once she is out of sight, I shall go back home." With tears streaming from his eyes he thought, "This daughter whom I raised has left me, knowing nothing at all." Then again he thought, "I shall not move from this place yet. Why is that? If my daughter should turn back to look at me and not see me, she would be unhappy and tormented by suffering. For now I shall stay right here." So he stayed on for a long while, watching until she was out of sight, but the girl never looked back.

Because the girl did not look back, anger arose in the sage, and he said, "Born of an animal after all, she did not even look back at me! I raised her and raised her from when she was little, and now that she has become a human being the king has carried her off, and I am left forlorn." Then he went into his hut and worked a spell, laying this curse on her by the mantra: "If the king casts her off, then let that be the end of it. But if he cherishes her and does not cast her off, may things not turn out as he wishes!"

At that time the great king of Vārāṇasī, having reached his palace, cherished her and gave her the name Queen Deer Lady. The lesser kings of the borderlands and the ministers gathered together and praised the king with pleasing words, and the king was filled with delight. Not long afterward she conceived a child in her womb, and the king himself waited upon the queen, providing her with bedding, food, drink and the like, all fine and soft. Then, when the ten months were complete, though he had hoped she would bear a son to carry on the king's lineage, when the months were complete she gave birth to a lotus. Through the power of the sage's spell the king became angry and said, "So it is true that she was born of an animal!" He removed her from the rank of queen and had the lotus thrown away.

Then, after a long time had passed, the king went with the ministers of Vārāṇasī to the pleasure garden to watch the spectacles and amuse themselves. Playing and making music, they set horses and elephants to fight, and had the wrestlers contend in strength. Among the wrestlers was one of the very greatest strength, and when he stamped his foot on the ground, the earth shook, and a lotus pond close by shook as well. Near that lotus pond there was a boulder, and beneath it lay a lotus, which tumbled into the pond. The lotus that fell into the pond was of the finest color, its hue clear and vivid, glowing with a shining light. When the king saw it, his mind was filled with delight, and he said to the ministers, "Never before have I seen a lotus like this!"

Then he gave the order, "Take that lotus out of the water," and sent someone to fetch it. That lotus had five hundred petals, and beneath each and every petal was seen a young boy, fair of face, beautiful, and surpassing ordinary people. The man who went to fetch the lotus, seeing such great wonders in it, said, "Great king, that lotus has five hundred petals, and beneath each petal is a son of the gods." When the king heard these words he was so startled that every hair of his body stood on end, and he said to the man, "Is this really true?" Wondering, "Is this the very lotus that Queen Deer Lady bore?" he asked the queen, "Where did you throw the lotus that you bore?" The queen answered, "Great king, I hid that lotus beneath a boulder on the bank of the pond." Then, convinced that it was indeed the one Queen Deer Lady had borne, he came back into the palace.

Having returned to the palace, he said to Queen Deer Lady, "I am deluded and without understanding; I could not tell the wise from the foolish. Thinking that what was said of the queen must be true, I went against the queen's heart, and I confess it." And he installed her once again as chief queen. Then the king, overjoyed, gathered together all the ministers, the brahmins, the lesser kings and the readers of marks, took the five hundred princes upon his lap, and had the readers of marks examine their marks, good and bad.

The readers of marks said, "These princes have come about through the king's merit and power. If they remain in the household life, the four borderlands will submit of their own accord, and even the gods will follow their lead. If they go forth, they will without doubt cut the root of birth and death, be freed from the river of desire, and cross to the far shore of the ocean of saṃsāra; they will be endowed with the three knowledges and the six superknowledges, and will attain the four fruits of the ascetic life."

When the king heard these words he was all the more delighted, and he gathered five hundred nurses to rear the five hundred princes. Then Queen Deer Lady said to the king, "Great king, there is no need to gather nurses from all over the realm. At present there are five hundred queens in the king's palace, and because I have sons, those queens are all jealous of me. Now if the king has each queen rear one prince, the princes will be reared."

The king said to the queen, "Since the five hundred queens are jealous of you, my queen, I would do as you wish even to the point of rebuking them, beating them, rejecting them, banishing them, or putting them to death. Why then would you take on something so very hard to bear toward those who have become your enemies, and think of giving my sons, more precious than anything between heaven and earth, to those queens?" At that time the five hundred queens heard her speak as she had, and they were overjoyed and said, "Queen Deer Lady has always granted us ease and happiness, and now she has given us her sons as well; we are overjoyed." At that time a retinue of some hundred thousand also heard these words, and a mind of great joy arose in them, and they generated the mind set on awakening.

Then the great king said to the queen, "This is a great wonder. I could not do as much as you." The queen said, "Through the force of jealousy, anger arises. As the antidote to wrongdoing one should cultivate patience, and as the antidote to wrath one must generate a mind of loving kindness. From the very beginning I have never quarreled with anyone over anything; the queens have only been harming and injuring themselves. It is like a man walking along at night who sees a log and takes it to be an enemy or a hungry ghost, and at once, terrified, he flees. Fleeing into the darkness, some fall from a high cliff into a chasm; some fall into water, or fire, or a heap of thorns, or a thicket, and their bodies are wounded and broken. So it is that, through the condition of a mistaken perception, they meet with such harm. In the same way, all sentient beings are born by themselves and die by themselves, like a silkworm, or a moth that flies into a flame; no one else brought it upon them. All faults arise from perceiving what is untrue. The queens too are like that, and so I take no notice of it, and have no quarrel at all with anyone."

The five hundred queens bowed to Queen Deer Lady, confessed their own wrongs, and served and attended upon Queen Deer Lady, regarding her as a mother or as a daughter. And they reared and cared for the princes as if they were their own sons.

Then the five hundred princes gradually grew up, and each prince had the might and strength of a thousand men. If any lesser kings of the borderlands rebelled and would not obey the king's command, there was no need for the fourfold army: the princes themselves would go out to attack and subdue them. At that time the land was peaceful and happy, and the guardian gods were pleased, so that wind and rain rose and fell in their proper seasons, and the people lived at leisure in comfort and happiness. The five hundred princes rode on fine elephants and played and amused themselves in the pleasure garden as they pleased, and their father and mother loved them, cherishing them like the apples of their eyes.

At that time the five hundred princes had grown up and come into their full strength. Later, on another occasion, they all gathered and sat on the bank of that lotus pond, and as they sat there, each one's reflection appeared in the water of the pond, and they said to one another, "It is like this: all phenomena are like an illusion, or a magical emanation, or a dream, or a reflection in water; there is nothing true or real in them. We too are now just like that. Though we are of great and noble lineage, live within the palace, and enjoy the five sense pleasures heedlessly, the years of our prime and our good looks cannot be relied upon. Whatever has come into being will perish; whatever is born will die. Youth and the prime of life do not last long, but turn to old age and decline. If one does not keep to moderation in food, one falls sick. Even if one lives a hundred years, in the end one must die." So the princes were overcome by a joyless sorrow.

Wanting neither food nor drink, they went back to the palace and said to their father the king, "The world is suffering; there is no happiness in it. Therefore, father, king, we ask to go forth." The king said to the princes, "Birth, aging, sickness and death are the same for everyone, so why should you alone grieve over them?" The princes replied, "We cannot bear the affliction of taking birth again and again after death, and of going on and on among the five destinies." Then the king, not opposing the princes' wishes, gave them leave to go forth.

The queen said to the princes, "When you have gone forth, do not abandon me and go far away. Behind the palace there is a pleasure garden that is very secluded, and its trees and groves are secluded too. Stay there, and I shall offer you the four requisites so that you will not be troubled by want." The princes went forth and, as the queen had asked, stayed in the pleasure garden behind the palace, and there every one of those princes, one after another, attained the awakening of a pratyekabuddha.

In this way four hundred and ninety-nine princes in turn went forth and attained the fruit of solitary awakening. Then they came to the king's palace and said to their father the king and to their mother, "We have attained the aim for which we went forth." Then those monks rose up into the sky above. When they vanished in the east, they appeared in the west; when they vanished in the west, they appeared in the east; when they vanished in the south, they appeared in the north; when they vanished in the north, they appeared in the south. At times, with an immense body, they filled the whole expanse of space; at times, from one body they emanated countless bodies; at times, water streamed from the upper part of the body while fire blazed from the lower part. Having displayed many kinds of miracles such as these, they set their bodies ablaze and passed into nirvāṇa. Then Queen Deer Lady gathered their relics, built four hundred and ninety-nine stūpas in the pleasure garden behind the palace, and made offerings to them.

The youngest of the princes, too, attained the awakening of a pratyekabuddha after ninety days had passed, and he too displayed great miracles to his father and mother. Having displayed great miracles, he passed into nirvāṇa. Then Queen Deer Lady gathered his relics, built a stūpa, and made offerings to it.

At that time Queen Deer Lady made offerings every day to the stūpas of the five hundred pratyekabuddhas with the finest incense, the finest flowers, and all kinds of music, and before those stūpas she grieved, unhappy, and said, "I bore five hundred sons, and they went forth, yet not even one of them generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening." And so she made this aspiration: "Whatever merit there is in my having made offerings to the five hundred pratyekabuddhas, building five hundred stūpas and making offerings to their relics, I dedicate to all sentient beings. In time to come, I do not wish to bear many sons who do not generate the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. Rather, may I bear a single son who generates the mind set on unsurpassed awakening, goes forth in that very life, and comes to possess the wisdom of omniscience!" Such was the aspiration she made.

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "If you should think that Queen Deer Lady at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not see it that way. Queen Deer Lady at that time, on that occasion, is none other than my present mother, Māyā. Because Queen Māyā made offerings in this way to the five hundred pratyekabuddhas and generated countless roots of virtue, she has now given birth to the body of the Tathāgata."

When this Dharma of the Buddha was taught, countless gods and humans attained the fruits, from the first fruit up to the fourth, and immeasurable numbers of sentient beings generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then Ānanda said to the Blessed One, "What deed did Queen Māyā do in the past, that she was born among animals, of an animal, and became the daughter of a deer?" The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen well. I shall unravel and explain to you the causes and conditions of the deeds Queen Māyā did in times past.

"Long ago in the past, countless, immeasurable eons ago, at that time, on that occasion, there appeared in the world a buddha, a blessed one called Vipaśyin, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, the Teacher, the Victor. After he had worked for the benefit of sentient beings and passed into nirvāṇa, while the Dharma was being practiced in his semblance period, at that time, on that occasion, in the land called Vārāṇasī, a certain brahmin had an only daughter, and then that brahmin died. The brahmin's wife raised the girl, and the girl gradually grew up.

"Mother and daughter had an orchard of fruit trees, and the mother had the girl guard the orchard. She herself went in search of food, and whatever she found she brought back and ate together with her daughter. While she was always seeking food in this way, one day she was late and the usual hour passed, and the girl, tormented by hunger and thirst, became angry. 'Whatever has happened to my mother,' she raged, 'that she has not given me food until so late, and has left me hungry and thirsty like this? My mother is not even as good as an animal! Even animals, beasts of prey, deer and birds, remember that their young are hungry and thirsty and come to feed them at the proper time.' So she spoke.

"Not long after she had said this, her mother came bringing food. While they were eating, the girl saw a pratyekabuddha in the guise of an ascetic passing through the sky from the south toward the north. A joyful mind toward that monk arose in her; she rose from where she sat, joined her palms, bowed her head, and invited him down. She spread out a clean seat, honored him with fine flowers, and, sharing out some of that food, offered it to the monk. When the monk had finished his meal, he taught the sublime Dharma and filled her

with delight and joy. At that time the girl made this aspiration: 'In time to come, may I meet with noble ones, and serve them, make offerings to them, and pay them homage! May I be fair of face and beautiful, great and powerful, and wherever I walk may lotuses spring up beneath my steps to bear up my feet!' Such was the aspiration she made."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The girl of that time, of that occasion, was Queen Deer Lady. Because she offered a single meal of alms to a pratyekabuddha in this way and honored him with fine flowers, for five hundred lifetimes she was great and powerful, had clothing and food as she wished, and lotuses sprang up beneath her feet. Through the power of her aspiration she has now also met with five hundred pratyekabuddhas, and made offerings to them, served them, and paid them homage. But because at that time, ungrateful for her mother's kindness, she spoke one harsh word, saying her mother was like an animal, through the condition of that evil verbal deed she was born for five hundred lifetimes from the womb of a deer."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Every fault of whoever is born in the world comes from their own mouth; therefore one should guard one's verbal actions. Verbal action is worse than being burned by a blazing fire. Being burned by a blazing fire lasts for only one life, but the blazing fire of nonvirtuous verbal action burns for countless births. A blazing fire burns only worldly wealth, but the blazing fire of nonvirtuous speech burns up the seven noble riches. Therefore, Ānanda, the faults of all sentient beings come from the mouth; the mouth and tongue are called the weapons that cut down the body."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, about a thousand laymen and laywomen, by guarding their actions, attained the first fruit. Countless gods and humans generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and others generated the resolve for everything down to the awakening of a pratyekabuddha. The whole great assembly rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said, bowed to him, and departed.

At that time the Blessed One and Ānanda, having received alms in Rājagṛha, were on their way back, and outside the city there was a deep ravine. The people of the city of Rājagṛha carried all their excrement, urine and filth to that ravine, and when it rained, the rainwater all drained into it as well. At that time, in the foul water of that ravine, a creature shaped like a human being but with many hands and feet saw the Tathāgata coming from afar. It raised its head out of the water, gazed at the Tathāgata, and tears flowed from its

eyes. When the Blessed One saw it, he was moved with compassion and saddened, and he went back to Vulture Peak. Then Ānanda spread out the Tathāgata's seat, and he sat down with his legs crossed.

Then Ānanda looked over the whole assembly, and knowing in his mind what the assembly was thinking, he said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, that creature in the foul water just now: what did it do in the past that it was born in that foul water? How long has it been since it was born there? And when will it ever be freed from it?" The Blessed One said to Ānanda and the great assembly, "Listen well. I shall unravel it well and explain it to you.

"Ānanda, long ago in the past, a thousand countless eons ago, at that time, on that occasion, a buddha appeared in the world, worked for the benefit of sentient beings, and passed completely into nirvāṇa. After he had passed into nirvāṇa, while the Dharma was being practiced in its semblance period, a certain brahmin built a dwelling for the Saṅgha and offered it to the Saṅgha. At that time a certain patron offered butter and sesame oil to the Saṅgha, and some visiting monks also arrived there. At that time a certain person who served as steward saw the visiting monks arrive and, being stingy, hid the butter and sesame oil away and mixed them up, and did not give them to the visiting monks. The visiting monks asked the steward, 'The butter, sesame oil and honey that came in, will you not give them to us?' The steward said, 'You are visitors; we are the residents.' The visiting monks said, 'Was it not offered by the patron to the Saṅgha present here?' At that the one serving as steward became angry and fearsome, and spoke harsh words to the visiting monks: 'Instead of eating excrement and urine, you want butter and sesame oil from me?'

"Through the deed of speaking those harsh words, for ninety koṭis of eons he has been born continually in this foul water. The one serving as steward at that time, on that occasion, is that creature living in the foul water just now. Thus because he once spoke harsh words to the Saṅgha in time past, he has been born in that place for a hundred thousand lifetimes counted one by one."

The Blessed One said to his disciples, "Restrain and guard your verbal actions. The faults of speech are worse than a blazing fire. Since parents and the Saṅgha are worthy of praise and acclaim, speak gently to them and always be mindful of their kindness. What is called the Saṅgha is the field of merit that brings one beyond the three realms. Parents are the supreme, sublime field of merit within the three realms. Why is that? Within the Saṅgha are the four

pairs and eight kinds of persons and the twelve noble ones; if one serves them one gains merit, and if one practices, awakening is accomplished. Parents keep a child in the womb for ten months, and once it is born, they leave it the dry and take the wet for themselves, and raise it with milk from the breast. After it is grown, they have it learn to be skilled in the sciences, and attend to it without ever missing the proper time. If the child goes forth, then by making merit it crosses the ocean of saṃsāra, of birth and death, and accomplishes its own aim and the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. Therefore, Ānanda, parents and the Saṅgha are called the two fields of merit for all sentient beings. Through them as conditions, gods and humans alike come to attain the sublime fruit of liberation, passing beyond sorrow, and even accomplish buddhahood."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, hundreds of thousands of immeasurable sentient beings, human and nonhuman, attained the fruits from the first up to the fourth. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and some set their minds on becoming śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas. Each of them joined their palms, bowed to the Buddha, circumambulated him, and departed full of joy.

Furthermore, in the land of Vārāṇasī there was a brahmin minister who was very wealthy, with many riches and precious things: gold, silver, beryl, crystal, coral and agate, and many elephants, horses, cattle and sheep, fields and pastures, servants and workers. When he was eighty years old a son was born to him. The boy was fair of face, lovely and beautiful, endowed with all the marks of a fine human being, so his father and mother were overjoyed, and they called a reader of marks to examine his marks.

When the reader of marks had examined his marks, they named the boy Cunda and raised him. When he had reached seven years of age, his father and mother, out of their great love, gave him leave to go forth. So that he could go forth, they took him to the mountain called Īśvara, where the Tathāgata was staying. At that time the Tathāgata, with the fourfold assembly, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas and others at their head, was teaching the great assembly both the worldly sciences and treatises and the Dharma that transcends the world.

Then that brahmin said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I am old and decrepit, and I have a son whom I offer to the Blessed One. I beg you, in your great compassion, to protect him and accept this son of mine as your disciple."

Then the Blessed One said, "Welcome!" and the boy's hair fell away of its own accord and the Dharma robes were on his body of themselves. He was encouraged and uplifted, a mind of delight and joy arose in him, and he attained the fruit of the path, coming to possess the three knowledges, the six superknowledges, and the eight liberations.

At that time Ānanda looked over the great assembly, and in order to resolve everyone's doubts he rose from his seat, set his robes in order, placed his upper robe over one shoulder, joined his palms, bowed, and said to the Blessed One, "What merit did the novice Cunda make in times past, that he has met the Blessed One here and so swiftly attained the fruit?" The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "It is not only in this present time. In times past too, the novice Cunda made supreme merit toward his parents and the Saṅgha, and so he met with a spiritual friend and attained the fruit of the path." Ānanda said, "Blessed One, please teach us that story." The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen well.

"Long ago in the past, a thousand immeasurable ages ago, a buddha, a blessed one called Vipaśyin, appeared in the world. Having worked for the benefit and happiness of gods and humans, he passed completely into nirvāṇa. After he had passed into nirvāṇa, there was a young monk who practiced the sublime Dharma. He was highly learned in the Mātṛkā, the Sūtras and the Vinaya, handsome and fine of form, endowed with the marks of a fine human being, and confident in teaching the Dharma. Because of the voice and the sweet words with which he spoke the Dharma, the kṣatriyas and brahmins were his friends, and they served him and made offerings to him.

"At that time there was also an old monk who was very ugly of face and not endowed with the marks of a fine human being, and whose voice was not pleasant, but who always praised the Three Jewels with words and chant. At that time the young monk, master of the three baskets, said to that monk with the unpleasant voice, 'Making such an unpleasant noise is like the howling of a wounded dog.' Then the old monk said to the young monk, 'What, do you not know me, that you speak harsh words to me?' The monk who was master of the three baskets said, 'I know you. You are the old monk called Mahala, who went forth in the sublime Dharma of the Buddha Vipaśyin. Why would I not know you?' The monk Mahala said, 'Now what was to be done has been done. The holy life has been lived. I shall not take up any further existence.'

"When the young monk, master of the three baskets, heard these words, his flesh crept and he was struck with alarm. Then the young monk lifted up the monk Mahala with his right hand, and from that hand Mahala sent forth a great light that illuminated the ten directions. Then the young monk, master of the three baskets, bowed his head at the old monk's feet, repented, and confessed and acknowledged his fault, saying, 'Veiled by the delusion of not knowing, I did not know that you were a noble one. May this evil deed done in ignorance not become a sin! In time to come, may I meet with a spiritual friend, meet with you, noble teacher, and bring my defilements to exhaustion!'"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Because at that time, on that occasion, that young monk, master of the three baskets, spoke one coarse word to the old monk, for five hundred lifetimes he experienced the body of a dog."

When the Blessed One had said this, the great assembly exclaimed, "How wonderful, how wonderful! In this world there is no supreme venom that exceeds verbal action!" And the whole great assembly made this vow in verse:

Though a burning wheel of iron
Should whirl unceasing on my crown,
I would not count it suffering;
I shall never speak a harsh word.
Though a burning wheel of iron
Should whirl unceasing on my head,
I would not count it suffering;
I shall speak no harsh word to the noble.

The Blessed One said, "Because Śāriputra has become the spiritual friend of many sentient beings, six times through the day and night he surveys and watches over the beings of the five destinies with his divine eye, and when the time for taming someone has come, he acts for that one's benefit.

"At that time five hundred merchants were constantly traveling back and forth between the land of Magadha and this land. Since the road they traveled back and forth was very dangerous, one merchant kept a white dog. At that time a companion of that merchant cooked some meat in the evening and set it aside, and in the latter part of the night the dog stole it and ate it. The next day at dawn, when the merchant's companion went to eat the meat and could not find it, he was vexed and angry. He took up a weapon, cut off the dog's four legs, threw it into a pit, and went on his way.

"In the first part of the night, Śāriputra, surveying everything with his divine eye, saw from afar the dog suffering great pain in the pit. Then the next day at dawn he put on his Dharma robes, took up his alms bowl, received alms in the city, and went to the pit on the dangerous road, where he fed the dog with the alms he had begged. Then he taught it a Dharma that brought delight and joy. When the dog heard that Dharma, it felt shame and remorse. Then, after seven days had passed, it cast off its evil karma, was freed, and was born as a human being."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The white dog of that time, on that occasion, is now this śramaṇa Cunda. In a past age, because he had spoken harsh words to a noble one, he was born in an unfortunate realm. Immediately he felt remorse, confessed, and a sense of shame arose in him, and he made the aspiration, 'In a future time, may I meet a spiritual friend!' Because he made that aspiration, he met a spiritual friend, his evil karma was purified, he was born as a human being, and by meeting a buddha he exhausted the defilements."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Keep in mind the kindness of your parents and of spiritual friends. Then, recognizing their kindness in this way, you should repay that kindness. What is called a spiritual friend is a cause that brings about benefit."

When he had said this, countless hundreds of thousands of beings generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and others generated the mind of śrāvakas and of pratyekabuddhas. The great assembly rejoiced greatly at what the Buddha had said, paid homage, and departed.

This concludes the fifth chapter, called "The Treatise," of The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness, fourth section.

At that time the fourfold assembly, placing the Blessed One before them, made offerings to him, served him, honored him, and praised him in words. Then the Tathāgata smiled, and from his mouth he sent forth rays of light, blue, yellow, red and white, called "great compassion." They illuminated the world systems of the ten directions, from the Peak of Existence down to the beings of the eighteen great hells. The light also illuminated the body of Devadatta, and Devadatta, who had been undergoing suffering, was made comfortable.

Then all the many members of the assembly praised the Tathāgata with one voice, saying, "Excellent, excellent! The Blessed One truly possesses great loving-kindness and great compassion; his mind is impartial toward enemy and friend alike. Although someone like Devadatta constantly harms the Blessed One and acts as his enemy, the Blessed One thinks with tenderness even of the one who harms him, and sending forth the light of great compassion he touched the body of Devadatta and freed him from suffering."

Then the Blessed One said to the great assembly, "Not only in this life has Devadatta harmed me. In past ages too he constantly did me harm, yet through the power of loving-kindness and compassion I constantly worked for his benefit and happiness."

Then Ānanda, knowing in his mind the thoughts of the great assembly, in order to cut through everyone's doubts, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, joined his palms, bowed, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, please explain what harms Devadatta did to the Blessed One in past ages."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Listen well, and I shall explain it to you in detail."

The Blessed One said, "Long ago, countless thousands of years in the past, in the land called Vārāṇasī, there appeared in the world a buddha, a blessed one, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher, victor. Having worked for the benefit of beings for ten thousand years, he passed into nirvāṇa. After he passed into nirvāṇa, the true Dharma remained for two hundred thousand years. When the semblance Dharma too had declined and disappeared, there was in the land called Vārāṇasī a king called Mahārāja, virtuous by nature and endowed with a wise intellect. He governed the realm by the true Dharma, and the people were happy and content.

"That king ruled over sixty minor kingdoms on the borders and eight hundred great cities, and he had five hundred Nepalese elephants as well. Though he had twenty thousand queens, he had no son. So the king continually made offerings to and prayed to the worldly gods and the gods of the mountains, of the rivers, and of the trees, and when twelve years had passed, the chief queen conceived a son, and the middle queen also conceived a son. The king was overjoyed, and he himself attended to them, providing service, honor,

bedding, food, drink, and every other necessity, all soft and excellent. When he had served them in this way for ten months, the chief queen bore a son, handsome and beautiful in appearance, adorned with excellent marks, and perfectly endowed with the marks of a man. The middle queen also bore a son. The king, delighted, gathered his ministers, the soothsayers, and the brahmins, and showing them his sons he had their marks read.

"When the soothsayers had examined the marks, in order to name the prince they asked, 'What omens occurred when this son was conceived?'

"The king said, 'Formerly the chief queen, the mother of the elder prince, was by nature irascible, very jealous and proud. But once the son was conceived in her womb, she became by nature gentle and good, always smiling, loving all beings as if each were her only child, smiling with a mind of tenderness, and speaking honestly.'

"Then the soothsayers named the prince Good Purpose.

"When they asked, 'What omens occurred when the middle queen conceived her son?' the king said, 'The mother of this son was formerly virtuous and gentle by nature, smiling, speaking honestly, and pleasing everyone's heart. But once the son was conceived in her womb, she became by nature irascible and full of hatred, jealous and proud.'

"The soothsayers said, 'This too is the residue of the son's past karma,' and they named the son Evil Purpose.

"Then the two princes were raised, and when they reached fourteen years of age, Prince Good Purpose was by nature endowed with a wise intellect and a loving mind, and he delighted in giving, so that his parents especially cherished that son as dearly as their own eyes.

"Prince Evil Purpose, however, was irascible by nature, so his parents did not delight in him. Out of hostility, Prince Evil Purpose was constantly jealous and intent on harming his elder brother.

"Later, on another occasion, Prince Good Purpose went out with his retinue, playing music, to stroll beyond the palace and see the sights. There he saw plowmen plowing a field, and as worms came up from the plowing, many birds gathered and ate them. When Prince Good Purpose saw this, a compassionate mind arose in him. 'Since I was born deep within the palace, I have never seen or heard of such a thing,' he thought, and he asked his retinue, 'Why do these creatures harm and eat one another?'

"The retinue said to the prince, 'This realm the king now rules depends on its subjects. The subjects in turn depend on food, and food comes from plowing the fields, from which the five kinds of grain grow and sustain the lives of beings.'

"The prince said, 'Alas, alas!' Then, going on further, he saw men and women doing the work of spinning thread and weaving, toiling to and fro in hardship. Having seen them, he asked the servants on his right and left, 'What are these people doing?'

"They said, 'These people do the work of spinning and weaving, and with it they make clothes to dress and cover our bodies. They too, alas, do work full of hardship.'

"Then, going on further still, he saw many people killing cattle, camels, horses, pigs and sheep and flaying their hides, and he asked, 'What are these people doing?'

"They said, 'These people do the work of killing. By selling the meat they earn clothing and food, and by this they make their living.'

"When the prince heard this, his hair stood on end and all the flesh of his body trembled. 'Alas, alas! My heart cannot bear this killing! One eats another's flesh in revenge, and for countless eons they will go on killing one another.'

"Then, going on further still, he saw some people carrying fishing nets and bird nets, killing birds and fish, so that one eats the flesh of another in revenge. Then he asked, 'What are these people doing?'

"They replied, 'These are fowlers and fishermen. They do this work of killing and so seek clothing and food.'

"When Prince Good Purpose heard those words, his eyes filled with tears. Thinking, 'These beings of the world do deeds that become evil and nonvirtuous, and they will never be freed from suffering,' he was unhappy, overwhelmed with sorrow, and he returned to the palace.

"When his father the king saw the prince return unhappy and sorrowful, he asked the prince, 'What has made you unhappy?' The prince described to his father the king in detail all the things he had seen.

"The king said to the prince, 'Such things exist everywhere and are just the way of existence, so what is there to grieve about?'

"The prince said, 'If I ask one wish of the king, will the king grant it?'

"The king said, 'You are my only son, and since I love and cherish you, I will not go against your wishes.'

"The prince said, 'I wish to give all the wealth, jewels, food and drink there are in my father the king's treasury to all beings.' And the king declared, 'I will not go against your wishes, so give as you please.'

"Then Prince Good Purpose summoned the ministers, opened the king's treasury, loaded wealth and jewels onto five hundred Nepalese elephants, and heaped them up at the four gates of the city. In the four directions he proclaimed, 'All you many beings! Do you want clothing? Do you want food and drink? Take whatever you wish, as you please, and carry it away!' As the fame of Prince Good Purpose spread in every direction in this way, everyone gathered and carried away whatever they wished.

"Before long a third of the king's treasury was exhausted, and the ministers said to the king, 'A third of the treasury has been spent. The prince is making it disappear; may the king consider this.' The king declared, 'I cannot go against the prince's wishes.'

"Then they said, 'Now two thirds of the king's treasury have been spent; may the king consider this.' The king declared, 'I cannot go against the prince's wishes. Use whatever means is best to restrain him a little, without going against his wishes.'

"Then, when Prince Good Purpose went again to open the treasury, the minister in charge of the treasury had gone off on business and did not come for a long time, so there was a delay. Prince Good Purpose said, 'A junior minister guarding the treasury would not dare to go against my wishes; this must surely be the command of the king my father. It is not right for a son who is called devoted to his parents to empty his father's treasury, so now I shall seek wealth and jewels myself and satisfy all beings. If I cannot give all beings clothing, food and drink to their full satisfaction, as they wish, how could I be called the son of a great king?'

"Having said this, he gathered everyone from the great ministers down to the minor ministers and consulted with them, asking, 'By what means could one best acquire wealth and profit?'

"One great minister said, 'If one seeks profit, nothing surpasses plowing the fields: one becomes ten thousand.'

"Another great minister said, 'Of all the ways of making profit in the world, if one establishes herds of livestock and keeps them on good pasture, they multiply greatly, and there is no profit greater than that.'

"Another minister said, 'If one seeks profit in the world, nothing surpasses going to sea and searching for precious jewels. If one finds a precious wish-fulfilling jewel, one will be able to give to all beings as they wish, to their full satisfaction.'

"Good Purpose said, 'This suits my mind; this will do.' He went to the palace and said to his father the king, 'I wish to go out on the great ocean to fetch a precious jewel.'

"When the king heard these words, he became distressed, like a person choking on something who can neither cough it up nor swallow it down, and he said to the prince,

"This realm is your realm too. The treasury, all the wealth, and whatever jewels there are, are yours to command and to use as you wish, so why must you go out on the ocean yourself? You are the son of a king, born deep within the palace. When you sleep you are surrounded by curtained canopies, and you have whatever food you desire. If you now set out on the road and travel, who knows how you will be afflicted, tormented by hunger, thirst, cold and heat? And besides, the hazards in the ocean are not just one but many: savage pretas, venomous nāgas, swirling waves, violent winds that toss and drive one off course, the color of the waters, mountains, sea monsters, great fish and the like. Because the hazards are so many, even if a hundred thousand set out, no more than one or two ever return. So why do you think of going out on the great ocean? I will not consent to it.'

"Then Prince Good Purpose threw himself face down on the ground, stretched out all four limbs, and said to his father the king and his mother, 'If you do not allow me to go to the ocean, I shall give up my life right here and never rise from this spot.'

"Then, when the great king and the queens saw him like this, they gazed at him without blinking, and they tried in every way to cheer him, saying, 'Prince, get up, eat some food and drink something.' But Prince Good Purpose would not listen, and said, 'If you do not allow me to go to the great ocean, I shall never take food or drink.'

"The king and the queens, tormented by unhappiness and grief, wept beside him, lamented, and rolled on the ground. In this way he went without eating or drinking for one day, then two days, three days, up to six days, and his father and mother were tormented by grief all the more. Fearing he would not survive, when the seventh day came his father and mother took his hands and feet into their laps, kissed his hands and feet, and tried to encourage him with sweet, gentle words: 'Now get up, eat some food and drink something. This body, built of food, stays alive through the condition of depending on food. If you do not eat or drink, you will not survive.' But the prince would not listen, and said, 'If my father and mother do not allow me to go, I shall certainly never rise from this very spot.'

"Then the chief queen said to the king, 'The resolve the prince has made is very hard to carry out. Could you bear for the prince to die right here? It is not right to go against his wishes. Out of compassion, it is proper to let him go to the great ocean. If you let him go, there is a chance he may return, one in a hundred; but if you do not let him go now, he will certainly die.'

"The king, unable to bear it, gave permission for him to go. When permission had been given, Prince Good Purpose rose from where he lay, utterly delighted, and bowed his head at the feet of his father the king.

"The king's retinue, the queens, the servants, and many hundreds of thousands of people had been saying to one another, 'Is Prince Good Purpose now dead or alive?' Now they said, 'Prince Good Purpose has risen, overjoyed, and is even eating and drinking.'

"Then the king said to the prince, 'What is your purpose in asking so insistently to go to the ocean?'

"The prince said, 'Great king, I wish to obtain a great precious wish-fulfilling jewel and satisfy the needs of all beings.'

"Then the great king issued a proclamation to everyone: 'Who wishes to go to the ocean? If you return from the ocean, you will be given clothing, food, wealth and jewels without interruption for seven generations, and everything you need for going out on the ocean will be given and provided.' When they heard that Prince Good Purpose was going out on the ocean to fetch a precious jewel, everyone gathered, overjoyed. Among them five hundred men pledged themselves, saying, 'We too ask to go as the prince's attendants.'

"At that time in the land of Vārāṇasī there was an ocean guide who had gone to the ocean many times before. He was very skilled in knowledge of the routes, both those that lead to safety and those that do not; he was eighty years old, and both his eyes were blind. Then the great king himself went to the guide and said to him, 'I have only one son. He has never even gone out of the door, yet he wishes to go to the ocean, so you must go as his attendant.'

"When the guide heard the king's words, he cried out loudly and wept, saying, 'Great king, going out on the great ocean has many hazards and obstacles, and its afflictions are not just one. Even if countless hundreds of thousands set out, no more than one or two ever return. Great king, why are you sending such a prince on such a long and dangerous road?'

"The king said, 'Because of my love and tenderness for the prince, I could not refuse him, and so I have sent him.'

"The guide said, 'In that case, I too will go.'

"Then Prince Good Purpose prepared provisions and equipment for the five hundred men and escorted them to the shore of the ocean.

"At that time his younger brother Evil Purpose thought, 'Our father and mother keep loving Prince Good Purpose more and more. Now he is going to the ocean to fetch a precious jewel, and if he comes back, Good Purpose will be loved more and more, and I will be all the more disliked and despised.' Having thought this, he said, 'I too will go after Prince Good Purpose to fetch jewels.' His father and mother allowed him to go, saying, 'If he goes too, then on dangerous or difficult roads the two brothers, traveling together, will surely help each other,' and so they sent Prince Evil Purpose as well.

"Then Prince Good Purpose boarded the ship, had seven iron mooring chains fastened to it, and stayed there for seven days. On the morning after he first boarded the ship, when the sun rose, Prince Good Purpose beat a drum and called out in a loud voice,

"'Whoever among you wishes to go to the ocean, say nothing at all. Those who are attached to parents, brothers and sisters, wives and children, and who have faith in the pleasures and comforts of Jambudvīpa, turn back from here! Do not come to regret it on my account. Why is that? Because in the ocean the hazards are exceedingly many: countless set out, yet no more than one or two return.' Though he called this out in a loud voice, the many in his company said nothing at all, so he cut one mooring chain and drew it up onto the ship.

In the same way he called out once each day for seven days, but all remained silent and said nothing at all, so he cut all seven mooring chains and drew them up onto the ship. Then they raised the sail to the wind and set off.

"Through the force of the prince's compassionate mind and merit, they reached the ocean island of precious jewels without mishap. When they had reached the jewels, Prince Good Purpose beat the drum again and instructed the many people, 'Since the road is long and dangerous, gather jewels here, rest for seven days, and then go back.' He also said, 'These jewels are marvelously precious in Jambudvīpa, but do not make your loads too heavy, for if they are heavy the ship will sink. If they are too light, there is no point in the hardship of the long road, so take a moderate amount and go.' And he instructed those people, 'May you reach your land safely! I am going on to seek the precious wish-fulfilling jewel.' Having instructed them so, he took his leave and they went their separate ways.

"Then Prince Good Purpose set out together with the guide, and for seven days they went through water no deeper than the knees. Then for seven days they went through water reaching up to the neck. Then for seven days they swam, and reached an ocean island on the far side. When they reached that ocean island, a land strewn with silver sand, the guide asked, 'What is this ground?' The prince said, 'This ground is nothing but silver sand.'

"The guide said, 'Look in the four directions: do you see something like a white mountain?'

"The prince said, 'In the southeast a white mountain is visible.'

"The guide said, 'The road leading onward lies at the foot of that mountain. Just beyond its edge there should be a land strewn with golden sand.' Having said this, worn out and exhausted, he collapsed on the ground and said to the prince, 'I am exhausted and have no strength left; I shall die here. Prince, from here go east for seven days and you should come to a golden mountain. Then go on for seven days and you should reach a land covered entirely with blue lotuses. Then go on another seven days and you should come to a land covered entirely with red lotuses. Beyond those lotuses there is a castle made of the seven precious substances. Its walls are made of gold, its turrets of silver, and its parapets of red kekeru gems; it is adorned with various jewels such as crystal and agate, covered above with a net of red pearls, and surrounded on its outer edge by seven successive moats of vaidūrya and sapphire. Within it is the palace of the nāga king, and in the ear of that nāga

king is a precious wish-fulfilling jewel. Ask him for it. If you obtain it, it will rain down the seven precious substances on Jambudvīpa, and it will rain down clothing, food, medicines for the sick, music, and every necessity, just as one wishes. That is why it is called the precious wish-fulfilling jewel. If the prince obtains it, all his aspirations will surely be fulfilled.'

"Having said this, he died. Then Prince Good Purpose took the guide into his lap, cried out and wept: 'Alas, alas! Why have I lost my dear guardian?' He buried the guide's bones in the golden sand, circumambulated them three times to the right, paid homage, and went on.

"Going on and on, he reached the foot of the golden mountain. When he had passed beyond the foot of the golden mountain, he found the ground covered with blue lotuses, and saw that beneath those lotuses it was full of great venomous snakes. Those venomous snakes had three kinds of venom: the venom of the bite, the venom of touch, and the venom of breath. The venomous snakes coiled around the lotus stalks, their mouths gaping and their eyes staring, looking at the prince. Then Prince Good Purpose entered the samādhi of a loving mind, and by the power of the samādhi set out from there. Though he went on, treading upon those lotuses with his feet, the venomous snakes did him no harm.

"Going on and on in this way through the force of the samādhi of a loving mind, he reached the nāga palace. The outside of the nāga king's palace was surrounded by seven successive moats, and in those moats venomous nāgas, coiled around one another with their heads raised, guarded the castle gate. Then Prince Good Purpose came to the castle gate. When he saw the venomous nāgas, with a loving mind he brought to mind all the beings of Jambudvīpa and thought, 'I have come all this way for the sake of beings. If the venomous nāgas harm me, there will be no benefit and happiness for them.' Having thought this, Prince Good Purpose raised his right hand and commanded the venomous nāgas, 'Know this! I wish to meet the nāga king for the sake of all beings.'

"Then the venomous nāgas opened a way, and passing through all seven successive moats, he reached the castle gate. At that castle gate he saw two crystal maidens sitting and spinning crystal thread. When he asked, 'Who are you?' they said, 'We are servant girls who guard the outer gate of the nāga king.'

"Then, entering further, he went on and reached the middle gate. At the middle gate he saw four crystal maidens sitting and spinning silver thread. When he asked those maidens, 'Are you the queens of the nāga king?' they said, 'No, we are servant girls who guard the middle gate of the nāga king.'

"Then the prince entered that gate and went on, and at the inner gate he saw eight crystal maidens sitting and spinning golden thread. When he asked, 'Who are you?' they said, 'We are servant girls who guard the inner gate of the nāga king's palace.'

"Then Prince Good Purpose instructed those maidens, 'I am the son of the king of Vārāṇasī in Jambudvīpa, called Good Purpose. Take this message: he wishes to meet the king and is now waiting at the gate.' The gatekeeper reported this to the nāga king, and the nāga king was amazed. He thought, 'Unless this is someone whose merit and roots of virtue are very pure, no other ordinary person could travel such a road and come here.' Having thought this, he called him in, and the nāga king himself came to greet him and led him into the palace.

"Inside the nāga king's palace the floor was made of vaidūrya and the throne of the seven precious substances. Lights of every kind blazed so brightly the eye could hardly bear them. Then the nāga king seated Prince Good Purpose on a seat that had been spread for him and conversed with him. Then Prince Good Purpose took up the conversation and spoke at length to the nāga king, teaching him the Dharma with many kinds of inspiring, uplifting and delightful talk: talk on giving, talk on moral discipline, talk on gods and humans, and so on.

"Then the nāga king was overjoyed and delighted, and asked, 'What do you wish for, you who have traveled such a hard road and come from so far?'

"Prince Good Purpose said to the nāga king, 'The beings of Jambudvīpa undergo endless great suffering for the sake of clothing, wealth, food and drink, so I wish for the precious jewel in the king's left ear.'

"The nāga king said, 'If you will consent to accept the offerings I prepare for just seven days, I will give you the jewel.'

"Then Prince Good Purpose, as the nāga king had invited him, stayed in the nāga palace for seven days. Taking the precious wish-fulfilling jewel, he set out to return to Jambudvīpa. Then the great nāga king, by the power of the nāgas, flew through the sky and escorted him to the near shore of the ocean. When

he arrived there, he met his younger brother Evil Purpose. The prince asked his younger brother Evil Purpose, 'Where are all your companions? Are you here all alone?'

"Prince Evil Purpose said, 'The ship sank and everyone died. Only I, clinging to a corpse, did not die and came through; all the others died at once.'

"Prince Good Purpose said, 'In the world, no jewel surpasses one's own body.'

"His younger brother said, 'That is not so. It is easier to die rich than to live poor. How do I know this? When I went and stayed in a charnel ground, I heard the corpses in that charnel ground saying so.'

"Prince Good Purpose, being honest by nature, said to his younger brother, 'Even if you have no jewels, it does not matter, for I have the nāga king's precious wish-fulfilling jewel.'

"When his younger brother asked, 'Where is the jewel?' the elder brother said, 'The precious wish-fulfilling jewel is in my topknot.'

"When the younger brother heard him say this, he was all the more agitated by jealousy, and hatred arose in him. He thought, 'On top of my father the king and my mother disliking me so much, now my elder brother has found the precious wish-fulfilling jewel. From now on they will dislike me even more and despise me like dirt and stones.' Having thought this, he said to his elder brother Good Purpose, 'Excellent indeed! It is excellent that you have obtained the precious jewel, but now in this fearful place it must be guarded well.'

"Then Prince Good Purpose untied his topknot, gave the jewel into the hands of his younger brother Evil Purpose, and said, 'When you are tired and worn out and lie down to sleep, I will watch over it and guard it. When I am tired and lie down to sleep, you watch over it and guard it.'

"Then, when it was Evil Purpose's turn to guard the jewel and his elder brother Good Purpose had fallen asleep, Evil Purpose stuck two splinters of dry bamboo into both of Good Purpose's eyes, took the precious jewel, and fled.

"Then Prince Good Purpose called out, 'Younger brother Evil Purpose! A thief has stuck splinters of wood into both my eyes; take the precious jewel and flee!' He called out, but there was no answer. 'Now my younger brother Evil Purpose must have been killed by an enemy, for there is no answer,' he said, and though he called out in a voice so loud that even the gods heard it, for a long time there was no answer at all.

"Then a tree deity spoke thus: 'Your younger brother Evil Purpose is himself the enemy. He put out both your eyes, took the precious jewel, and has fled back home. What use is calling out "Evil Purpose"?' When Prince Good Purpose heard those words, he was tormented by grief and became despondent.

"Then Prince Evil Purpose took the precious jewel back to his own land, met his father and mother, and said to his father the king and his mother, 'Because I am endowed with merit, I have returned without mishap. Prince Good Purpose and the other companions had little merit, so they perished in the water and all died.'

"When his father the king and his mother heard those words, they cried out loudly and wept, fainted, and fell to the ground. Then, after cold water was sprinkled on them, after a long time they came to again and said to Prince Evil Purpose, 'What face do you have, coming back to meet us like this?' Prince Evil Purpose, displeased and angry, dug into the ground in a secluded place and hid the precious jewel.

"At that time, since there was no one to pull out the dry bamboo splinters stuck in both his eyes, Prince Good Purpose, tormented by pain, rolled on the ground. He did not know where to go, and was tormented by hunger and thirst as well. Neither able to live nor able to die, he went groping his way blindly until he reached the border region of the land of King Lishibar.

"That king of Lishibar had a daughter who had been promised in marriage to Prince Good Purpose, son of the king of Vārāṇasī. King Lishibar had a cowherd who tended five hundred cattle, going about grazing them wherever there was grass and water.

At that time Prince Good Purpose was lying on a road, and the cowherd came that way driving the greater part of his herd. The prince was all but trampled by the cattle, but among them was a king of bulls, which stood over the prince. When all the other cattle had passed, it lowered itself down, rolled on the ground, looked at the prince, and stood up again. Then with its tongue it licked the prince's two eyes and drew out the bamboo splinters.

Then the cowherd, coming along behind, arrived there and asked, "Who are you?"

Good Purpose thought, "If I tell in detail my family and lineage and what has happened to me, my younger brother may come to great suffering." Having thought this, he said, "I am a blind beggar."

Then the cowherd looked at him, and inferring from his other marks, saw that he was no ordinary person. He said, "My house is not far from here. I will provide for your livelihood; let us go to my house." And he led Prince Good Purpose to his home.

When the cowherd had brought him home, he provided him with food, drink and everything he needed, and he instructed the sons and daughters of the household and everyone in the house, "All of you must serve this blind man as you would serve me."

So for more than a month they looked after him in the house, but they grew weary of it and said, "Now our provisions are running low. Who could support this blind man forever?"

When Good Purpose heard these words, his heart sank. When that night had passed, the next day he said to the householder, "Now I shall go."

The householder said, "What has gone wrong, that you are thinking of leaving us?"

Good Purpose said, "By nature, host and guest do not stay together for long." And Good Purpose said further, "If you are so kind to me, make me a sweet-sounding lute, and take me to some place where many people gather, or to a great city."

Then the householder provided what was needed, just as he wished, brought him into the midst of the crowds in the city of King Lishibar, and returned home in peace.

Then, because Prince Good Purpose was exceedingly skilled at the lute, and the sweet sound of his lute was so delightful, everyone gave him the necessities of life, and he never lacked for food or drink. At that time there were five hundred beggars in the land of Lishibar, and he satisfied all of them as well with food and drink.

Now that king had an orchard, whose fruit grew so abundantly that the birds could never be kept away. The overseer who guarded the orchard then said to Prince Good Purpose, "Could you not stay and guard my fruit orchard? I will provide you with the necessities you need."

Good Purpose said, "I have no eyes and cannot see. How could I guard your orchard and drive away the birds?"

The overseer of the orchard said, "I have a method. I will stretch ropes across the tops of my trees, tie bells to the ropes, and place the rope in your hand. Whenever you hear the cries of birds, it will be enough to pull on the rope."

Good Purpose said, "If it is done that way, I can do it. Lead me to the trees." So saying, he went there. And Prince Good Purpose stayed in that orchard, guarding the fruit, playing music on his lute and amusing himself.

At that time the king's daughter, with her attendants, went to stroll in the orchard and enjoy the sights. Seeing the blind man, she went up to him and asked, "Whose man are you?"

He said, "I am a blind beggar."

When the king's daughter saw the blind man, she felt love for him and could not bear to leave him. When the king sent for his daughter, she said, "I will not go. Bring food and drink here; I will eat together with this blind man." When she had eaten the meal together with the blind man, she said to the king, "Please give me to this blind man. If you give me to him, my heart will be content."

The king said, "Daughter, have you been seized by a spirit or a graha? Or are you mad? Is your heart bewitched? Why would you stay with that blind man? Do you not know? Earlier the king of Vārāṇasī asked for you as a wife for his son Good Purpose, and you were promised to him. The prince has now gone to the ocean, and he has not yet returned. Why then would you think of becoming the wife of a beggar?"

The daughter said, "That is so, yet even if I lose my life, I will not leave the blind man."

When the king heard these words, he could not refuse his daughter. He summoned the blind man and lodged him in a secluded part of the palace.

Then the king's daughter went to the blind man and said, "Do you know? Now I will join with you as husband and wife."

Good Purpose said, "Whose daughter are you, that you think of joining with me as husband and wife?"

She said, "I am the daughter of King Lishibar."

Good Purpose said, "You are a king's daughter, and I am a beggar. How could we show each other due respect?"

The wife said, "I will serve you with all my heart, and I will never act against your wishes."

So they lived together for ninety days. Then one day the wife went outside without speaking to her husband, and after a long while she came back.

Good Purpose said to his wife, "Where did you go in secret? Where did you go without even telling me, and where have you come back from?"

The wife said, "I did not go anywhere in secret."

Good Purpose said, "Who can know whether you went in secret or not?"

The wife was unhappy and dejected, and with her eyes full of tears she spoke these words and swore an oath: "If I went off on some secret business behind your back, may your two eyes never be healed. But if that is not so, may one of your eyes see as it did before."

The moment she had spoken the words of her oath, one of her husband's eyes could see as before and became clear, shining like a star, and his wife saw this plainly. The wife said, "Now do you believe me?"

Good Purpose smiled and said nothing at all.

The wife said, "You are shameless and ungrateful. I am the daughter of a great king, and you are an ordinary man, and yet, though I have served you with all my heart, you still do not believe me."

Her husband said, "Do you know who I am?"

She said, "I do not know. You are a beggar."

Her husband said, "No, I am not. I am the one called Prince Good Purpose, son of the king of the land of Vārāṇasī."

The wife said, "You are a great fool. Why do you say such a thing? The son of the king of Vārāṇasī set out on the ocean and went to fetch jewels, and he has not yet returned. So why do you claim to be him? You are telling lies, and I do not believe you."

Prince Good Purpose said, "From the time I was first born until now, I have never told a lie."

The wife said, "Who could be sure whether what you say is true or false?"

Her husband said, "If these words I have spoken are false and I have deceived you, may my one eye never see again. But if my words are true, may my other

eye also see as it did before." The moment he had said this, the eyeball of that other eye too became clear and could see as before.

When the wife saw that Prince Good Purpose's two eyes were clear and beautiful as before, and that he bore the marks of a great man, was delightful, and was handsome beyond compare in the world, a mind of intense joy arose in her. She was as elated as if blessed by a noble one, and she gazed at him almost without blinking.

Then she went to the palace and said to her father the king, "That husband of mine is Prince Good Purpose."

The king said, "Has this foolish girl gone mad? Has she been deceived by a hungry ghost? What is wrong with her, that she says such things? It is said that Prince Good Purpose set out on the ocean and has still not returned. Why do you call a beggar Prince Good Purpose?"

The daughter said, "It is not so. If the king does not believe me, would you please look with your own eyes?"

The moment the king looked, he recognized that it was Prince Good Purpose. Having recognized him, he was alarmed and said, "If the king of Vārāṇasī hears of this, we will be blamed." So saying, he said, "Prince Good Purpose, I did not know before that you were the prince. I confess my offense."

The prince said, "There is no offense in that. But, king, give a gift to that cowherd."

Then King Lishibar gave that cowherd gold, silver, jewels, clothing, food and drink, and also gave him five hundred cattle outright. Then the cowherd, overjoyed, proclaimed loudly among a great crowd of people, "What kindness of help did I do for Prince Good Purpose, that I should be given so much wealth and so many jewels? Even when giving is done in secret, its kindness returns plainly before one's eyes. So vast is the karmic maturation of the fruit of giving!"

At that, the whole great assembly rejoiced greatly, and a mind delighting in giving arose in them. The gods too praised and extolled that man, saying, "Those who wish for buddhahood should give to all," and so it came to pass.

Now in the past, before Prince Good Purpose set out on the ocean, while he was living in the palace, he had raised a white goose, which was his constant companion. When eating, drinking, going about, staying, sitting or lying down, they were always together.

Then his mother the queen went to the goose and said to it, "While the prince was here, you were always his companion. Now he has gone to the ocean, and there is no knowing whether he is dead or alive; I do not know. Do you not remember the prince?"

When the goose heard these words, it cried out and rolled on the ground, and with its eyes full of tears it said to the queen, "Queen, if you command me to search for the prince, I shall go."

When it had said this, the queen wrote a letter, tied it to the goose's neck, and sent it to search for the prince. Then the goose asked in which direction the prince had gone, flew up into the sky, and went toward the ocean.

When the queen saw the goose leave like this, she thought, "Now, without a doubt, I will soon surely hear news of whether my son is alive or dead."

Then the goose soared back and forth in the sky above the ocean, examining everywhere and searching, but it did not see the prince. Gradually it reached the land of King Lishibar, and from afar it saw Prince Good Purpose staying in the king's palace. Then the goose came down right there, came to where the prince was, gave a piteous cry, and gazed at the prince with great joy.

Then the prince took the letter from the goose's neck and respectfully bowed his head to it. Then he opened the letter and read it. When he had read it, he understood that his parents, the king and queen, remembering the prince day and night, had wept constantly until both their eyes had gone blind.

Then Prince Good Purpose wrote down in detail everything that had happened, tied it once more to the goose's neck, and sent it back. Then the goose, overjoyed, came back to the land of Vārāṇasī, to his father the king and his mother the queen.

When the king saw that a letter had come, he was overjoyed and delighted, and his elation knew no bounds. He also learned that Prince Good Purpose had been robbed by Evil Purpose, that his jewels had been stolen, and that he had suffered greatly.

Then his father the king at once seized Evil Purpose, had his hands and feet bound up, fastened an iron chain around his neck, and threw him into prison.

Then he sent a messenger to King Lishibar with the message, "Why have you detained the prince and caused us to be tormented by grief?"

Then King Lishibar, afraid, adorned Prince Good Purpose with clothes and ornaments and stationed him at the border. He did as the message required, and arranged it so that it was as though a messenger had come, saying, "Prince Good Purpose has returned from the ocean and is now coming here."

Then King Lishibar had the whole region through which the prince was to come swept and sprinkled with water. Victory banners, pennants and parasols were hung, bells were rung and drums were beaten, and all kinds of music were played. The king himself, with his retinue, went out from the palace to welcome the prince from afar. He gave him his daughter as his wife and sent him off to be escorted to the land of Vārāṇasī.

When the king and queen of Vārāṇasī heard that the prince was coming, they were overjoyed and delighted. Mounted on the finest elephant of Nepal, they went out to welcome the prince. The place of welcome was swept and sprinkled, incense, pennants, victory banners, parasols and the like were set out and hung up, and all kinds of music were played as well. All the people dwelling in that land, men and women alike, heard that Prince Good Purpose had returned safely from the ocean, and they all rejoiced greatly, and everyone went out to welcome the prince.

Then Prince Good Purpose bowed his head at the feet of his father the king and his mother the queen. The king and queen were blind and could not see the prince, so they stroked him with their hands and said, "Are you our son Good Purpose? Because we remembered you constantly and were tormented by grief, we have become like this."

When the prince had paid homage to his father the king and to the queen, he raised his hands to the vassal kings, the ministers and the multitude of people, and with a loud voice he lifted their spirits, saying, "Although I met with hardship, through your merit I have returned."

Then Prince Good Purpose said to his father the king, "Where is my younger brother Evil Purpose now? Where is he?"

His father the king said, "Do not ask about him. That evildoer is now in prison, and there is no question of releasing him."

Prince Good Purpose said, "Please let me meet Evil Purpose." He pleaded in this way, weeping, two and three times, and the king could not refuse his wish, so Evil Purpose was brought out of prison. The prince asked that the iron chains and shackles be taken off Evil Purpose's hands and feet.

Then, when he had been brought out of the prison, the prince embraced Evil Purpose in his lap and lifted his spirits with gentle words, saying, "Have you suffered greatly?" After they had talked, he asked two and three times, "Where is the precious jewel of mine that you took?" Only then did Evil Purpose say, "It is hidden under the ground."

Then Prince Good Purpose dug the jewel out of that place and took it. Then he came before his father the king and his mother the queen. He perfumed the precious jewel with fine incense, knelt down, and made this aspiration: "If you are truly a precious wish-fulfilling jewel, may the eyes of my father the king and my mother the queen see once more as they did before." The moment he had said this, the eyes of both his father the king and his mother saw clearly as before, and they were overjoyed and delighted.

Then Prince Good Purpose, on the fifteenth day, at the time of the full moon, bathed, put on new, clean clothes, and placed the precious jewel on top of a banner pole. Holding a censer in his hand, he bowed his head to the precious wish-fulfilling jewel and made this aspiration: "I have undergone great suffering for the sake of all the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa, and I have obtained this precious jewel."

The moment he had said this, a great wind arose from the east and blew away the clouds and mist, making the whole sky completely clear. The wind blew away all the filthy mire, excrement and urine, refuse, and everything unpleasant in Jambudvīpa, making it completely clean. Then, through the power of the precious jewel, self-grown śāli rice, needing no ploughing, rained down upon Jambudvīpa. That śāli rice was soft and full of color and flavor, and it fell until every hollow and ravine was filled about knee-deep.

After that, fine clothes to wear, ornaments for the body such as bracelets, jewels and armlets, rained down. After that, gold, silver, the seven kinds of precious substances and the like, and all kinds of musical instruments, in short, every necessity that any sentient being could need or wish for, rained down, and all were satisfied and contented.

Such is the meaning of a bodhisattva practicing the perfection of generosity through the force of great compassion, and giving all sentient beings the necessities they need until they are satisfied.

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "If you think that the great king of the land of Vārāṇasī at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so. The great king at that time, on that occasion, is now my father, King

Śuddhodana. If you think that the queen at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, do not regard it so. She who was the queen at that time, on that occasion, is now my mother Māyā. Prince Evil Purpose at that time, on that occasion, is now Devadatta himself. Prince Good Purpose at that time, on that occasion, is now I myself.

"Even in times long past, this Devadatta constantly harmed me with malicious intent, yet I always accepted it with patience, always showed him kindness, and continually brought him happiness. How much more so now that I have attained complete awakening!"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, hundreds of thousands of gods and humans attained results ranging from the fruit of stream-entry up to the fruit of arhatship. Furthermore, countless hundreds of thousands of gods and humans generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and countless hundreds of thousands of sentient beings generated the resolve for the levels of the śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas.

Ānanda said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, what is the name of this sūtra? How should it be kept in mind?"

The Blessed One said, "The name of this sūtra is Skill in Means: Repaying the Kindness of the Buddha, Giving to All Sentient Beings Until They Are Satisfied."

The great assembly rejoiced greatly at the teaching of this sūtra, paid homage, and departed.

Furthermore, although Devadatta had gone forth into homelessness following the teaching of the Buddha, he was constantly jealous for the sake of honor and gain. Though Devadatta knew how to recite from memory as many sūtras as would make sixty thousand loads for a mighty elephant, he was not freed from the hell of the beings who commit the deeds of immediate retribution.

At that time Devadatta became close friends with King Ajātaśatru. They were fond of each other and felt close, and each trusted the other's word.

Then Devadatta said to King Ajātaśatru, "You become the new king, and I will become the new Buddha."

King Ajātaśatru said, "My father the king is still alive now, so that would not be proper."

Devadatta said, "He can be done away with. And I shall do away with the Buddha. After that, would it not be pleasant for a new king and a new Buddha

to work for the welfare of beings?"

Then King Ajātaśatru, just as Devadatta had said, killed his father the king and seized Rājagṛha, the land of Vārāṇasī.

Devadatta said to King Ajātaśatru, "Now I too shall do away with the Tathāgata."

Ajātaśatru said, "The Tathāgata possesses the power of great miracles, and he knows the thoughts that others think. How could you do away with him? Besides, the Tathāgata has great close disciples, Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Mist, Aniruddha and others, so you will not be able to."

Devadatta said to King Ajātaśatru, "King, be my ally."

The king said, "What do you intend to do?"

Devadatta said, "Let the great king issue a decree throughout the land: no one is to give the monks clothing, food, drink or alms."

Then King Ajātaśatru issued a decree: "If anyone gives clothing, food or alms to the monks, his hands and feet will be cut off."

At that time the Blessed One, together with his retinue, the great Saṅgha of monks, went out from Vulture Peak to beg for alms, but they obtained nothing at all. In the same way, from the first day through the seventh day they obtained nothing at all, and so the great disciples, Śāriputra and the others, went by the power of their miracles to other lands to beg for clothing, food and alms.

At that time Devadatta said to King Ajātaśatru, "Now not one of the Buddha's great disciples is left, and the Tathāgata is staying alone. Let the king send to invite the Tathāgata. When he comes into the palace, we will give liquor to five hundred savage black elephants of Nepal and make them thoroughly drunk. Then, once the Buddha has been invited and has come into the palace, those raging, drunken elephants will trample him and kill him."

Then King Ajātaśatru sent someone to invite the Tathāgata, and the Buddha and five hundred arhats accepted the king's invitation and went to Rājagṛha.

Then King Ajātaśatru let loose the five hundred raging, drunken elephants. The raging elephants broke down trees, tore through fences and knocked down walls, and, trumpeting loudly with fury, they charged toward the Tathāgata and the five hundred arhats.

Then the five hundred arhats, terrified, rose up into the sky above and remained in the sky above the Buddha. At that time Ānanda alone stayed at the Tathāgata's side.

At that time the Tathāgata, through the force of his love and compassion, raised his right hand, and from his five fingers he emanated lions with gaping jaws, roaring loudly. The five hundred raging elephants were terrified and fell to the ground.

Then the Tathāgata, surrounded by a great retinue, went to the king's palace. King Ajātaśatru came outside, welcomed the Tathāgata, and invited him to be seated. When he was seated, the king confessed and repented, and said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, it was not I who did this. Devadatta made me do it."

The Blessed One said, "I know that. This Devadatta has always done me harm, and not only now. In times past too, though he always did me harm, I, through the force of great compassion, always did him good."

At that time King Ajātaśatru joined his palms and said to the Blessed One, "What were the harms that this Devadatta did to the Tathāgata in times past?"

The Blessed One said, "Listen well, and I shall analyze and explain it.

"In times past, beyond countless eons ago, there was a great king who was fond of goose meat. He constantly had a hunter catch geese for him.

"At that time five hundred geese were flying through the sky from the north toward the south, and the king of the geese was caught in the hunter's bird net. Then the hunter, delighted, came out of his hut and was about to kill it, when a female goose flew up, came near, and gave a piteous cry.

"Then the hunter drew his bow, nocked an arrow and made ready to kill her, but she was not afraid of the arrow. Beating her two wings, she leaped onto the king of the geese. The other five hundred geese also circled and hovered in the sky above.

"At that time the hunter saw that female goose crying piteously, vomiting blood from her mouth, and, with no regard even for her own life, devoted to the king of the geese. Seeing this, the hunter thought, 'If even birds born in the animal realm are so devoted to one another that they would give up even body and life, what kind of heart would I have to kill this king of the geese?' Thinking this, he lifted the net and let it go.

"At that time the female goose, overjoyed, flew off after it, and surrounded by the five hundred geese they flew away through the sky.

"Then that hunter said to the king,

"I caught a king of the geese and was going to offer it to you, but a female goose, vomiting blood from her mouth and without fear even of my bow and arrow, leaped onto the king of the geese. My heart could not bear it, so I let him go, and surrounded by five hundred geese they flew away through the sky."

At that time, when the king heard these words, his mind became troubled and compassion arose in him. He thought, "Even those born in the animal realm cherish one another and do not begrudge even body and life." Thinking this, the king too vowed never again to eat the flesh of geese.

"The great king at that time, on that occasion, is now the great king yourself. The one who was the hunter at that time, on that occasion, is now Devadatta himself. The female goose who vomited blood from her mouth at that time, on that occasion, is now Ānanda. The five hundred geese at that time, on that occasion, are now the five hundred arhats. The one who was the king of the geese at that time, on that occasion, is now I.

"Therefore Ānanda's devotion to me now is just as it was before. And the five hundred arhats rising into the sky above at this time is just as it happened before. And at that time too, though Devadatta did me harm, I, through the force of great compassion, constantly acted for his benefit."

When this Dharma was taught, hundreds of thousands of gods and humans attained results ranging from the first fruit up to the fourth fruit. Some generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and others generated the resolve for the levels of the śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas.

Furthermore, Devadatta's malice was not pacified, and he thought, "I will let the nails of my ten fingers grow long, put poison beneath the nails, go to where the Tathāgata is, and bow my head at his feet. When I bow in this way and take hold of his feet, the poison under my ten nails will be smeared on his feet. The poison will spread, and without a doubt he will die."

Having thought this, he went to where the Tathāgata was, just as he had planned. When he arrived there, he bowed his head at his feet, took hold of his feet with his hands, and smeared on the poison. At that moment the poison

turned into sweet dew and did the Tathāgata no harm.

When things did not turn out as Devadatta had planned, he thought again, "The Tathāgata is now staying alone on Vulture Peak. I will go up that mountain, send a boulder rolling down, and kill him." Having thought this, he went to the summit of the mountain and sent a rockslide down.

"Though the little toe of the Buddha's foot was wounded, through the force of my great compassion I remain impartial toward enemy and friend.

"Furthermore, in times past, beyond countless eons ago, at that time, on that occasion, there appeared in the world the Buddha, the Blessed One called Rightly Teaching, a tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of those to be tamed, teacher, victor.

"After that Buddha had passed into nirvāṇa, during the time when the semblance of the Dharma was practiced, a monk who practiced meditative concentration was staying in a forest grove. At that time many lice were feeding on that monk. Then the monk made this agreement with the lice: 'When I am practicing meditative concentration, stay hidden and do not move.' When he had made this agreement, the lice did just that.

"Then at another time a flea came there and said to the lice, 'How is it that you have become so fat and glossy?' When it asked this, the lice said, 'Our host, who constantly practices meditative concentration, lets us eat our food and drink at the proper times without fail, and that is why we are glossy.'

"The flea said, 'I too will stay with you.' Having said this, it stayed there with them. At that time, while the monk was practicing meditative concentration, the flea caught the smell of flesh and blood and bit the monk. Then the monk, his mind disturbed, took off his robe, threw it into the fire, and burned it.

"The monk who practiced meditative concentration at that time, on that occasion, is the Buddha Kāśyapa. The flea at that time, on that occasion, is Devadatta himself. The one who was a louse at that time, on that occasion, is now I.

"That Devadatta did me harm for the sake of honor and gain, and even now that I have attained complete awakening, for the sake of honor and fame he drew blood from the body of the Buddha and fell into the great hell.

"The harms that Devadatta, with constant malice toward me, has done to the Tathāgata could not be told in full even in an eon, yet the Tathāgata has

always protected him with great compassion, with a loving and tender heart. Through meeting with Devadatta I quickly attained buddhahood, and so, remembering his kindness, I have always protected him with compassion."

At that time the Tathāgata said to Ānanda, "Go into the hell and ask, 'Devadatta, are you greatly tormented by suffering?' and then come back."

Then Ānanda, as the Buddha had instructed, went into the hell. Arriving at the gate of the hell, he said to Abang, the guardian of the hell, "Call Devadatta."

Abang said, "The Devadatta of which buddha do you want? Every buddha of the past has also had someone called Devadatta."

Then Abang said to Devadatta, "Ānanda is now waiting outside the gate and needs to meet you."

Devadatta came there and said to Ānanda, "Have you come well? What does the Tathāgata say? For me now, the happiness here in the Avīci hell is like attaining the bliss of a monk who has entered the third dhyāna."

The Blessed One said, "For the sake of beings, the great bodhisattva, through great skill in means, experiences the countless great sufferings of saṃsāra, of birth and death, and still he does not regard them as harm. If anyone thinks that Devadatta is truly an evildoer who has fallen into the Avīci hell, that cannot be so."

At that time, when the great assembly heard the Tathāgata teach this most profound skill in means of Devadatta's conduct, countless hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena.

Countless hundreds of thousands of gods and humans gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Countless hundreds of thousands of gods and humans attained the fruits from the fruit of stream-entry up to the fruit of arhatship. At that time the gods of the intermediate space let divine flowers fall like rain from the sky above, played divine music, and lit everything with great rays of light, praising, "What the Tathāgata has taught is most wonderful and excellent!" When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the great assembly rejoiced, bowed their heads, and departed.

This concludes the sixth chapter, called Evil Purpose, from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness. Fifth fascicle.

At that time the great assembly paid service and reverence to the Blessed One, made offerings, extolled him and praised him, circled around him, and sat gazing at him. Then the Tathāgata, delighting in his immeasurable and most profound domain of activity, in order to rescue many beings from the unbearable suffering of the three realms of existence, to dispel the five obscurations, to loosen the fetters that bind on every side, to bring all sentient beings to liberation, and to establish them in the bliss of the unconditioned, distinguished and taught two kinds of field of merit. What are the two? The conditioned field of merit and the unconditioned field of merit. And what are these? They are father and mother, the preceptor, the teacher, the Buddha, the Dharma, the Saṅgha, and the bodhisattvas. If sentient beings make merit by offering toward them, they will attain the fruit of the path.

Then the Blessed One said to Śāriputra, foremost of the wise, and the other great close disciples, "Know this: before long the Tathāgata will pass into nirvāṇa."

When Śāriputra heard these words, he felt as if the limbs of his body were pierced with needles. Overwhelmed by grief, he fell to the ground and fainted. Cold water was sprinkled on his face, and after a long while he came to again. He rose, joined his palms, bowed, and praised him with these verses:

"In the nectar of the Buddha's teaching
No listener grows weary or tired;
There is none who falls under the sway of laziness,
And none who is not benefited.

In the ocean of circling through the five destinies,
As if sinking into a mire of filth,
Bound by craving and desire,
The world circles on for lack of knowing.

In former times you practiced true uprightness
And gave impartially;
Therefore you bear the mark between the brows,
And its radiant light is immeasurable.

Your eyes are like the new moon;
You behold every land of the ten directions without exception.
The mind's eye of all beings

Rejoices greatly in seeing you."

Then Śāriputra praised the Tathāgata with a hundred thousand verses, bowed his head at his feet, and circumambulated him a hundred thousand times. Then he said to the gods, nāgas, humans and nonhumans, "Sons of good family, alas, alas, the world is empty! Ah me, ah me, the world is empty! How sad, how sad, the world is empty! The boat and bridge of the precious true Dharma has fallen apart. The tree of unsurpassed awakening is broken. The precious sublime banner has fallen. The sun of the unsurpassed Buddha is setting behind the mountain of the great nirvāṇa."

When he had said this, the whole great assembly was struck with dread, so terrified that every hair on their bodies stood on end. The sun too lost its brightness, the mountains toppled, and the great earth shook violently.

Then Śāriputra spoke these verses to the great assembly:

"I have seen the body of the Buddha,
Like a mountain of refined gold.
His marks and qualities will all cease,
And only his name will remain.

To escape from the three worlds,
Strive with the power of diligence.
If you choose virtuous deeds,
Passing into nirvāṇa is the supreme bliss."

Then Śāriputra, to inspire the great assembly, displayed the power of his miraculous abilities. Through that power he rose into the sky above and emanated a great jeweled elephant with a thousand heads. He showed elephants entwined one with another, their thousand heads facing outward. Each of those elephants had seven tusks, and on each tusk there was a bathing pool. In each pool there were seven lotus flowers. On each lotus sat an emanated buddha. With each emanated buddha was a close disciple Śāriputra, and each Śāriputra sent forth great rays of light, illuminating world systems in the ten directions as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River, and gathered all those whose causes were in accord. When all those possessing the causes had assembled, Śāriputra displayed a great body that filled the whole of space. He also displayed his great body changing into a small one. He entered and emerged from the earth as if it were water, and also vanished from sight. He displayed fire blazing from the lower part of his

body and water streaming from the upper part. Unobstructed in the sky above, he displayed countless miracles of every kind, from a hundred up to a thousand. Then he descended from the sky and taught the Dharma extensively to the great assembly, inspiring, encouraging and gladdening them. He led countless hundreds of thousands of beings to give rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. He brought countless hundreds of thousands of beings to attain the fruits from stream-entry up to the fruit of arhatship, and further, he led countless hundreds of thousands of beings to set their minds on becoming śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Having thus accomplished immeasurable benefit and happiness, Śāriputra said this to the great assembly:

"How shall I manage not to see the Tathāgata pass into nirvāṇa before me?" And rising into the sky above, he brought forth fire from his own body, burned his body, and passed into nirvāṇa.

At that time the members of the great assembly, stricken at heart, gazed at Śāriputra without blinking and wailed with loud cries, until their bodies were covered with dust. The sun too lost its brightness, and heaven and earth shook greatly. Then the great assembly gathered Śāriputra's bones, built a stūpa, and made offerings to it.

At that time hundreds of thousands in the great assembly, because they remembered Śāriputra, were tormented in mind by suffering, and grew dazed and bewildered until they lost their presence of mind. Then the Tathāgata, through the force of his compassion, emanated a Śāriputra and had him sit within the assembly. When the great assembly saw that Śāriputra, the suffering of their sorrow was stilled, and they became joyful once more. With their minds thus filled with joy, they all gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then Ānanda, knowing in his mind through the blessing of the Tathāgata that the great assembly was in doubt, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, knelt with his right knee on the ground, joined his palms, bowed, and said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, for what cause and what condition did this Śāriputra pass into nirvāṇa before the Tathāgata, so that the great assembly is unhappy and grieving?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda and the great assembly, "It is not only now, in this one instance, that Śāriputra has passed into nirvāṇa before the Tathāgata.

In times past as well, unable to bear seeing me pass away first, he passed away first."

Then Ānanda said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, how was it that in times past Śāriputra passed away first?"

The Blessed One said, "Listen well. In times past, countless eons ago, at that time and in that age, there was a land called Vārāṇasī, and the king of the land of Vārāṇasī was called Great Radiance. The king called Great Radiance ruled over sixty petty kings of the borderlands and eight hundred cities. Since that king always had a mind of compassion, he gave generously to all, never going against anyone's wishes.

"At that time one of the petty kings of the borderlands disliked that king and constantly harbored ill will toward him. Every fortnight, on the six observance days, King Great Radiance loaded five hundred elephants with jewels, wealth, clothing, food and drink, heaped them up at the marketplaces and at the four gates of the city, and gave them away to all.

"At that time that hostile petty king heard, 'King Great Radiance gives to all, never going against their wishes, whatever they want, from clothing and food up to gold, silver and jewels.' Hearing this, that petty king of the borderlands grew jealous of the merit of generosity King Great Radiance was making. He gathered his ministers and commanded, 'Which of you can go and beg for the head of King Great Radiance of Vārāṇasī?' The ministers said, 'None of us is equal to it.'

"Then he proclaimed an edict to everyone: 'Whoever begs for the head of King Great Radiance of Vārāṇasī and comes back with it, I will give a thousand sealed measures of gold.' When he had proclaimed this edict, a brahmin said, 'I can go and beg for it. Prepare my provisions and supplies.' From that land to Vārāṇasī was a distance of six thousand krośas, so provisions and supplies were prepared accordingly, and the brahmin set out for Vārāṇasī.

"At that time, as that brahmin arrived in the region of the land of Vārāṇasī, the great earth quaked in six ways. The beasts of prey and the wild animals fled in terror in the four directions. The sun and moon grew dim and invisible, as if eclipsed. The five planets and the stars no longer moved in their proper seasons. Something like rainbows, red, black and white, appeared from time to time by day and by night. The stars were thrown into disorder and fell. The rivers, springs and bathing pools of that land, and its flourishing and lovely flowering and fruit trees, all dried up.

"Then that brahmin came to the gate of the palace of the king of the land of Vārāṇasī. At that time the god who guarded the palace gate said to the human gatekeeper, 'This wicked brahmin has come from far away to beg for the head of King Great Radiance. Do not let him in.' So the brahmin could not enter the palace. He waited and waited for seven days, and then said to the gatekeeper, 'I have come from far away and wish to meet the great king. Announce me.' Then the gatekeeper announced, as asked, 'A brahmin has come from far away and is now waiting at the gate.'

"As soon as the king heard these words, he came out to the gate, welcomed him, and greeted him as a father meets his son. He said, 'Where have you come from? Were you not troubled and wearied on the road?'

"The brahmin said, 'In another land I heard of your virtue, O king, of how you give without going against people's wishes. Your fair name is renowned throughout heaven and earth, and I heard that your virtue is no lie but true. So I too have made the journey on purpose over mountains and valleys, and I have come with a hope.'

"The king said, 'I am now called the one who gives everything. If you would ask, or if you have some need, ask without hesitation.'

"The brahmin said, 'Is that really true? I need nothing else at all. I am holding a great sacrifice, and so I have come to beg for the king's head.'

"When the king heard these words, he thought, 'From beginningless time I have circled through birth and death, and though I have wasted bodies like this one, it was never for the sake of the Dharma as it should be. Circling through birth and death to no purpose, I have been afflicted.

I have vowed to accomplish unsurpassed awakening with this body for the sake of all sentient beings, so if I were to break that vow, it would contradict my original resolve. And if I do not give this body, how shall I ever attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening?' Thinking this, he was overjoyed with the brahmin, and said, 'Let me give some brief instructions on the governing of the realm to the queens and the princes. Then in seven days I will give you what you want.'

"Then the great king went into the palace and addressed the queens: 'Between heaven and earth, all who are dear and beloved will be parted and separated. For humans, where there is birth there is death; where there can be creation, there can also be destruction. Whatever grows from the earth in

summer all withers in winter.' So he spoke.

"When the queens and the princes heard these words the king had spoken, they were like a person choking, who can neither spit out nor swallow. They asked the king, 'Why do you say this?' The king said, 'A brahmin has come from far away to beg for my head, and I have agreed to give it.'

"When the queens and the princes heard these words, they threw themselves on the ground and wailed, tore their hair, and rent their clothes, and they said, 'Great king, if in the world nothing is dearer than one's own body, why do you give away and offer what is so very hard to give?'

"At that time the five hundred ministers also said to the brahmin, 'What do you want with this head, foul and filthy, full of pus and blood?' The brahmin said, 'I asked for it because I need it. Why should you question me?' The ministers said, 'You have come to our land, so we question you, and it is right that you answer properly.' Then, though the brahmin would have spoken plainly, he feared that the ministers would part him from his life, and in his fear he said nothing at all.

"Then the five hundred ministers said to the brahmin, 'Do not be afraid. We grant you safety.' Then they said to the brahmin, 'Poor brahmin, what use to you is that foul head of pus and blood? Each one of us five hundred ministers will exchange it for a head made of the seven precious substances, and we will also give you whatever you need, enough to last for seven generations.' The brahmin said, 'I do not want that.'

"The great ministers, their hopes unfulfilled, were tormented in mind with grief. They cried aloud, wept, and said to the king, 'Great king, for the sake of one brahmin you would abandon everything, the land, the subjects, the queens, the princes and the rest, and leave us orphaned forever. Can your heart bear to leave us behind?' The king said, 'I am giving away and offering this body for the sake of you and of all sentient beings.'

"At that time one of the great inner ministers heard what the king said and thought, 'Without doubt the king will give his body to this brahmin. It is a calamity.' And he thought, 'My heart cannot bear the king's giving up his body; I shall not look upon it.' He went into a secluded room, took up a sharp weapon, and cut off his own life.

"Then the great king went to the garden behind the palace, called the brahmin, and said, 'Come here. Now take my head. Out of love and affection

for you, I will not turn aside your heart's wish. By this gift, may I in the future obtain the head of wisdom.' He joined his palms and bowed to the ten directions. Having bowed, he said, 'Buddhas and bodhisattvas of the ten directions, regard me with loving care, and bless me that this aspiration of mine may be fulfilled.' Then he said to the brahmin, 'Now I give it to you. Take it.'

"The brahmin said, 'The king has the strength of a mighty wrestler. Unable to bear the pain, he would turn and harm me. King, if you truly are able to do this, untie your hair yourself and fasten it to a tree.'

"When the king heard these words, a mind of still greater compassion arose in him, and he thought, 'This brahmin is thin and feeble. If he cannot cut off my head, my great aspiration will not be fulfilled.' So the king himself tied his topknot to the tree, and said to the brahmin, 'Cut off my head, and then place it back in my hands. With my own hands I will give it to you.'

"Then the brahmin took up a sword and crept toward him. At that moment the god of that tree struck the brahmin, and he fell senseless to the ground. Then King Great Radiance said to the god of the tree, 'Rather than helping me, will you turn and become an obstacle and a hindrance to my virtue?' Then the god of the tree, tormented with grief, cried, 'Alas, alas!' From a cloudless sky rain fell as blood, the great earth shook violently, and the sun lost its brightness and all grew dark. Then the brahmin cut off the king's head and went back to his own land.

"Then the five hundred princes and the ministers gathered the bones of King Great Radiance, built a stūpa, and made offerings to it."

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "The great inner minister of that time and that age, who could not bear to see King Great Radiance make the great gift of his head and so died first, is now Śāriputra. He who at that time and in that age was King Great Radiance is now I, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni. Thus the bodhisattva vowed to practice what is exceedingly hard to practice, and for the sake of all sentient beings repaid the kindness of the buddhas, and fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Therefore Śāriputra, unable to bear seeing with his eyes my passing into nirvāṇa, passed into nirvāṇa first; and in times past too, unable to bear seeing me make that gift, he died first. Here in this garden behind the palace, at this very tree, I gave away heads as a wheel-turning king a full thousand times. What need is there, then, even to mention giving the limbs of the body, hands, feet and the

rest?"

When the Buddha taught of these austerities he had performed, countless hundreds of thousands of sentient beings gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Countless hundreds of thousands of gods and humans attained the fruits from the fruit of stream-entry up to the fruit of arhatship. Countless hundreds of thousands of gods and humans set their minds on becoming śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the whole great assembly of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, humans, nonhumans and the rest rejoiced and departed.

Furthermore, it was like this. In the land of Magadha, five hundred bandits who lived among the mountain crags were constantly robbing, so that travelers could no longer go to and fro. At that time the king of the land of Magadha marshaled his fourfold army, overpowered the bandits, gouged out their eyes, cut off their ears and noses too, and cast them away among the steep mountain crags. At that time the five hundred bandits were tormented by the pain in their bodies and came close to death.

Among those five hundred bandits was one who had become a disciple of the Buddha. He said, "We are not far from death. Why do we not all go for refuge to the Buddha?" Then the five hundred bandits cried out with one voice, "Homage to the Buddha Śākyamuni!"

At that time the Tathāgata was staying on Vulture Peak. Through the force of his great compassion he went to a mountain called Gandha. A great wind arose, and on that mountain, where there was a grove of sandalwood trees, it raised a sandalwood powder that filled the whole expanse of the sky, and the sandalwood powder reached the mountain where the bandits were. That sandalwood powder settled on the bandits' wounds, and their eyes, their noses and all the wounds of their bodies were healed, and their blood too turned into milk. Then they all said, "Through the great compassion of the Buddha all the wounds of our bodies have been healed and we are at ease. To repay the Buddha's kindness, we set our minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." Having said this, they all vowed with one voice, "We shall bring ordinary beings who have not attained happiness to attain happiness. We shall liberate those who are not liberated. We shall bring those who have not reached the far shore to the far shore. We shall bring those who have not attained the fruit to attain the fruit."

Furthermore, it was like this. The great compassion of the Tathāgata and his miraculous power of skillful means are inconceivable. When the Buddha was staying in Śrāvastī, five hundred bandits lived among the mountain crags, robbing travelers and doing what is contrary to the Dharma. At that time the Tathāgata, through the force of his skillful means, emanated himself as a man riding a fine elephant. He wore clothes on his body and carried a bow and arrows and weapons. The elephant was adorned with the seven precious substances, and his own body too was adorned with the seven precious substances, and he went alone along the side of the mountain crags where the bandits lived.

At that time the five hundred bandits saw such a man coming from afar, and said to one another, "In all our many years as bandits we have never seen anything like this."

At that time the bandits had a leader, and he asked, "What have you seen?" They said, "There is a man riding a fine elephant coming this way. That man's clothes and ornaments are made of the seven precious substances, and the elephant too is adorned with the seven precious substances. Someone like that, shining over heaven and earth, is coming straight along the road. If we strike that man and seize him, we will have riches enough to last seven generations."

At that time, when the bandit leader heard these words, he was overjoyed, and he planned it thus: "Let us creep up slowly, and when we have come near, all of us shoot arrows and seize him." Then the five hundred bandits approached him and, all at once, raised a great shout.

At that time the emanated man, with a mind of love and compassion, drew his bow and shot, and each of the five hundred bandits was struck by one arrow. Suffering unbearable pain, they rolled on the ground, cried aloud and wept. When they tried to pull the arrows out, the arrows were lodged so fast that, though they strained with all the strength they had, they could not do it. Then the five hundred bandits were terrified and thought, "Now we shall surely die." Why? "It is a great marvel that all of us together could not overcome a single man." And all with one voice they spoke thus:

"Among humans, what are you?
A god, a nāga, or a hungry ghost?
Or is it the power of a spell?
By one arrow shot, five hundred are wounded.

The suffering of this pain is hard to bear;
For our lives' sake we beg of you,
Please draw out these venomous arrows.
From now on we shall not offend."

Then the emanated man spoke in verse:

"No wound goes beyond the wound of the axe;
Among missiles the short arrow is supreme.
Youth and a wrestler's strength cannot remove it;
Through much learning it comes to be no more."

At that time, having spoken this verse, the emanated man changed back into the body of a buddha and sent forth great rays of light, illuminating all the world systems of the ten directions. Blind beings touched by that light came to see forms with their eyes. The lame and the hunchbacked were straightened again. Those whose bodies lacked hands or feet came to possess all their limbs. The insane too regained their presence of mind. In short, everything that was unpleasant became pleasant.

At that time the Tathāgata taught the five hundred bandits the Dharma in many ways, inspiring, encouraging and gladdening them. When the five hundred bandits heard the Dharma they were overjoyed; the wounds of their bodies were healed and their blood turned into milk. They set their minds on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and all with one voice they offered these verses:

"Having set our minds on awakening,
We shall bring vast benefit to beings.
We shall train in the Buddha's teaching
And always offer reverence and service.

Protected by the force of the Buddha's compassion,
Freed from suffering, our minds and bodies are at ease.
The buddhas and the bodhisattvas
And our spiritual friends: we shall remember their kindness.

Teachers, masters, fathers and mothers,
And all other sentient beings,
Friend and foe alike, we shall regard with an equal mind.
The merit of repaying kindness has no equal."

At that time, in the sky above, the gods of the desire realm, Śakra, lord of the gods, and the rest, let divine flowers fall like rain, made offerings to the Tathāgata with divine music, and with one voice offered these verses:

"Through our merit of the past
Our light and radiance are supremely beautiful.
With sublime articles of offering
We act for the benefit of all.

To meet a buddha is exceedingly hard;
To hear the true Dharma is extremely hard.
Because in former times we made roots of virtue,
We have met the god of the Śākyas.

To remember the Buddha's kindness
We set our minds on awakening.
Our seeing of the Buddha
And the virtues of the three vehicles
We dedicate wholly to unsurpassed awakening
For the sake of all beings without exception."

At that time, having spoken these verses, the gods circumambulated him a hundred thousand times, bowed their heads to the Buddha, and went back up into the sky.

Furthermore, it was like this. The power of the Tathāgata's skillful means and of the roots of virtue of his great compassion is inconceivable. At that time, in the land of Vaiśālī, there was a brahmin who clung to wrong views and was wholly in the grip of pride. Śāriputra and Mahāmaudgalyāyana befriended that brahmin and often went to his house and taught him the Dharma, but he did not gain faith and remained attached to his evil views.

That brahmin was very rich and had a great many precious jewels, but he had no son. He thought, "If I die, all my wealth and livestock will be taken back." Then he made offerings and prayers to the gods of the sacred mountains, the gods of the trees and others like them, and after ninety days his wife became pregnant. When the months were complete she gave birth to a boy, handsome, lovely to behold, bearing the marks of a fine man, dear to his parents' hearts, and pleasing to many.

They raised that son, and when he was twenty years old he went wandering outside with his friends to see the shows. On the road he met a plowing ox,

was trampled by it, and died. When the parents heard that their son had died, they cried aloud, wept and wailed, rolled on the ground, covered their bodies with dust, and tore their hair, saying, "In a single morning my treasure is gone!" Wailing, they went to where their son's corpse lay, took the corpse in their arms, and wept until they fainted and came to again, until they were out of their minds. They cast off their clothes and went about naked, and so they met the Tathāgata.

Then the Tathāgata, through the force of his great compassion, emanated their son and let them meet him. The boy's parents were filled with great joy. They took the boy in their arms, their madness cleared, and their minds returned to them, and the Tathāgata taught them the Dharma. When the brahmin heard the Dharma, at once he gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Furthermore, it was like this. The power of the Tathāgata's great compassion and roots of virtue is inconceivable. At that time King Vaiḍūrya marshaled his fourfold army, defeated the people of Kapilavastu, and seized the sons of the Śākyas. He dug pits in the earth as deep as their armpits and buried them in the ground so that they could neither stir nor move. When they had been buried in the ground like this for seven days, the Tathāgata, through the power of his great compassion, transformed the pits into bathing pools. The water of the pools had the eight qualities, and lotus flowers covered their surface: padma and puṇḍarīka lotuses, blue, red, yellow and white, as large as chariot wheels, covered them completely. He also emanated birds of many kinds singing sweetly. At that time, when this happened, the sons of the Śākyas were filled with great joy, and at once they gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

When they had set their minds on awakening, King Vaiḍūrya made five hundred fierce black elephants drunk with liquor and maddened, shod their feet with iron hooves, tied sharp swords to their trunks, and, raising evil cries, made them trample the sons of the Śākyas. The hooves of the beasts trampled the sons of the Śākyas and left their joints, flesh, skin and bones all ground into a filthy pulp on the earth.

Through the power of the Tathāgata's great compassion they felt no distress in mind or body. Because body and mind were at ease, they gave rise to the mind of awakening. Because they had given rise to the mind of awakening, they came to have an even, impartial mind toward all sentient beings.

Because their minds were impartial, they had no thought of hatred. Because they had no hatred, when they passed from that life they were reborn as gods in the heavens.

Having been reborn as gods in the heavens, they examined with the divine eye from what cause this had first come about, and they said to one another, "Through the kindness of the Buddha's great compassion we have been born as gods. We have mansions of the seven precious substances and sublime divine garments, our bodies have light, and we possess music and every enjoyment of bliss. Since this has come about through the miraculous power of the Tathāgata, we too shall give rise to the mind of great compassion for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. Wherever the Buddha's Dharma is, whether in a village, a town, on a mountain, in a grove, at the foot of a tree, in a palace compound or in a house, wherever this sūtra is studied, read, recited or explained, in that place we shall provide and offer whatever is wished, so that the Dharma is never interrupted. In that place we shall guard and protect it day and night, so that harm from weapons, epidemics and famine do not arise."

When they had made this aspiration, the life span, strength, bodily complexion and luminosity of those gods became even finer than before, and in great joy they departed back through the sky.

Furthermore, the great compassion of the Tathāgata's skillful means and the power of his roots of virtue are inconceivable. At that time King Vaiḍūrya, after he had conquered the land of Kapilavastu and wiped out the sons of the Śākyas, chose five hundred daughters of the Śākyas, beautiful and more accomplished in every art than others. Surrounded by these five hundred young women and with music playing, he returned to his own land. Gathering together with his queens and consorts in the palace, he sat down cross-legged. Seated on his throne, he said, "I am happy! Excellent!"

Then the daughters of the Śākyas said to King Vaiḍūrya, "Why are you happy?"

The king said, "I am happy because I have triumphed over my enemies."

The young women said, "You have not triumphed. Even if the king's entire fourfold army had risen up, it could not have overcome a single son of the Śākyas. Because we Śākyas have become disciples of the Buddha and do not contend with anyone, the king has merely won. Did you not, having given rise to evil intent, lead your fourfold army against Kapilavastu three or four times, one after another, and were you not always defeated? When you first led your

army there, the sons of the Śākyas said this: 'If we fight with this shameless, ungrateful King Vaiḍūrya who comes to harm us, there will be no distinction at all between the wise and the foolish, and neither white nor black will be evident. Let us merely frighten him so as to turn him back.' And they all vowed thus: 'We shall shoot our arrows all at once, but we shall not wound or harm the other side.' Then they arrayed their fourfold army and met your army forty krośas out in front, and when they all shot their arrows the stream of arrows was unbroken. King, did you not take fright and turn back?

"Then again, after ninety days had passed, you once more led your fourfold army against the Śākyas and attacked. At that time the sons of the Śākyas deliberated thus: 'This evil King Vaiḍūrya, who knows neither shame nor embarrassment, has now come again to harm us, so we Śākyas make this vow: we shall shoot our arrows at those enemies all at once, without harming their bodies, cutting all the lacings of their armor so that their armor falls loose.' Having vowed this, all the Śākyas shot their arrows, cut all the lacings of the armor, and left them naked. Then, prince, you were frightened and deliberated, 'If it comes to our lives, what shall we do?' Did not one minister then give this counsel: 'The Śākyas are disciples of the Buddha, so they keep the precept of not taking life, and because their compassion is great they did not harm us. Were it otherwise, our bodies and lives would be gone'? When he had said this, you said, 'If that is true, then attack still further.' At that time the sons of the Śākyas remained without moving a hand. Though King Vaiḍūrya's fourfold army drew near, the sons of the Śākyas remained without fighting back.

"Then a brahmin who was there said to the Śākyas, 'Now that disaster has come, why do you remain without fighting back?' The Śākyas said, 'We do not contend with anyone. If we were to contend with this, we would not be worthy to be disciples of the Buddha.' Then that brahmin, displeased with what they had said, stepped forward alone in front of the Śākyas and attacked King Vaiḍūrya's army. Each arrow he shot wounded seven men at a time, so that before long many were wounded and killed. King, did you not turn back with your fourfold army? After the army had turned back, the Śākyas thought, 'It is not right for us to stay and keep company with this brahmin.' With this thought the Śākyas assembled and expelled the brahmin from that land. It was after that brahmin had been expelled that the king again led his fourfold army, conquered the land of Kapilavastu, and won."

Then King Vaiḍūrya was abashed and ashamed. He summoned low-caste butchers, had the hands and feet of the daughters of the Śākyas chopped off and their noses and ears cut off, carted them away, and threw them into a charnel ground. Then the daughters of the Śākyas, their hands and feet cut off, rolled about on the ground, experiencing great suffering, and were at the point of death. Tormented by suffering, some of the daughters of the Śākyas called out the names of their fathers and mothers, brothers and sisters; some called upon heaven; some called upon the earth; some cried out in utter misery.

Among them, one who was foremost among the daughters of the Śākyas said to the young women, "Sisters, know this. Once I heard this from the Buddha: I heard that whoever is destitute and in distress, if they single-mindedly bring the Buddha to mind and recite his name, then as their life ebbs away they will accomplish what they wish and will come to happiness."

Then the five hundred daughters of the Śākyas bowed with one-pointed minds and said in unison, "Homage to the Buddha Śākyamuni, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha!" And they cried out, "Alas, alas! Oh, how wretched! Oh, how wretched! Blessed One, Sugata!"

The moment they had said this, through the force of the Tathāgata's great compassion, a cloud of great compassion gathered in the sky above. Rain fell from that cloud of great compassion, and the raindrops struck the young women's bodies. As soon as the rain touched them, their hands, feet and all their other limbs were restored just as they had been before. Then the daughters of the Śākyas were overjoyed, and all of them said with one voice, "The Tathāgata is our loving father and mother! The unsurpassed Blessed One is the sublime medicine of the world! He is the eye that gives the world light! He is the one who liberates from the suffering of the three realms! He is the giver of supreme bliss!"

"Why do we say this? Because we have been freed from the torment of suffering. In order to remember the Buddha's kindness, if we now wish to repay the Buddha's kindness, by what means shall we repay it? The body of the Tathāgata is a vajra body, an everlasting body, a body without hunger or thirst, a body of sublime form. He is endowed with the inconceivable perfection of the meditative concentrations, the samādhis, the faculties, the powers and the limbs of awakening. He is fully adorned with the thirty-two major marks and the eighty excellent minor marks. He abides in the great

parinirvāṇa and regards all sentient beings as he regards Rāhula. He regards friend and foe alike, and hopes for no reward. If we now wish to repay the Buddha's kindness, let us go forth, keep moral discipline, and uphold the sublime Dharma." With this thought they sought robes and alms bowls and went to a nunnery to request ordination.

When we arrived at the nuns' dwelling, we first met the group of six nuns, and the group of six nuns admonished us thus: "Girls, you are young and in the bloom of youth, lovely and beautiful. Why do you think of giving up what is so hard to give up, and think of going forth? Would you not be happier enjoying the five sense pleasures of the world? Once you have known happiness and reached old age, would it not be soon enough to go forth?" So they admonished us. The six nuns had thought, "If these girls do not go forth, they will surely give us their robes, their alms bowls and everything they own," and with this thought they obstructed the daughters of the Śākyas from going forth.

When the young women heard these words they became all the more unhappy and were overcome with grief. "Why must we meet with yet another great danger such as this? Just as there may be deadly poison in fine food, so too are these nuns. Even we know that the five sense pleasures of the world are full of the faults of danger, so why do these nuns see them as good qualities?" With this thought they cried out aloud and wept.

Then we came away, and as we went along we met the nun Utpalavarṇā, who asked us, "Why are you weeping?"

We said, "We are weeping because things with the nuns did not turn out as we had hoped."

Utpalavarṇā said, "What did you hope for that has not come about?"

"We asked to be ordained, but we were not permitted to go forth."

Utpalavarṇā said, "If you wish to go forth, I shall ordain you."

The daughters of the Śākyas were overjoyed and went forth as disciples of Utpalavarṇā. Having gone forth in this way, they all gathered and talked together, saying, "Before we went forth, we did not merely experience a little suffering. Our fathers, mothers, relatives and friends were killed by the enemy, and our noses, ears, hands and feet were all cut and chopped off. We experienced inexhaustible, unimaginable suffering."

Utpalavarṇā said, "What is there to talk about in suffering only that much? It does not compare with the account of the suffering I experienced before I went forth."

The daughters of the Śākyas joined their palms and said to their preceptor, "Please tell us what kind of suffering you experienced when you had not yet gone forth."

Then the nun Utpalavarṇā entered samādhi and, by the might of her higher perception, sent forth great rays of light that illuminated Jambudvīpa. She gathered gods, nāgas, yakṣas, humans, nonhumans and others who were linked to her by karma and concordant causes, and to that great assembly she spoke thus:

"Before I went forth, I was living in the land of Śrāvastī, and my father and mother gave me as a bride to a man who lived in the north. According to the custom of the land of those northerners, when a woman was about to give birth she was sent back to her parents' land to give birth. In this way I gave birth over many years, one child after another. Later, when I was about to give birth to another child, I set out for my parents' land together with my husband, with horses and a carriage for our conveyance. When we had gone halfway, there was a river in flood, and we could not cross it, so that night we slept on the riverbank in a lonely pasture.

"That night I gave birth, and a venomous snake in the grass caught the smell of blood and came toward where I had given birth. Before it reached me, it came upon my husband and a servant who were sleeping, and it bit them, killing the servant first. Then it came upon my husband. I called to him, 'A snake is coming! A snake is coming!' but he did not hear, and my husband too was killed. Then it killed the horses, the oxen and all the beasts of burden. I alone escaped. The next day, when dawn broke and I looked, I saw my husband's corpse swollen and the blood lying on the ground like mire. I was terrified and fell to the ground. Then I cried out loudly and wept, beat my breast with my fists, tore out my hair, and fell upon the corpse.

"For many days in this way I could not get across the water and stayed on the riverbank. Later, when the flood had subsided, I left the eldest child on the near bank, carried the middle child on my back, and put the youngest in the fold of my garment. Holding the fold in my teeth, I waded into the water. When I had gone halfway across, I looked back at my children and saw that a tiger had come and seized the eldest. I opened my mouth and screamed, and the

fold of my garment slipped away, and the youngest fell into the water. As I grabbed for the youngest, the child on my back also slipped off, and all my children died. So one child was eaten by the tiger and the others died in the water. I reached the far side, so tormented by suffering that my heart all but split, and I vomited blood from my mouth. I wailed, 'Alas, alas!' and sat weeping, saying, 'In a single day I have come to see suffering such as this!'

"Before long a large party of travelers arrived there. Among those travelers was a householder who was a close friend of my parents. I went to him and asked for news of my parents. The householder said this to me: 'Fire broke out in your parents' house, and the house burned down. Your father and mother were burned as well.' When I heard these words, I fainted and fell to the ground."

"Then, after a long while, I came to again and went on, and as I traveled, my companions met with five hundred bandits and were overcome. At that time the bandit chief took me as his wife and always made me keep watch at the door. When he set me to keep watch at the door, he commanded me, 'If there is any emergency, keep a sharp lookout and let me in.'

"Then, at another time, that husband went off with the bandits to rob and plunder, and he was pursued by the people of the king's city. In distress he fled back home, and he arrived just at the time when I was giving birth. Although I heard my husband calling at the door, I could not open it. At that time the husband thought, 'This wife of mine must be plotting to harm me; she will not even open the door.' With this thought he climbed over the wall and came inside. He said to his wife, 'Why do you not open the door?' The wife said, 'I could not open the door because I was giving birth.'

"Then that husband grew angry and commanded, 'As long as there is a body, there will be children. Since you have harmed me, even though you have this child, no matter what, kill it at once!' At that time I loved the child too much and could not bring myself to kill it. Then my husband drew his sword, cut off the child's hands and feet, and said, 'Eat this flesh! If you do not eat the flesh, I will cut off your head!' Then, terrified, I ate the child's flesh. When I had eaten the child's flesh in this way, his anger subsided.

"Then, at yet another time, he went off to steal and plunder, was caught by the king, and was put to death according to the law. At that time, by the custom of that king's land, when a thief had been killed, the thief's corpse and his wife, still alive, were placed in a tomb. Others saw that I had been placed in

the tomb together with my ornaments, and soon afterward someone who wanted my ornaments dug open the tomb at night, took me away as well, and made me his wife. Before long that tomb robber too was caught by the king and executed according to the law. By the custom of the land, the thief's wife was again placed alive in the tomb with the corpse. Then, before long, hungry wolves ate the corpse and dug their way out, and I too escaped from there.

"Bewildered as though drunk, I wandered on and met a large crowd of people, and I said to them, 'I am tormented by a great many sufferings, and now I long for a place of happiness free from sorrow.' Then a brahmin householder, out of compassion for me, said this to me: 'I have heard that if one enters the Dharma of the Buddha Śākyamuni, there are no conditions for the afflictions, and one is utterly happy.' When I heard these words, a mind of great joy arose in me. I went to where the nuns, the great Prajāpatī and Yaśodharā, were, and when I arrived I went forth. Having gone forth, I meditated step by step and attained the fruit, and came to possess the three knowledges, the six higher perceptions and the eight liberations. Through that cause and that condition, before I went forth I experienced such great suffering, and having experienced it, through that condition I went forth and also attained the fruit."

At that time, when the daughters of the Śākyas heard her say this, a mind of great joy arose in them, and they obtained the stainless Dharma eye with regard to the Dharma. The assembly listening to the Dharma also made aspirations for awakening and departed in joy.

At that time the Buddha's aunt and foster mother, the nun Gautamī, said this to the nuns, the probationary nuns, the novices, the laywomen and all women: "The Buddha's Dharma possesses the qualities that bring benefit and happiness to all. In order to attain the three kinds of fruit, all sentient beings have the fortune to enter the ocean of the Tathāgata's Dharma, but it has not been granted to us women. That is because all women have many obscurations; they cannot let go, and are attached and clinging; they are open to countless thoroughly afflicted actions; their understanding is small and they cling; they are lazy and very proud; with this very body they cannot become a cause of awakening, and they are not fit to attain the thirty-two major marks; while wandering in saṃsāra they cannot attain the supreme fruit of a wheel-turning king and gather many beings by the Dharma of the ten virtues; they do not attain the unsurpassed means of a king of Brahmās, and cannot urge the turning of the wheel of the sublime Dharma for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. Therefore the Tathāgata has not permitted

women to become disciples who enter the Dharma. Just as divine māras, those with evil views and all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) are forever attached to and clinging to evil views, and wish to destroy the sublime Dharma and to overthrow the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, so likewise the Tathāgata has not permitted women to enter, even though they have faith in the Buddha's Dharma.

"For the sake of all women I asked the Tathāgata again and again, up to three times, for permission to enter the Buddha's Dharma, but he did not grant it. Though I asked up to three times in this way, he did not grant it, and since things did not turn out as I had hoped, I was overcome by unhappiness and grief. With my eyes full of tears I came away, and as I went along I met Ānanda on the road. Ānanda asked me, 'Mother, why are you so unhappy and grieving?' At that time I said this to Ānanda: 'I have faith and devotion in the Buddha's Dharma, and I asked the Tathāgata up to three times, but he did not grant it. That is why I am unhappy and grieving.' When I had said this, Ānanda said to me, 'Mother, do not be unhappy. I shall ask the Tathāgata, and I shall bring you, Mother, into the Buddha's teaching.' Then at once I became joyful.

"Then Ānanda went to where the Buddha was, and when he arrived he said this: 'Blessed One, if you grant me the opportunity to ask a question, I shall ask the Blessed One.' The Blessed One declared, 'Ask whatever you wish.' Then Ānanda said this to the Blessed One:"

"Mother Gautamī nourished and raised the Tathāgata's form body, and that he has now become fully awakened is also because of his mother as a condition that he became perfectly and completely awakened. Since his mother has been so kind to the Tathāgata, and the Tathāgata permits even all sentient beings to enter the Buddha's teaching, what need is there to speak of his mother entering the Buddha's teaching?"

The Blessed One declared to Ānanda, "It is as you say. It is not that the Tathāgata does not know how kind his mother has been to the Tathāgata, yet he has not permitted women to enter the Buddha's teaching. If the Tathāgata were to permit women to enter the Buddha's teaching, the sublime Dharma would decline five hundred years earlier. Therefore the Tathāgata is not pleased to have women enter the Buddha's teaching."

Then Ānanda bowed his head at the Buddha's feet, joined his palms, bowed, and again said this to the Blessed One: "As I clearly recall, all the buddhas of the past had the fourfold assembly. Will not the Buddha Śākyamuni alone have

the fourfold assembly?"

The Buddha declared to Ānanda, "If Gautamī has faith in the Buddha's Dharma in this way, then if she gives rise to great diligence and practices the eight rules of respect in complete purity, she is permitted to enter the Buddha's Dharma."

Then Ānanda bowed his head at the Buddha's feet, circumambulated him three times, went back, and said this to his mother: "I earnestly entreated the Tathāgata, and you, Mother, are permitted to enter the Dharma."

"Most excellent! Ānanda, it is excellent that you entreated the Tathāgata again and again, so that things have turned out as your mother hoped." When his mother heard from Ānanda that she was permitted to enter the Tathāgata's teaching, she was overjoyed: "Today, here, this impermanent body of mine has become a permanent, precious body. This life of mine too, which changes and passes away from moment to moment, has today, here, become a precious life. Until now my body, my life and my wealth have existed merely from the coming together of conditions, but now I have found precious wealth." Seeing in this way great qualities of benefit and happiness, she gave rise to a mind to honor and serve Ānanda all the more, and she said this to Ānanda: "Have no doubt. I shall practice in accordance with what the Tathāgata has intended and taught, and even if it costs me my body and life, I shall not let it lapse." Then the Tathāgata also explained in detail how the eight rules of respect are not to be allowed to lapse.

At that time Mother Gautamī, by the force of great compassion, for the sake of all women of the future, again said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, if in the future there should be a woman who has faith and devotion in the Buddha's Dharma, please permit her as well to enter the teaching."

The Blessed One declared, "Excellent! Any woman who protects and upholds the Buddha's Dharma and gradually takes up moral discipline, generosity, much learning and the virtuous dharmas is permitted to go forth; and even if she remains a householder, she is permitted to receive the three refuges, the five precepts and up to the full precepts, and to enter into liberation and on up to the dharmas of the limbs of awakening. If she strives earnestly in these, she will also attain the three kinds of fruit, and will attain even the nirvāṇa of gods and humans."

When Gautamī heard him say this, she was overjoyed, delighted and glad at heart, and she said this to the Blessed One: "That I have attained the fruit is also the kindness of the Buddha."

The Blessed One declared, "Do not say so. It is not that the Tathāgata has shown kindness to sentient beings. The Tathāgata does not think, 'I have been kind to sentient beings,' or 'I have not been kind.' If the Tathāgata were to count up his kindnesses to sentient beings, his mind of equanimity would be impaired. Gautamī, if the Tathāgata were to think, 'I have been kind to sentient beings,' or 'I have not,' there would be no equanimity at all. Why is that? Even if some sentient being does harm to the Buddha, there is no aversion toward that being; and even if some sentient being anoints the Tathāgata's body with a paste of incense and sandalwood, the Tathāgata does not think of being pleased with that being. The Tathāgata regards sentient beings with equanimity. This is Ānanda's kindness, not the Tathāgata's kindness, for it is through Ānanda as a condition that women have come to enter the Buddha's teaching. Gautamī, in the future, nuns, laywomen and women should always keep Ānanda in mind single-mindedly. They should honor and serve him greatly, recite his name, and constantly remember his kindness. Or else they should not forget him in the six periods of the day and night; they should remember him."

Then Gautamī instructed the nuns and the women thus: "We take refuge in our teacher Ānanda for as long as we live. Any woman who wishes always to be happy and content, to have good fortune and to attain the fruit should always, on the eighth day of the middle month of spring and on the eighth day of the middle month of autumn, put on new, clean clothes, single-mindedly take the eight precepts for one day and night, and, rousing diligence, make offerings during the six periods. Then Ānanda will protect her through the might of his miraculous power and bring about whatever she wishes."

The great assembly, having heard the Dharma, was overjoyed, circumambulated, and departed.

This concludes the chapter called Compassion, the seventh, from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness, fascicle six.

At that time the Tathāgata was surrounded by a great assembly, who made offerings and paid him service, showed him honor and reverence, and sat praising and extolling him. Then Ānanda, perceiving with his mind the doubts

of the great assembly, rose from his seat and said this to the Buddha:

"Blessed One, why did you permit even someone of low birth and base caste, such as Aniruddha, to go forth? Because Aniruddha has gone forth, the minds of faith and respect of all the royal caste and the merchant caste have declined. Because their minds of faith have declined in this way, their grounds of merit have entirely declined. Even the monk Nanda, son of King Śuddhodana, has given rise to a contemptuous attitude."

Then the Blessed One declared this to Ānanda and the great assembly: "Listen well. It would be easier for you to say that the Tathāgata lacks the great compassion of equanimity, the three close applications of mindfulness, the five wisdoms and samādhi, than to say that the monk Aniruddha is truly of low birth and base caste, or of inferior conduct, inferior aspiration or inferior diligence. Can that be said? It would be easier for you to call the Tathāgata afflicted, impermanent, subject to change and passing away, but it is not right to say that the monk Aniruddha went forth from a low birth and base caste. Since the Tathāgata speaks words of genuine truth through the wisdom of omniscience, you should trust what the Tathāgata has said.

"The Tathāgata, seeing and knowing the faults and flaws of saṃsāra, became perfectly and completely awakened by himself. Through going forth, one such as the monk Aniruddha has come to possess the three knowledges, the six higher perceptions and the eight liberations, and has become an object of offering for gods and humans. He has become supreme and sublime as a protector of the sublime Dharma and an upholder of the Vinaya. Because he has become an object of offering for all, even ordinary beings come to attain the three sublime fruits through him, namely: they attain a fruit in the present, a fruit in their next birth and a fruit in the future. Therefore Aniruddha possesses supreme and sublime conduct; he is a bodhisattva of utterly great compassion. In times past, too, he generated roots of virtue with and paid homage to as many as hundreds of thousands of koṭis of countless buddhas, and in the Dharma of those buddhas too he was foremost among the upholders of the Vinaya. Now, in the Dharma of the Buddha Śākyamuni as well, he has become foremost among the upholders of the Vinaya."

At that time, when the monk Nanda had heard what the Buddha said, he rose from his seat, bowed his head at the feet of the noble Kauṇḍinya, and went on down the line to Aniruddha, where he merely joined his palms and gave a slight bow. Then the Blessed One spoke to Nanda in verse:

"Nanda, you should understand this:
One does not become poor and wretched,
Nor does one's greatness decline;
This is the very nature of going forth."

When the Blessed One had instructed Nanda in this way, encouraged him and spoken many kinds of delightful Dharma, Nanda was overjoyed and delighted. He arranged his robe and bowed his head at the feet of the noble Aniruddha, and at that very moment heaven and earth shook in six ways. His body and mind became pliant and workable; he fully attained his own aim and did what had to be done.

Then the Blessed One said to the noble Aniruddha, "Quickly roar your lion's roar! That is, teach the Three Jewels, the four truths, the distinctions among the seven assemblies of householders and renunciants, their three refuges, and the moral disciplines from the five precepts up to all the moral disciplines: the moral discipline of benefiting sentient beings, the moral discipline of purifying the afflictions, the moral discipline of taming through deportment, the moral discipline of meditative concentration and the uncontaminated moral discipline; and so make the lineage of the Three Jewels flourish."

Then Aniruddha said this to the Blessed One: "If the Tathāgata will bless me through the might of his miraculous power, I shall ask the Tathāgata a little." He asked: "What is it that is called the Three Jewels? If the Three Jewels called the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha have no distinct characteristics, why are there distinctions and differences between the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and how is taking refuge in the Three Jewels to be held? If the three refuges were one, it would not be right to speak of three. If three refuges are taught, why are seven kinds of assembly taught? Blessed One, to what does one go for refuge, that it is called taking refuge?"

Then the Blessed One explained those points one by one, and declared this: "'Buddha' means awareness, because he is directly aware of all the characteristics of dharmas. Furthermore, all sentient beings in the three realms are continually drunk with sleep, but the Buddha has opened the eye of awakening; since he himself is aware and also makes others aware, he is called awareness. The Buddha, having obtained the means for all dharmas, has taught everything."

Aniruddha asked, "How is it that the Buddha is called one who has taught everything? Is it said of his teaching according to whatever suits the faculties

without missing the right time, or is it said of his teaching in accordance with the distinct divisions?"

The Buddha declared, "The Buddha taught all dharmas according to the faculties, without missing the right time; later, when the disciples compiled the Dharma piṭaka, they set it out in its several divisions. On some occasions the Buddha laid down for the disciples the moral disciplines, heavy and light, what is a transgression and what is not, and so the Vinaya Piṭaka was distinguished. On some occasions, because afflictions and secondary afflictions arise from the characteristics of cause and result, he taught the characteristics of karma, and so the Abhidharma Piṭaka was distinguished. What he taught and explained as suited to the world with its gods and humans is called the Collection Increasing by One (Ekottarāgama); it was taught as the practice of persons who have the fortune to be disciplined. The many kinds of profound meaning he taught to sentient beings of sharp faculties are called the Middle Collection (Madhyamāgama); it was taught as the practice of the disciples. The various kinds of dharmas of meditative concentration he taught are called the Miscellaneous Collection (Saṃyuktāgama); it was taught as the practice of persons who practice meditative concentration. In order to refute the many non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), he taught the Long Collection (Dīrghāgama)."

It was asked: "If the Buddha abides in having spoken everything, then what of this? In a sūtra, the Buddha was seated at the foot of a tree, and taking hold of the leaves of one branch of that tree, he said to his attendants, 'Are the leaves of this branch I hold many, or are the leaves of the great tree many?' They replied, 'The leaves of the tree are many.' The Buddha in turn said, 'The Dharma that I know is like the leaves of the tree; the Dharma that I have taught is like the leaves held in the hand.' Since he said this, may it be said that the Buddha has spoken everything?"

He declared: "There is the 'all' that is all things of distinct characteristics, and the 'all' that is all things of a single characteristic. Here, with the 'all' of distinct characteristics in mind, it is explained that the Buddha has spoken everything. Moreover, that is said with regard to sentient beings being unable to grasp it exhaustively; it is not that the Buddha is unable to speak it. Furthermore, it is with respect to his knowing everything that he is said to have spoken everything; it is not permissible to say that he has spoken everything as a means of guiding beings."

It was asked: "If the Buddha speaks by means of his knowing, and śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas also speak on the basis of knowledge, why should they not also be given the name buddha?"

He declared: "It is not so. The Buddha has reached the culmination of both knowing and speaking, whereas the knowledge and speech of the two vehicles have not reached the culmination of the Dharma. Furthermore, because the Buddha knows all dharmas thoroughly, he also knows the names that are designated for them; the two vehicles are not able to do so. Furthermore, the dharmas the Buddha has attained are limitless and the Dharma he teaches is limitless; the two vehicles are not able to do so. Furthermore, as for what is shared in what the Buddha has attained, some of it is shared with what the two vehicles attain, and some is not shared with what the śrāvakas attain. The knowledge shared by the three vehicles is attained by the middle vehicle. The knowledge shared by the two vehicles is attained by the Buddha alone, and what the two vehicles do not know is known by the Buddha alone. Furthermore, the larger the box, the larger its lid: when the Dharma is great, its characteristics too are limitless. Therefore the Buddha, with limitless wisdom, teaches limitless Dharma, whereas the wisdom of the two vehicles is limited, so it is not designated the characteristics of the Dharma. Furthermore, he possesses both faculty and object. Faculty means the faculty of wisdom. Object means wisdom. The object of the faculty means the dharmas that wisdom apprehends. The Buddha is complete in both faculty and object, and there is no dharma apprehended by wisdom that he has not fathomed to the end. The two vehicles are not complete in both faculty and object. Furthermore, the Buddha has attained the true wisdom that knows the characteristics of all dharmas correctly, just as they are. The two vehicles do not know the depths of the Dharma thoroughly, so their knowledge may not be called true wisdom. Thus, for many kinds of reasons, the two vehicles may not be called buddhas.

"The name Blessed One may not be applied on the basis of words and sounds; it is applied on the basis of meaning, and so he is called the Blessed One, because he knows all the remedial dharmas. Furthermore, since the sounds and languages of the world do not agree, worldly people themselves simply do not understand them, but the Buddha, knowing them all, is called the Blessed One. Furthermore, in the text of the one called the monk Pārśva it is said that, among those of the two vehicles and ordinary beings, some have faith in solitude and peace, some have faith in meditative concentration and

meditative absorption, and some, because of other conditions, keep it secret and do not teach it; but the Dharma that the Buddha has attained is endowed with the power of loving-kindness and compassion, so he delights in showing and speaking it to others. In another sense, he is called the Blessed One because he has conquered the three poisons."

It was asked: "If those of the two vehicles have also conquered the three poisons, why are they not designated Blessed Ones?"

He declared: "It is not so, because those of the two vehicles are subject to falling back, whereas the Buddha is not subject to falling back. Falling back is of three kinds: falling back from a fruit, falling back that is not from a fruit, and falling back in the activity of practice.

"Falling back from a fruit means that the three fruits of the śrāvakas are subject to falling back, while the final fruit does not fall back. The middle vehicle is of two kinds. If one is a pratyekabuddha who has practiced yoga for as long as a hundred eons, the fruit does not fall back. If one has become a pratyekabuddha from the three fruits of the lesser vehicle from the outset, that fruit is subject to falling back. But the fruit of a buddha does not fall back.

"Falling back that is not from a fruit is when a person headed toward the three vehicles turns back without having attained the fruit, and when a monk who practices yoga is lazy, lacks diligence, and declines in the practice of yoga and does not exert himself. These three are called falling back that is not from a fruit.

"Falling back in the activity of practice means being unable to engage directly, as an activity, in all the dharmas that are to be attained. For example, with the ten powers of a buddha or the ten knowledges of the lesser vehicle, one engages in one of them and the rest are not needed; or when someone who knows a hundred thousand verses of the sūtras by heart is at a time when he is not reciting them, that is called falling back in the activity of practice with respect to all of them.

"The lesser vehicle too has non-falling back from a fruit, and the middle vehicle too has falling back that is not from a fruit, but the Buddha has no falling back that is not from a fruit, because there is no dharma in which he has not exerted diligence. Those of the two vehicles have falling back from practice, but for the Buddha it is not fixed one way: since engaging in one of the ten powers suffices and the other nine need not be engaged, it is called falling back. Or, in another sense, he has no falling back, since he does not

need to engage in activity. For example, if a person knows two hundred thousand verses of the sūtras by heart, relying on his ability he can recite them completely in one or two days, but the Buddha completes them in a mere instant. The ten powers are just the same: if they need to be engaged, he accomplishes immeasurable deeds in a mere instant, so he has no falling back on account of not needing to engage in activity."

"Furthermore, the Buddha has no falling back on account of not needing to engage in activity. For example, when he puts on his lower garment, he does not put it on without any rule, as ordinary beings do. Moreover, whatever enlightened activity he performs is for the benefit of many sentient beings: if there is benefit, he performs that action; if there is no benefit, he does not perform it. Thus he has no falling back on account of not needing to engage in activity; each act has its own purpose, and since this is not fixed in one way, it is called the inconceivable intention of the Buddha."

It was asked: "Why is it that, for the śrāvakas, the three fruits are subject to falling back, while the final fruit is not?"

He declared: "The three fruits are subject to falling back because they were attained before. The final fruit is not subject to falling back because it had never yet been attained. For example, just as a poor person who comes upon delicious food does not forget it for a long time, so it is with this point. Furthermore, the final fruit becomes the unobstructed path of patience and becomes the path of the wisdom of liberation. The three fruits are subject to falling back because they have not become the unobstructed path of wisdom and have not become the path of the wisdom of liberation. Furthermore, the path of seeing the truths does not fall back, but the path of contemplation falls back, because it cuts the knots of the afflictions by means of both pure and impure perceptions. In contemplation there is defilement, but in the seeing of the truths there is no defilement: through seeing the truths there is no defilement, and through seeing the truths one also sees the defilements; and through seeing the meaning, contemplation of the profound meaning also arises, so there is no falling back into defilement. Furthermore, the power of the wisdom that sees the truths is great, like a great tree trunk pressing down on goods, whereas the wisdom of contemplation and mental attention is weak, so there is falling back. Furthermore, in seeing the truths, the two minds of patience and wisdom of the desire realm cut the knots of the ninefold defilement, and the two minds of patience and wisdom of the higher realms cut the seventy-two defilements. Having reached the culmination of the

formless realm, there is no falling back. For that reason, he alone is called the Blessed One.

"Furthermore, the Buddha has no trace of habitual tendencies, but those of both vehicles have not exhausted their habitual tendencies. For example, the monk called Ever Chewing always chews the cud like an ox, because in former lives he was an ox for many lifetimes and was then born as a human. For example, a certain monk, though his defilements were exhausted, always looked into a mirror, because for many lifetimes he had been a woman who sold herself and was then born as a human. For example, a certain monk delighted in climbing onto seats and racks, because for many lifetimes he had been a monkey and was then born as a human. Such as these may not be called Blessed Ones."

It was asked: "As for the words 'Thus have I heard,' was it said 'I heard' while the Buddha was still living, or was it said 'heard' after the Buddha had passed into nirvāṇa? If in the words of the compilation of the treasury of the Dharma it says 'I heard,' did he not say, 'Please teach and explain to me, without omission, what the Buddha has taught'?"

It was asked: "How was whatever was spoken as words of Dharma during those twenty years taught to him?"

He declared: "Through the Buddha's skillful means, he shows countless dharmas even with a single verse, and he shows the meaning of countless dharmas with a single verse. Even if the Buddha taught only a brief outline, Ānanda knew it without omission, because the power of his retention, through his sharp wisdom, was great.

"As for the saying that there are eighty thousand dharmas: just as, for example, the roots, branches, twigs, and leaves of a tree are collectively called one tree, so the Dharma that the Buddha taught for the sake of sentient beings from beginning to end is called one collection; in that way there are eighty thousand."

Again: "If the Buddha, without moving from a single seat, taught the Dharma for twenty years, and Ānanda did not hear it, why does he say 'I heard'?"

He declared: "It may also be said that the gods told Ānanda. Or it may also be said that the Buddha, the Blessed One, through his conventional, worldly mind, caused Ānanda to know it. Or it may also be said that it was the Dharma spoken to the monks. Furthermore, Ānanda made this request to the Buddha:

'Please do not give me the Buddha's old robes, and do not give me the alms of the patrons. I serve the Buddha and attend on him, providing whatever he wishes, because I desire the Dharma, not for the sake of clothing and food. The other monks see the Buddha at the times of morning and afternoon; please let me see him whenever I wish to look.' Furthermore, the Dharma was spoken for twenty years, and the teaching of the Dharma is called one collection; in that way there are eighty thousand.

"Or again, sixteen syllables are half a verse, and thirty-two syllables are called one verse; in that way there are eighty thousand. Or again, from the long and short lines of verse, forty-two syllables make one verse; in that way there are eighty thousand. Or again, the teaching of moral discipline each half month is called one collection; in that way there are eighty thousand. Or again, sixty-six thousand verses spoken by the Buddha are called one collection; in that way there are eighty thousand. Or again, because the Buddha taught eighty thousand medicines of the Dharma as antidotes to eighty thousand afflictions, they are called the eighty thousand doors of the Dharma."

It was asked: "Why did the Buddha not mention the sūtras and the Abhidharma first, but mention the Vinaya first?"

He declared: "Because it is supreme, and because it was laid down by the Buddha. For example, in the sūtras there are also teachings of the Dharma given by disciples. For example, there is also the case where Śakra, lord of the gods, said, 'I am supreme among those who give gifts. Why is that? Because by giving gifts I became lord of the gods, and my wishes are fulfilled as I desire,' and the Buddha too said, 'It is so.' At certain times the Buddha emanated emanated buddhas, and there are also teachings of the Dharma spoken by emanated buddhas. But the Vinaya is not like that: all of it was spoken by the Buddha, and therefore the Buddha mentioned it first."

"Or again, the sūtras were spoken according to whatever place he was staying in, but the Vinaya is not like that. If an offense occurred in some place, the rule was not laid down right there but was laid down outside the boundary. If an offense occurred among householders, it was laid down within the Saṅgha; if an offense occurred in a town, it was likewise laid down within the Saṅgha; and if an offense occurred among the five kinds of assembly, it had to be laid down among the monks and nuns. Therefore the Buddha mentioned it first.

"As for 'Vaiśālī': some lands are named after the name of a king, some are named after the lie of the land, and some are named after a city. This land was

given its name from a nāga. As for 'the place of Kalandaka': it was named after a bird, and 'city' is the name of the lord of the city. As for 'Devadatta': because his parents prayed to the gods and obtained a son, he was given the name Devadatta, 'Given by the Gods.'

"As for 'mighty and rich': riches are of two kinds, the sentient kind and the non-sentient kind. The non-sentient kind means having much gold and silver, treasuries of the seven kinds of precious things, wealth, fields, and houses. The sentient kind means having many male servants, female servants, laborers, oxen, horses, cattle, and sheep, and many villages and households under one's control. That is called rich. 'Mighty' means having power, or having excellent qualities, so that all people show him respect and hold him in honor; therefore he is called mighty. 'Turning to the Three Jewels, he took the three refuges.'"

It was asked: "What is the nature of the three refuges?"

"Some teachers say that the three refuges are a ritual act, and that a ritual act has no defining characteristic. When one takes the three refuges, kneeling, joining the palms, and uttering the three refuges aloud in words is the manifest ritual of body and speech. If one has made the mind one-pointed, then although body and speech are present, there is nothing manifested by the ritual; that is called the unmanifest ritual. Otherwise, the three refuges are said to be the nature of the three actions of body, speech, and mind. Or again, the three refuges are the five virtuous aggregates: through the five virtuous aggregates of a sentient being, one goes for refuge to the three, and the Three Jewels are the place in which one takes refuge.

"'Going for refuge' has the meaning of protection and refuge, or of an ally and support. For example, a man who has committed a great offense flees to another country and seeks refuge there with the foreign king, and the king of that country commands him, 'If you wish to be free of fear, do not leave this country of mine, and heed what I teach; then I will protect you.' Ordinary beings are just the same: since they have fallen under the power of Māra and suffer the misfortune of circling in birth and death, they should turn to the Three Jewels and go for refuge. If one turns one-pointedly to the Three Jewels and goes for refuge, and does not act contrary to the Buddha's teaching, Māra, the evil king, can do nothing at all.

"Once, a pigeon threatened by a hawk went into Śāriputra's shadow, yet it was still frightened and terrified. Then, when it went into the Buddha's shadow, it

was without fear and did not tremble at all. Even if the great ocean might shift and change, that pigeon could not be moved. This is because the Buddha possesses great loving-kindness and great compassion, while Śāriputra does not have great loving-kindness and compassion. The Buddha has no habitual tendencies, while Śāriputra has not exhausted his habitual tendencies. The Buddha practiced the conduct of a bodhisattva for three countless eons, while Śāriputra practiced austerities for sixty eons. Therefore, when the pigeon went into Śāriputra's shadow it was still frightened and afraid, but when it went into the Buddha's shadow it became fearless."

It was asked: "If by going for refuge to the Three Jewels evil and nonvirtue are purified and one has no cause for fear, why did one such as Devadatta, who went for refuge to the Three Jewels, went forth from home out of faith, and was even complete in moral discipline, commit three deeds of immediate retribution and fall into the Avīci hell?"

He declared: "Protection, too, is given as refuge to those who are fit to be given refuge. One such as Devadatta committed great nonvirtuous evil and was bound up with karma that must certainly be experienced, and for that reason it is hard to protect him."

It was asked: "If the Buddha does not protect those who have committed great evil, what need is there for the Buddha to protect those who have no evil karma? And how can it be said that the Three Jewels have the power of protection?"

He declared: "Devadatta's going for refuge to the Three Jewels was not done with a genuine mind, so his three refuges were not complete. Because he constantly desired gain, honor, and fame, he even set himself up against the Buddha, saying, 'I have the wisdom of omniscience.' Therefore, although the Three Jewels have great power, they did not become a protection for him. Consider, for example, one such as King Ajātaśatru. He had the evil of a deed of immediate retribution and deserved to fall into the Avīci hell, but because he asked the Buddha for refuge with a genuine, one-pointed mind, the evil of immediate retribution was purified. He fell into the Black Line hell (Kālasūtra), and just as one among humans experiences heavy evil, he experienced something like that weight for only seven days, and by that all his evil was purified. That is called the power of the protection of the Three Jewels."

It was asked: "It is said that Devadatta, having committed evil, cannot be protected. What then is the meaning of what is said in the sūtras, 'Whoever

goes for refuge to the Buddha will not fall into the three lower realms'?"

He declared: "Because Devadatta went for refuge to the Three Jewels, although he went to the Avīci hell, the suffering he experiences is lighter and smaller, and there are intervals of rest."

"For example, when a person has gone to a mountain, a forest, or a wilderness, a place of fear, if he brings the Buddha to mind and thinks of him, then by the Buddha's qualities his fear and terror will be calmed. Therefore it is no lie that, if one goes for refuge to the Three Jewels, they become one's protection and refuge."

It was asked: "Under which of the four truths are those called the Three Jewels included? Under which of the twenty-two faculties are they included? Under which of the eighteen elements are they included? Under which of the twelve sense sources are they included? Under which of the five aggregates are they to be included?"

He declared: "Among the four truths, the Three Jewels are included under the truth of cessation, and they are one part of the truth of the path. As to the faculties, they are included under the faculty of coming to know what was not known. Among the eighteen elements, they are included under the mind element, the mind-consciousness element, and the element of mental phenomena. Among the twelve sense sources, they are included within the mind sense source and the sense source of mental phenomena. Among the five aggregates, they are included within the five undefiled aggregates.

"Now, among the four truths, the Buddha Jewel is one part of the truth of the path. Among the four truths, the Dharma Jewel is included under the truth of cessation. Among the four truths, the Saṅgha Jewel too is one part of the truth of the path. Among the twenty-two faculties, the Buddha Jewel is included under the faculty of final knowledge. The Dharma Jewel, being the truth of cessation, is unconditioned and so is not included under any faculty. Among the twenty-two faculties, the Saṅgha Jewel is included within the three undefiled faculties.

"Among the eighteen elements, the Buddha Jewel is included within one part of the mind element, the mind-consciousness element, and the element of mental phenomena. Among the twelve sense sources, it is included within one part of the mind sense source and the sense source of mental phenomena. Among the five aggregates of appropriation, it is included within one part of the five undefiled aggregates.

"Among the eighteen elements, the Dharma Jewel is included within one part of the element of mental phenomena. Among the twelve sense sources, it is included within one part of the sense source of mental phenomena. The Dharma Jewel is not included in the five aggregates, because the five aggregates are conditioned, whereas the Dharma is unconditioned.

"Among the eighteen elements, the Saṅgha Jewel is included within one part of the mind element, the mind-consciousness element, and the element of mental phenomena. Among the twelve sense sources, it is included within one part of the mind sense source and the sense source of mental phenomena. Among the five aggregates, it is included within one part of the five undefiled aggregates."

It was asked: "When one says, 'I go for refuge to the Buddha,' does one go for refuge to the Buddha Śākyamuni, or does one go for refuge to the buddhas of the three times?"

He declared: "One goes for refuge to the buddhas of the three times. Why is that? Because the Dharma body of the buddhas is one and the same. Going for refuge to one buddha is itself going for refuge to all buddhas, because there is no difference among the buddhas.

"Or again, as for saying, 'I go for refuge to the buddhas of the three times': among the gods, some say, 'I am a disciple of the Buddha Kāśyapa,' and some say, 'I am a disciple of the Buddha Vipaśyin.' In the same way, with regard to each of the seven buddhas, each of them says, 'I am the disciple of such-and-such a buddha.' Therefore it is held, 'It is fitting that I go for refuge to one buddha; the three times are not appropriate.' But there are also those who say that this is not right. Why is that? For example, in the Sūtra Asked by Vaiśravaṇa it is said that King Vaiśravaṇa, in going for refuge to the Three Jewels, went for refuge to the buddhas of the past, to those yet to come, and to those now present. If one connects it with that meaning, it is evident that one goes for refuge to the buddhas of the three times."

It was asked: "If that is so, what is the meaning of the sons of the gods each saying, 'I am the disciple of such-and-such a buddha'?"

He declared: "What definitive settling of the meaning is there in what the sons of the gods say? Some sons of the gods go for refuge to one buddha, and some go for refuge to the buddhas of the three times. In short, it is done with regard to one buddha."

It was asked: "Going for refuge to what is called going for refuge to the Buddha?"

He declared: "'Going for refuge' is a wheel of speech. It is going for refuge to the qualities of omniscience and of one who has nothing more to learn."

It was asked: "Does one go for refuge to the form body, or does one go for refuge to the Dharma body?"

He declared: "One goes for refuge to the Dharma body; one does not go for refuge to the form body, because form is not the Buddha."

It was asked: "If the form body is not the Buddha, why does drawing blood from the Buddha's body become a deed of immediate retribution?"

He declared: "The form body is the vessel of the Dharma body; it is the abode of the Dharma body. Therefore doing harm to the form body becomes a deed of immediate retribution; it is not that it becomes a deed of immediate retribution because the form body is the Buddha."

It was asked: "Going for refuge to what is called going for refuge to the Dharma?"

He declared: "'Going for refuge' is a wheel of speech. Going for refuge to nirvāṇa, which has reached the end of both desire and freedom from desire, is called going for refuge to the Dharma."

It was asked: "Does one go for refuge to the ending of one's own body, or does one go for refuge to the ending of the bodies of others?"

He declared: "Going for refuge to the ending of one's own body and to the ending of the bodies of others is called going for refuge to the Dharma."

It was asked: "How does one go for refuge to the Saṅgha?"

He declared: "Going for refuge is a wheel of speech. Going for refuge to the qualities of the śrāvakas, both those still in training and those beyond training, who are a field of merit, is called going for refuge to the Saṅgha."

It was asked: "Does one go for refuge to the Saṅgha of conventional truth, or does one go for refuge to the Saṅgha of ultimate truth? If one goes for refuge to the Saṅgha of ultimate truth, then when the Buddha long ago conferred the three refuges on Trapuṣa and Bhallika, it would not have been fitting for him to say, 'Later there will be what is called the Saṅgha; go for refuge to it,' since the Saṅgha of ultimate truth is always present in the world."

He declared: "Because the Saṅgha of conventional truth is the basis on which the ultimate Saṅgha depends, he said, 'Later there will be a Saṅgha; go for refuge to it.' Or again, he said this so that the Saṅgha of conventional truth would be respected and honored. For the Buddha, among all assemblies, the Saṅgha is the supreme assembly of the Buddha. For example, curd comes from milk, butter comes from curd, and the essence of butter comes from butter, and the essence of butter is the supreme and most excellent. The Saṅgha, the Buddha's assembly, is just like that. When there is a Saṅgha of disciples, there are within it those who have entered the four paths and attained the four fruits, an unsurpassed field of merit. Therefore, among the ninety-six kinds of assembly, the Saṅgha is the most excellent, supreme, and without equal. Therefore there is no contradiction with the meaning in his saying, 'Later there will be a Saṅgha; go for refuge to it.'"

It was asked: "The Buddha himself is the Dharma, the Dharma itself is also the Saṅgha, and the Saṅgha itself is also the Dharma, so in reality they are a single dharma. What distinction or difference is there?"

He declared: "Although those dharmas are so, there are differences in terms of meaning. As for what are called the Three Jewels: one who, without being taught, has great wisdom and has attained the ground of no more training, and who possesses all qualities, is called the Buddha Jewel. The truth of cessation, the unconditioned, is called the Dharma Jewel. Those who possess the qualities and wisdom of the śrāvakas in training and beyond training are called the Saṅgha Jewel.

"Divided in terms of dharmas: the dharmas that are untaught and beyond training are called the Buddha Jewel. The truth of cessation, the unconditioned, the dharma that is neither in training nor beyond training, is called the Dharma Jewel. The śrāvakas in training and beyond training are called the Saṅgha Jewel.

"Divided in terms of the faculties: the Buddha is the faculty of final knowledge. The Dharma is not a dharma of the faculties. The Saṅgha is the three undefiled faculties.

"Divided in terms of the truths: the Buddha is one part of the truth of the path. The Dharma is the truth of cessation. The Saṅgha too is one part of the truth of the path.

"Divided in terms of the fruit of the ascetic (śramaṇa): the Buddha is a śramaṇa. The Dharma is the fruit of the śramaṇa. The Saṅgha is śramaṇas.

The Dharma Jewel is the fruit of the śramaṇa.

"Divided in terms of the brahmin: the Buddha is a brahmin. The Dharma is the fruit of the brahmin. The Saṅgha is brahmins. The Dharma Jewel is the fruit of the brahmin.

"Divided in terms of pure conduct: the Buddha is pure conduct. The Dharma is the fruit of pure conduct. The Saṅgha is pure conduct. The Dharma Jewel is the fruit of pure conduct.

"Divided in terms of cause and result: the Buddha is a cause. The Dharma is the result. The Saṅgha is a cause. The Dharma Jewel is the result.

"Divided in terms of path and result: the Buddha is the path. The Dharma is the result. The Saṅgha is the path. The Dharma Jewel is the result.

"The teacher of the Buddha is the Dharma. Since the Buddha is born from the Dharma, the Dharma is the mother of the Buddha, and the Buddha abides in the Dharma."

It was asked: "If the teacher of the Buddha is the Dharma, why is the Dharma not mentioned first among the Three Jewels?"

He declared: "Although it is the Dharma that is the Buddha's teacher, the Dharma is not taught by anyone other than the Buddha, and what is called the path must be accomplished by a person. Therefore the Buddha is mentioned first."

Then Aniruddha again said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, when one takes refuge in the Three Jewels, if one mentions the Dharma Jewel first and the Buddha Jewel afterward, is it valid as going for refuge to the three?"

He declared: "If one has no understanding or knowledge, then even if the order is mistaken there is no fault, and it counts as going for refuge. If one knowingly and deliberately says it wrongly, there is a fault, and it does not count as going for refuge to the three."

It was asked: "If one mentions the Buddha and the Dharma but does not mention the Saṅgha, is it valid as the three refuges? If one mentions the Dharma and the Saṅgha but does not mention the Buddha, is it valid as going for refuge? If one mentions the Buddha and the Saṅgha but does not mention the Dharma, does it count as going for refuge to the three?"

He declared: "None of these is valid; they do not count."

It was asked: "Without going for refuge to the three, may one obtain the five precepts? Without going for refuge to the three, may one obtain the eight-branch precepts? Without going for refuge to the three, may one obtain the ten precepts? Without performing the formal act of a motion and three proclamations (jñapticaturthakarman), may one receive the full precepts?"

He declared: "None of these is valid. If one is to receive the five precepts, one should first go for refuge to the three. After going for refuge to the three, one comes to obtain the five precepts. Then one should state what the five precepts are, so that the other person knows the names of the five precepts. In the same way, it is by performing the formal act of a motion and three proclamations that one comes to the full precepts, and after that, the four supports, the four root offenses, and the thirteen saṅghāvaśeṣas should be stated and taught so that they are known and understood.

"Or again, if, after the going for refuge, the precept of not killing is taught, one comes to obtain the precepts. Therefore it is said that by explaining one precept one obtains the five precepts: if one can keep one precept, it is said that one can keep all five. Or again, it is because the five precepts are connected with one another, and because from the outset one has vowed to receive the five precepts. Or again, the precepts are obtained after the five precepts have been received. Some teachers say that the statement 'having performed the three refuges, one obtains the five precepts' is true in meaning, just as with the performance of the formal act of motion and proclamation."

Taking the eight-branch precepts, taking the ten precepts, and taking the five precepts are as has been explained.

He asked, "If someone has earlier gone for refuge to the Three and become a layman, and later takes the five precepts, or else the ten precepts, must he then go for refuge anew?"

He declared, "Even without performing the three refuges again, because he earlier went for refuge to the Three, he obtains all the precepts."

He asked, "If one has gone for refuge to the Three but has not performed the formal act of motion and proclamation, does one obtain the precepts?"

He declared, "Those who take the five precepts, the eight-branch precepts, and the ten precepts obtain the precepts by going for refuge to the Three. But in taking moral discipline in full, moral discipline becomes complete through performing the formal act of a motion and proclamations, four in all, and not

through going for refuge to the Three. Because the qualities and merit of taking moral discipline in full are great, it cannot be accomplished by a mere slight act or a mere slight condition. Therefore one obtains that moral discipline through the three refuges and through performing the fourfold act of motion and proclamation within a Saṅgha of ten. The five precepts, the eight-branch precepts, and the ten precepts are not so great in qualities and power, and therefore one obtains that moral discipline by going for refuge to the Three; many acts and many conditions are not needed."

He asked, "After someone has taken moral discipline in full, only the four root offenses and the thirteen saṅghāvaśeṣas are taught, while the others are not taught in full. Why is that?"

He declared, "These two kinds of moral discipline are the weighty ones within. If even one of the four roots is broken, it cannot be restored. A saṅghāvaśeṣa can indeed be restored, but it is hard to restore: one must undergo the probation that satisfies the Saṅgha and the act of penalty, and then confess the offense before a Saṅgha of twenty. Because these are hard to guard, they are mentioned so that they will be guarded. The others are easy to guard if one trains in them, so there is no need to mention them. That is why these two kinds are mentioned and the others are not."

He asked, "Is this prātimokṣa discipline an undefiled discipline, or is it the discipline of meditative concentration?"

He declared, "It is neither the undefiled discipline nor the discipline of meditative concentration. As for this prātimokṣa discipline, if a buddha has come into the world, this discipline exists; if a buddha has not come into the world, this discipline does not exist. The undefiled discipline and the discipline of meditative concentration exist at all times, whether or not a buddha has come into the world. The prātimokṣa discipline comes into being through being laid down, but the undefiled discipline and the discipline of meditative concentration do not come into being through being laid down. The prātimokṣa discipline is obtained from others, but the undefiled discipline and the discipline of meditative concentration are not obtained from others. The prātimokṣa discipline is present at all times, whether one is asleep or awake, and whether the mind is virtuous, nonvirtuous, or indeterminate. The undefiled discipline and the discipline of meditative concentration are present while one is sitting in meditative concentration and when one is settled in undefiled mind, but they are absent in all other states of mind. The prātimokṣa discipline

exists only among humans, but the undefiled discipline and the discipline of meditative concentration exist among both gods and humans. The prātimokṣa discipline exists only in the desire realm, but the undefiled discipline and the discipline of meditative concentration exist fully in the desire realm and the form realm. The undefiled discipline and the prātimokṣa discipline exist only among the disciples of the Buddha, but the discipline of meditative concentration exists among non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) as well."

He asked, "Of the five precepts of a layman, how many concern wrongs by nature, and how many concern wrongs by prescription?"

He declared, "Four concern wrongs by nature; the one precept on drinking alcohol concerns a wrong by prescription. Drinking alcohol is a ground for heedlessness and laziness, and it becomes an accomplice to the four wrongs. Among the five precepts, drinking alcohol is the basis of heedlessness, and so it also causes the other four precepts to be broken. For example, in the time of the Buddha Kāśyapa, a certain layman, on account of drinking alcohol, lusted after another man's wife and committed sexual misconduct with her; he also stole his neighbor's chicken and killed it. When someone asked him, 'Why do you act like this?' he said, 'I did no such thing.' Thus, through drinking alcohol, he broke all four precepts at once. If one drinks alcohol, one may even commit the four acts of immediate retribution; only causing a schism in the Saṅgha one cannot do. And although this is not brought about by past karma, one will nonetheless experience madness, a madness without mindfulness. Through drinking alcohol one becomes intoxicated like a maddened bull elephant and turns quarrelsome. When drunk on alcohol, one lets slip the proper activities one should engage in: meditative concentration, reading the sūtras, recitation, and the formal acts of the Saṅgha. So although it is not a wrong by nature, it is like a wrong by nature."

Then Aniruddha again said to the Blessed One, "Are precepts such as the precepts of a layman obtained only with respect to sentient beings, or may they also be obtained with respect to what is not a sentient being? Are the precepts obtained with respect to sentient beings who can be killed, from whom one can steal, with whom unchaste conduct can be engaged in, and to whom lies can be told? Or are the precepts also obtained with respect to sentient beings who cannot be killed, from whom one cannot steal, with whom unchaste conduct cannot be engaged in, and to whom lies cannot be told?"

He declared, "With respect to sentient beings, four precepts are obtained; with respect to what is not a sentient being, the precept of not drinking alcohol is obtained."

With respect to everything that counts as a sentient being, whether it can be killed or cannot be killed, whether unchaste conduct can be engaged in with it or cannot, whether one can steal from it or cannot, whether lies can be told to it or cannot, from all of them moral discipline is obtained. From the Avīci hell upward and from the sphere of neither perception nor nonperception downward, all that has life within the great trichiliocosm world-system, up to and including the Tathāgata, are those from whom these four kinds of moral discipline may be obtained. For at the outset, when taking moral discipline, one vows, "I shall not take the life of any living being, I shall not take anything that is not given, I shall not engage in unchaste conduct with anyone, and I shall not tell any lie," and no limit or measure is set to this. Therefore there is no sentient being from whom moral discipline is not obtained.

When the conferral of moral discipline is performed according to the rite, first, so that the candidates will understand and have faith, the Dharma is taught, and they are made to give rise to a mind of loving-kindness and compassion toward all sentient beings. When such a mind of superior aspiration arises in this way, a superior moral discipline is obtained.

Further, in obtaining moral discipline, the four kinds of moral discipline are obtained separately from each and every sentient being, and if each of the four is divided, they become twelve kinds of moral discipline. The four faults that are reversed by not killing sentient beings, not taking what is not given, not engaging in unchaste conduct, and not telling lies arise on account of three causes and conditions: they arise from attachment, they arise from aversion, and they arise from delusion. With respect to every sentient being there are these twelve nonvirtues, and if one turns away from these nonvirtues, one obtains twelve manifest forms of virtuous moral discipline (vijñaptirūpa). It is the same for what is obtained from all the immeasurable sentient beings.

Even if a hundred times ten thousand or a hundred times a hundred thousand arhats pass into nirvāṇa, if one first obtained moral discipline from those arhats, then even though the arhats have passed into nirvāṇa, the moral discipline is not impaired.

As for the precept of not drinking alcohol, from the beginning of this body to its end, one obtains a manifest form of the precept with respect to every single draught of all that exists throughout the great trichiliocosm world-system. Since at the outset, when taking the precept, one has vowed, "I shall not drink any alcohol," even if all the alcohol were used up, the moral discipline would always remain and would not be impaired.

He asked, "If at the outset, when taking the precepts, one took the precept of not engaging in sexual misconduct with any woman through the three doors, and later one takes a wife, is this moral discipline broken?"

He declared, "It is not broken. Why is that? At the outset one obtained the precept of not engaging in sexual misconduct with women; but since this is one's own wife, it is not sexual misconduct, and so the precept is not broken. When this principle is applied, everything is consistent: the obtaining of moral discipline in the eight precepts and the ten precepts, with respect to sentient beings and to what is not a sentient being, is likewise the same.

"As for the two hundred and fifty precepts, here too one obtains seven precepts separately with respect to each and every sentient being, and when these are divided they become twenty-one precepts. With respect to every sentient being seven wrongs of body and speech can occur, and these wrongs arise through three kinds of causes and conditions: they arise through attachment, they arise through aversion, and they arise through delusion. Thus the seven wrongs arise through three causes and conditions, and so the seven nonvirtuous wrongs times three make twenty-one. If one turns away from those wrongs, that becomes moral discipline; and just as there are twenty-one manifest forms of moral discipline with respect to a single sentient being, so it is with respect to all sentient beings. When this principle is applied, countless kinds of moral discipline can be obtained at one time, yet they are not all broken at once at one time, nor do they all cease at one time.

"As for what is called broken moral discipline: if the root of moral discipline is broken, one cannot advance from one level to a higher one, and even if one gives back the moral discipline and later takes it again, one does not obtain moral discipline. For example, if the root of the one-day eight-branch precepts is broken, one may not later take any of these kinds of moral discipline: the eight precepts, the five precepts, the ten precepts, the full precepts, the discipline of meditative concentration, or the undefiled discipline. If the root of the five precepts is broken, then even if one takes the eight precepts, the ten,

the full moral discipline, the discipline of meditative concentration, or the undefiled discipline, none of them can be obtained. If, after the five precepts have been broken, one gives back the five precepts and takes the ten precepts, that is not possible. If, after giving back the five precepts, one takes the five precepts again, or takes the eight precepts, the ten precepts, the full precepts, the discipline of meditative concentration, or the undefiled discipline, one obtains no precept at all. If the root of the ten precepts or of the full precepts is broken, then advancing from one level to a higher one, or giving back the precepts and taking precepts again, is just as was explained for the five precepts."

He asked, "Of these three kinds of moral discipline, the discipline of meditative concentration, the undefiled discipline, and the prātimokṣa discipline, which is called the supreme discipline?"

He declared, "The discipline of meditative concentration is supreme; yet in another respect the prātimokṣa discipline is also supreme. How is that? This discipline exists only if a buddha comes into the world, whereas the discipline of meditative concentration and the undefiled discipline exist at all times. The prātimokṣa discipline can be obtained with respect to both sentient beings and what is not a sentient being, whereas the discipline of meditative concentration and the undefiled discipline are not obtained with respect to all sentient beings. The prātimokṣa discipline is obtained through a mind of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, whereas the discipline of meditative concentration and the undefiled discipline are not obtained through a mind of loving-kindness."

"The prātimokṣa discipline is what keeps the seven kinds of assembly that uphold the Buddha's Dharma present in the world, and it becomes the basis on which the fruits of the three vehicles continue unbroken. The discipline of meditative concentration and the undefiled discipline are not like this, and therefore it is the highest and most excellent in the three realms.

"At the outset, when one takes the precepts, moral discipline becomes complete the instant the formal act of a motion and proclamations, four in all, has been performed. The manifest form of moral discipline in the very first instant of mind is called both 'action' and 'path of action.' The manifest form of the precepts that arises in the later instants of mind is called 'action,' but it is not a 'path of action.' Thus, from the first instant of mind, the intention of the manifest form of moral discipline is fully complete, and because it is endowed

with intention it is called the path of action of intention. With the earlier moral discipline acting as the cause, the manifest form of the remaining moral discipline comes about spontaneously, and therefore it is called 'action,' but not 'path of action.'

"The precept of the single first instant of mind is accompanied by the rite, and it is not without the rite either. The precepts that arise successively afterward possess only what is without the rite; they are not accompanied by the rite. The precept of the single first instant of mind is called moral discipline, it is also called virtuous conduct, and it is also called Vinaya. The moral discipline that arises successively, immediately after it, also has that same meaning."

Then Aniruddha again asked the Blessed One, "Of the three times taken together, in which time is moral discipline obtained?"

He declared, "The precepts are obtained by a single instant of mind in the present time. The past and the future are dharmas, and because they are not sentient beings, they do not obtain the precepts; but the single present instant of mind is a sentient being, and so it obtains the precepts."

He asked, "Is moral discipline obtained by a virtuous mind, by a nonvirtuous mind, or by an indeterminate mind? Or are the precepts obtained by one who is without mind?"

He declared, "They are obtained by all of these. At the outset, with a virtuous mind, one bows at the feet of the Saṅgha, takes up the robes and the alms bowl, and makes the request to whoever is the preceptor. Then, squatting with palms joined, one completes the precepts with a virtuous mind, without interruption, through the formal act of a motion and proclamations, four in all; this is called obtaining moral discipline by a virtuous mind.

"Suppose that while the rite is being performed in this way, step by step, one has been continually endowed with a virtuous mind, but then, at the time when the officiant performs the fourfold act of motion and proclamation, unvirtuous thoughts such as attachment or aversion arise. Even though that same being comes to possess the manifest form of moral discipline, this is called obtaining the precepts by a nonvirtuous mind. Yet in this case the precepts are obtained by the force of the earlier virtuous mind and the virtuous act; they are not obtained by the nonvirtuous mind.

"Suppose one has first performed the acts of the rite with a virtuous mind, and then, at the time the fourfold act of motion and proclamation is performed,

one falls asleep or dozes off, and the manifest form of the precepts arises from that sleeping and drowsy mind; this is called obtaining the precepts by an indeterminate mind.

"Suppose one has first performed the rite with a virtuous mind, and then, at the time the fourfold act of motion and proclamation is performed, one enters into equipoise in the samādhi of cessation. Since at that time one comes to possess the manifest form of the precepts, this is called obtaining the precepts while without mind."

Aniruddha again asked, "If a householder, without having taken the five precepts, directly takes the ten precepts, does he obtain the precepts?"

He declared, "He obtains both kinds at one time, the precepts of a layman and the precepts of a novice (śrāmaṇera). If, without having taken either the five precepts or the ten precepts, one directly takes the full precepts, one obtains all three kinds of precepts at one time."

Aniruddha asked, "Blessed One, if by taking the full precepts one obtains all three kinds of precepts at one time, why must one proceed in stages, first taking the five precepts, then after that taking the ten precepts, and only later taking the full precepts?"

He declared, "Although one does obtain all three kinds of moral discipline at one time, whoever has strong devotion to the Buddha's Dharma will surely proceed in stages. First one takes the five precepts and is tamed, and once faith and devotion have grown strong, one then takes the ten precepts. Having taken the ten precepts, once the roots of virtue have grown strong, one then takes the full moral discipline. In this way, step by step, one gains the taste of the Buddha's Dharma, and one's devotion becomes firm and indestructible. For example, just as entering the great ocean becomes deeper only gradually, so too is entering the ocean of the Buddha's Dharma. If one takes the full moral discipline all at once, the proper sequence is lost and one's deportment also suffers.

"Moreover, regarding moral discipline, there are some sentient beings who attain the fruit of the path by taking the five precepts, and there are some sentient beings who attain the fruit of the path on the basis of having taken the ten precepts. Because causes and conditions differ in these ways, the Tathāgata taught a proper sequence.

"If one first takes the five precepts and then takes the ten precepts, then at the time of taking the ten precepts one possesses both sets of precepts. If after taking the five precepts and the ten precepts one takes the full precepts, then at the time of taking them in full one possesses all three sets of precepts.

"Among the seven kinds who take the five precepts, the ten precepts, and the full precepts, only the precepts conferred through the fourfold act of motion and proclamation are obtained in stages over three times. The remaining six kinds of taking are obtained at a single time; for them there is no sequence of three times.

"Although the three kinds of moral discipline are thus obtained at a single time, they are distinct. When one gives back moral discipline and says, 'From today onward I am a novice, not a monk,' then although the full moral discipline no longer exists, the other two kinds of moral discipline do not cease to exist; they remain. If, having taken the five precepts and the ten precepts, one says, 'From now on I am a layman, not a novice,' then only the ten precepts cease to exist, while the five precepts remain."

"If one says, 'I give back all the precepts of a householder and of one gone forth; accept me as a layman who has gone for refuge,' then although the three kinds of moral discipline cease all at once, the three refuges do not cease. The obtaining of the three kinds of moral discipline in sequence, the rite of giving them back, and the order of these, are just as was taught for obtaining the precepts at a single time."

He asked, "If someone who was formerly a layman goes forth and takes the ten precepts, do the five precepts not cease to exist?"

He declared, "They do not cease to exist. Only the name and the rank are exchanged; the precepts do not cease to exist. That is, one loses the name of layman and gains the name of novice; one loses the rank of a householder and gains the rank of one gone forth."

He asked, "If one takes the full moral discipline of a monk, do the ten precepts and the five precepts not cease to exist?"

He declared, "They do not cease to exist. Here too, only the name and the rank are lost: one loses the name of novice and gains the name of monk; one loses the rank of novice and gains the rank of monk. From beginning to end it is moral discipline; it is only the name that is applied for the time being. It is like the leaves of a cultivated tree: in spring and summer they are green, in

autumn yellow, and in winter gray. Changed by the seasons, the leaves of the tree take on different colors, yet from beginning to end they are nothing but the leaves of the tree. Moral discipline is likewise: it is always just one moral discipline, but it becomes different through time. Again, for example, milk, curd, butter, and ghee are distinct as four kinds, yet though they differ in time they are like one and the same thing. Moral discipline is likewise: though it differs through the three times, there is no difference in the moral discipline itself."

Aniruddha again asked, "Blessed One, if a layman taking the precepts is not able, by his capacity, to take them in full, and takes from one or two up to four precepts, does that count as having taken moral discipline?"

He declared, "He does not obtain the precepts by that."

He asked, "If he does not obtain the precepts, then what is the meaning of the statements in the sūtras that there are laymen who practice a small part, laymen who practice a large part, and laymen who practice the whole?"

He declared, "That was said with reference to the greater and lesser qualities that come from guarding the precepts. It does not mean that moral discipline may be taken in that way."

Aniruddha again asked, "Blessed One, if someone takes the five precepts for one day, or for two days, up to ten days, taking them in that way, does he obtain the precepts?"

He declared, "That is not permissible. The moral discipline laid down by the Buddha has, in each case, a fixed time and measure. One who takes the five precepts must without fail take them for as long as he lives. One who takes the eight-branch precepts must without fail take them for one day and night. Therefore what you first proposed is not permissible.

"Taking the precepts by performing the fourfold act of motion and proclamation also has superior, middling, and inferior levels. Of these, the five precepts are the inferior precepts, the ten precepts are the middling precepts, and the full precepts are called the superior precepts. The five precepts too have three levels, superior, middling, and inferior. If one takes the precepts with a small and feeble mind, they are called inferior precepts. One who takes moral discipline with a middling mind obtains middling precepts. If one takes moral discipline with a superior mind, one obtains superior precepts. That the full moral discipline also has three levels, superior, middling, and inferior, is

just as was taught for the five precepts.

"If, after first taking the precepts with an inferior mind, one later takes the ten precepts with a superior or middling mind, the five precepts do not grow or become superior beyond what they were before. But apart from the five precepts, the remaining five precepts, up to not eating food at the wrong time, become superior precepts, while the five precepts taken earlier remain inferior. If one first takes the five precepts with an inferior mind and afterward takes the full precepts with a superior or middling mind, here too the five precepts taken earlier do not grow or become superior. But apart from the earlier five precepts, all the other precepts, because they were taken with a superior and exceptional mind at the time of taking the full moral discipline, become superior and exceptional moral discipline.

"Therefore the prātimokṣa discipline is not obtained in a twofold ranking. If it is divided by sequence, the five precepts are called inferior, the ten precepts are called middling, and the full moral discipline is called superior. If it is divided according to meaning, then when one takes the five precepts with a superior mind, those precepts are called superior; when one takes the ten precepts with a middling mind, they are called middling precepts; and when one takes the full moral discipline with an inferior mind, it is called inferior moral discipline. Applied to the meaning, the obtaining of moral discipline from a superior, middling, or inferior mind does not correspond to the sequence, and there is no single fixed determination.

"If someone has requested a preceptor to confer the ten precepts, then even if the preceptor is not present at the time the ten precepts are taken, the ten precepts are obtained. If the preceptor dies at the time the ten precepts are taken, and one knows or has heard that he has died, then even though one takes the precepts one does not obtain them. If one does not know or has not heard that he has died, one obtains the precepts. In taking moral discipline through the fourfold act of motion and proclamation, if the preceptor is not present, then even though one takes the precepts one does not obtain them, because the number of the Saṅgha is not complete. If the number of the Saṅgha is complete, the precepts may be taken even without the preceptor."

Aniruddha again asked, "Blessed One, may a layman who holds the five precepts engage in trade for profit?"

He declared, "He may engage in trade for profit, but he should not engage in these five kinds of business. He should not engage in the business of trading in

livestock that goes on foot; if he has livestock of his own, he is allowed to sell it, but he may not sell it to a butcher. He may not engage in trading bows, arrows, and weapons for profit, though he may sell what he himself owns. He may not engage in the business of trading in alcohol for profit, though he may sell what he himself owns. He may not press sesame oil, because many insects die. That is so according to the custom of India; on this side of Kapiśa, if there are no insects in the oil being pressed, there is no fault.

"Dyeing and boiling with the five kinds of great colored dyes is also not permitted, because many insects die. In other countries, such as Yogsha, many insects die from the dyeing and boiling of colors, and therefore it is not allowed. In the land of China too, the boiling of indigo-blue dye kills many insects, and so it is included among the five kinds of dyeing and boiling."

Aniruddha again asked, "Blessed One, if, besides not eating food at the wrong time, which is the fast, what is called the eight precepts of a single day would make nine, why is it called eight?"

He declared, "What is called a precept is, by its nature, the fast of not eating food at the wrong time. It is a branch of the eight precepts; because it serves as their support, they are called the eight-branch precepts, and not nine."

He asked, "If someone takes the eight-branch precepts, in which of the seven kinds of assembly is that person included?"

He declared, "Even though he has not taken the precepts for life, he has the precepts of a single day, and so he too is called a layman. Then again, he cannot be called a layman, since he has not taken moral discipline for life; and he cannot be called not a layman, since he has the precepts of a single day. Therefore the sūtras also say that he is an intermediate person."

Aniruddha again asked, "Blessed One, is there any prātimokṣa discipline apart from that of the seven assemblies?"

He declared, "There is: it is precisely the eight-branch precepts. In accordance with that meaning, one who has taken the eight-branch precepts is not included among the seven kinds of assembly. Since, by the rule for taking the eight-branch precepts, the words are fixed as 'I shall not take life for one day and night,' they may not be mixed with the other precepts that are taken for life."

He asked, "May one take the eight-branch precepts all at once for two days, or three, up to ten days?"

He declared, "From the very beginning the Buddha laid them down as precepts for a single day and night, and so one may not go beyond that. If one is able, by one's capacity, to take them, one must take them one day and night at a time, each time anew; in that way it is permissible to take them for many days. The method of taking the eight-branch precepts for a single day and night is that one must take them from another person. And from whom must one take them? One must take them from any one of the five assemblies.

"If, after taking the eight-branch precepts, one beats or abuses a sentient being, the moral discipline is not pure. Even if on the day one took the precepts one did not beat or abuse anyone, but resolved to beat or abuse someone the next day, the moral discipline is still not pure. In short, however much improper action one does with body and speech, although the precepts are not broken, they are not pure. Even if body and speech are pure, if the mind gives rise to conceptual thoughts of attachment, or to conceptual thoughts of harm driven by aversion, they are again not pure. Even if the three actions of body, speech, and mind are pure, if one does not bring the six recollections to mind, that too is not called pure moral discipline. If, after taking the eight-branch precepts, one brings the six recollections to mind, it is called pure moral discipline.

"The sūtras say that the merit of a king of Jambudvīpa, who holds sway over all the people within the realm of Jambudvīpa and over all the gold, silver, and wealth found there, does not amount to even a sixteenth part of the merit of the pure eight-branch moral discipline.

"Whoever has resolved to take the eight-branch precepts but carelessly indulges in music at will, or carelessly eats delicious food, or carelessly enjoys all sorts of amusements as he pleases, and then afterward takes the precepts, whether in the morning or in the afternoon, does not obtain the precepts. If, having had no intention beforehand of taking the precepts, one has carelessly done all sorts of things, and afterward meets a spiritual friend and takes the precepts, one obtains the precepts at any time, whether in the morning or in the afternoon. If one set out to take the precepts but an obstructor or an obstacle arose, so that one had no control over it, and later, once there is no obstructor or obstacle, one takes the precepts, one obtains them at any time, whether in the morning or in the afternoon."

He asked, "If one takes precepts that one will keep by day but not keep by night, does one obtain the eight-branch precepts? And if one takes precepts

that one will keep by night but not keep by day, does one obtain the eight-branch precepts?"

He declared, "In neither case are the precepts obtained. For from the very beginning the Buddha laid them down as precepts of a single day and night; this is a fixed measure, and it may not be contravened."

Aniruddha again asked, "Blessed One, if the precepts are not obtained in that way, then what of the account in the sūtras that the monk Koṭikarṇa saw, in a remote wilderness, some hungry ghosts undergoing all sorts of suffering, some of whom enjoyed pleasures by day and suffered by night, and some of whom enjoyed pleasures by night and underwent suffering by day? And what of the conflicting idea that, in their former lives among humans, these had kept the precepts by day and done evil by night, or else kept the precepts by night and done evil deeds by day?"

He declared, "One cannot rely solely on the causes and conditions of former lives. Moreover, this account is not taught in the sūtras or in the Vinaya, so it cannot be called the definitive true meaning. Elsewhere it is said that what was described there was an emanation produced by the noble Kātyāyana in order to tame Koṭikarṇa, and was not real.

"When someone who has taken the eight-branch precepts gives the precepts back, it is not necessary to give them back to the five kinds of assembly; by saying a single sentence to one other person, 'I give back the precepts,' the precepts are given back.

"If one distinguishes in terms of who obtains the prātimokṣa precepts, then of those belonging to the five classes of destiny, only those of the human class obtain the precepts; those of the remaining classes do not.

For example, those belonging to the class of gods do not obtain the precepts, because they are attached to and fixated on the enjoyment of pleasures. For instance, once an attendant of the noble Maudgalyāyana was struck by illness, and the noble Maudgalyāyana went up to the heaven of the Thirty-Three to consult the physician Jīvaka. At that time the sons of the gods were just about to go and play in the pleasure grove of Supreme Delight, and the noble Maudgalyāyana was sitting in the middle of the road along which they were going; yet the sons of the gods went past without the leisure even to glance at the noble Maudgalyāyana. When Jīvaka came up level with him, he merely raised his hand to Maudgalyāyana from a distance and drove on with his chariot.

Then the noble Maudgalyāyana thought, "When this Jīvaka lived among humans in the past, he was my disciple. Now he is attached to the enjoyments of the gods, and his former memory has declined." Having thought this, by his miraculous power he blessed Jīvaka's chariot so that it could not move. Then Jīvaka got down from the chariot and bowed at the feet of the noble Maudgalyāyana, and Maudgalyāyana told him of many and various causes and conditions.

Jīvaka said to Maudgalyāyana, "Because I was the venerable one's disciple when I lived among humans, I at least raised my hand and greeted you. Do any of the other sons of the gods do even that much? Those born as gods are fixated on and attached to the enjoyment of pleasures, and so, having no control over themselves, they become like that."

Maudgalyāyana said to Jīvaka, "A disciple has been struck by illness and is sick. How should he be treated?"

Jīvaka said, "For the time being he should not eat food."

Then Maudgalyāyana urged Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, with these words: "Since it is extremely rare to meet a buddha who has come into the world, why do you not go to him from time to time and discuss the sublime Dharma?"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing with his mind the thought of the noble Maudgalyāyana, commissioned a son of the gods and sent him to summon another son of the gods; but though he was called as many as three times, he did not come. That son of the gods had no more than a single goddess and a single musician, yet because he was attached to and fixated on desire, he could not bear to leave them, strict though the command of the lord of the gods was, and only came later. Then, when Śakra asked him why this had happened, he told him honestly how it had come about.

Śakra said to Maudgalyāyana, "This son of the gods has no more than a single goddess and a single musician, and yet he cannot bear to give them up. As for my own sport and delight: I have become lord of the gods, surrounded by many and various celestial palaces and by countless goddesses, enjoying and sporting with all kinds of divine food of a hundred flavors and hundreds of thousands of divine musicians, so that when I look to the east I forget even the west. How much more, then, must this be so for me! Though I know that meeting a buddha who has come into the world is difficult, and that hearing the sublime Dharma is extremely difficult, I am bound and caught by the

pleasures of desire and have no control over myself, so that even though I know it, I am unable to act on it."

In the practice of taking moral discipline, the precepts are obtained by vowing resolutely with a heroic and courageous mind. In someone like a son of the gods, attached as he is to the pleasures of desire, the unwholesome mind predominates; and if the power of the wholesome mind is weak, by what force could he obtain the precepts? Those like the hungry ghosts do not, because they suffer from hunger and thirst, and their bodies and minds blaze and burn. Hell beings are tormented by countless sufferings of heat and cold, they experience all kinds of unbearable things, and their bodies and minds are in anguish, so they have no cause for obtaining the precepts. Those like the animals are obscured by karma and lack understanding, so for them there is no rite of taking the precepts. Where some sūtras say that on certain occasions nāgas took moral discipline, this means that, taking the eight-branch precepts with a wholesome mind, they obtained merit through that wholesome mind for the space of one day and night; but because they are obscured by karma, they did not obtain moral discipline.

If one distinguishes in terms of the four continents, the humans living in southern Jambudvīpa, in western Godānīya, in eastern Videha, and on the small islands in the ocean that belong to these three continents obtain the precepts. For example, the Buddha prophesied that in western Godānīya noble ones would dwell in assembly, and at present, since the great work of the Buddha is spreading there, the four kinds of assembly are also present. In eastern Videha too there are monks, and since the Buddha's Dharma is practiced there as well, the four assemblies are present. Only in northern Kuru is there no Buddha's Dharma, and moral discipline is not obtained there. That is because they are obscured by the ripening of meritorious karma and obscured by delusion, and so they have not become vessels for the Dharma of the noble ones.

Persons are of four kinds. What are they? Male, female, the paṇḍaka (one of neither sex), and one with both sexual characteristics. Of these four kinds, males and females can obtain the precepts; paṇḍakas and those with both characteristics do not obtain the precepts. Moreover, among males and females, whoever has killed father or mother, killed an arhat, drawn blood from the body of a buddha with malicious intent, caused a schism in the Saṅgha, engaged in unchaste conduct with a nun, robbed travellers on a narrow pass, lived in the community by theft, or severed the roots of virtue:

none of these persons obtains moral discipline. But if one examines this in terms of the great purpose, one who has deep faith and devotion toward the Buddha's Dharma is not included here. Whether a god, a nāga, a hungry ghost, a yakṣa, one of northern Kuru, a paṇḍaka, one with both sexual characteristics, or even one who has committed all kinds of evil and unwholesome deeds, such a one may take the three refuges.

It was asked, "Are the buddhas of the three times equal in their obtaining of moral discipline?"

He declared, "They are not equal. What is called obtaining moral discipline is that the precepts are obtained with respect to the realms of sentient beings and of what is not a sentient being. When a single buddha comes into the world, he acts for the benefit of countless sentient beings and leads them to nirvāṇa without remainder; therefore the buddhas who come into the world afterward do not obtain moral discipline with respect to any of those beings. Thus the buddhas, earlier and later, are not equal in their obtaining of moral discipline. For example, the Buddha Kāśyapa tamed countless sentient beings and led them to nirvāṇa without remainder; and whereas the Buddha Kāśyapa obtained moral discipline with respect to all of those beings, the Buddha Śākyamuni did not obtain moral discipline with respect to any of them."

"All buddhas are alike, equal in these three things. What are they? They are equal in the accumulations of their conduct, equal in the Dharma body, and equal in acting for the benefit of sentient beings. All buddhas alike practiced the conduct of a bodhisattva for three countless eons, perfected the Dharma body of five parts, and perfected the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha; and all of them led countless sentient beings into nirvāṇa."

It was asked, "Since the sūtras say that when a single buddha comes into the world he acts so that some ninety koṭis of niyutas of sentient beings pass into nirvāṇa, why do you say that he acts for the benefit of countless sentient beings?"

He declared, "When the sūtras say that a single buddha who comes into the world acts for the benefit of some ninety koṭis of niyutas of sentient beings, this refers to those who are liberated by that buddha. Among the sentient beings who are liberated, there are some whose benefit the Buddha himself accomplishes, some whose benefit his disciples accomplish, and some who are liberated by the Dharma he leaves behind. The words 'ninety koṭis of niyutas

of sentient beings' refer to those whose benefit the Buddha accomplishes himself; the words 'he led countless sentient beings into nirvāṇa without remainder' refer to the benefit he accomplishes in general. All the buddhas of the three times are equal in those respects, but in their obtaining of moral discipline they are not equal."

It was asked, "Is what is called the discipline of non-restraint obtained with respect to sentient beings and also what is not a sentient being? Is that discipline obtained with respect to everything, both what is appropriated by consciousness and what is not?"

He declared, "The discipline of non-restraint is obtained with respect to sentient beings; the discipline of non-restraint is not obtained with respect to what is not a sentient being. According to another view, the discipline of non-restraint is obtained with respect to sentient beings that may be killed, but that discipline is not obtained with respect to sentient beings that may not be killed. According to yet another view, the discipline of non-restraint is said to be obtained with respect to both, sentient beings that may be killed and those that may not. For example, a butcher who slaughters sheep is always equipped with the intention to kill and attends only to slaughtering sheep, so there is no measuring its extent. Even if he is born among gods or humans, and does not at once commit the act of killing, still, as he circles from one birth to the next, there is the possibility that he will be reborn again as a sheep. Therefore the discipline of non-restraint is obtained with respect to all sentient beings, and the twelve disciplines of non-restraint are likewise.

"The twelve disciplines of non-restraint are these: the butcher, the executioner, the pig breeder, the poultry breeder, the fisherman, the hunter, the bird catcher, the snake catcher, the one who casts spells on nāgas, the jailer, the thief, and the catcher of thieves: these are the twelve. Raising silkworms is also included among the disciplines of non-restraint.

"There are three occasions on which the discipline of non-restraint is lost: at the time of death, when attachment and fixation are exhausted, and when one takes the moral discipline of the vows. For example, when one takes the three refuges, by saying the first phrase at the beginning, the discipline of non-restraint is lost; then, when one says the second and the third phrases, the moral discipline of virtue is obtained."

It was asked, "When a person does the work of non-restraint, at what moment is the moral discipline of virtue lost and the discipline of non-virtue obtained?"

He declared, "When one first says the single phrase 'I am a butcher,' the discipline of virtue is lost, and by saying 'I am a butcher' a second and a third time, the discipline of non-virtue is obtained. According to another view, the discipline of non-virtue is obtained at the very moment the discipline of virtue is given up. If a person who keeps the discipline of virtue has not made the commitment 'I am a butcher,' but, attached merely to profit and gain, raises piglets and does the work of slaughter, then at that time his discipline of virtue is said to be lost; this is called giving up the discipline of virtue and obtaining the discipline of non-virtue. If he definitely commits himself, saying 'I am a butcher,' then too the discipline of non-virtue is obtained. The discipline of non-virtue is obtained merely by one's own commitment; it need not be received from anyone else. If one commits to take the discipline of non-virtue for one day and night, or two, up to ten days and nights, or for one year or two years, it is obtained accordingly, for as long or as short a time as one committed to. Therefore evil, non-virtuous things make one sink into the cycle of birth and death; they have no power to raise one higher and higher. Thus the discipline of non-virtue is obtained through the very deed itself, and is not like the moral discipline of virtue."

This was the eighth chapter, called Aniruddha, from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness. Seventh scroll, the last.

Moreover, when bodhisattva great beings, who know kindness, repay kindness, and with great skillful means act for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings, know the right time and occasion, their teaching and correcting do no harm.

Son of good family, a buddha appeared in the world called Fearless King, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, the Teacher, the Victor. He came into the world and acted for the benefit of the fortunate. Having acted for the benefit of the fortunate, he passed into parinirvāṇa.

After he had passed into nirvāṇa, while the sublime Dharma was being practiced, there arose a brahmin's son, upright in mind and possessed of sharp wisdom, who kept the five constant precepts and upheld the sublime Dharma. At a later time this brahmin's son set out for another country on business.

Since the road that travellers took was very dangerous, he went in the company of five hundred fellow travellers. When he and those companions reached the dangerous place, there were five hundred bandits living in that dangerous place, who constantly attacked the travellers passing through.

At that time, intending to attack those travellers, the bandit chief sent a man ahead to watch and observe how the travellers were going. Now among the bandits there was a man who had once been a close friend of the brahmin's son, and he came ahead among those travellers and warned the brahmin's son, saying, "Son of good family, understand this: tonight, in the first part of the night, enemies will come. Whatever happens, find some way to escape, so that you yourself are not harmed or wounded."

When the brahmin's son heard these words, he became as uneasy as a man who has something stuck in his throat that he can neither swallow nor spit out. He thought, "If I speak of this to my companions, I fear my companions will kill that man; and if my companions kill that man, my companions will experience countless sufferings in the three lower realms. If I do not tell my companions, the enemies will kill my companions; and if they kill my companions, the enemies will fall into the three lower realms and experience countless sufferings." Having thought this, he thought further, "I shall act as a means to the benefit and happiness of sentient beings. Even if I myself fall into the three lower realms and experience suffering, that is easy to bear." Having thought this, he took up a sword, killed the man who was to carry back the report, and so brought his companions to safety.

Then, when his companions saw what had happened, they said to the brahmin's son, "Son of a brahmin, you are the best among men and supremely virtuous. Why have you now committed such a great evil here?"

Then the brahmin's son set his knee on the ground, joined his palms, and with a mind full of wonder said to his companions, "Today I have committed a great evil that ought not to be done; and I did it in order to benefit sentient beings and to bring my companions to safety."

His companions said, "You killed a man; how can you say that you brought us to safety?"

The brahmin's son said, "This man I have killed was a cruel enemy. This enemy was coming to kill you, my companions; so, for your sake, my companions, I cut off this man's life, so that you may reach your country safely. As for me, even if I experience the sufferings of the hell beings, that is easy to bear."

Then the five hundred companions cried aloud and wept, and said, "Under the whole sky there is nothing so precious as life; of all terrors none surpasses death. Therefore all sentient beings, for the sake of body and life, will give up gold, silver, jewels, lands, wives, children, even food and clothing. Today we have gained back our lives once more." Having said this, they continued, "Son of a brahmin, because you disregarded the sufferings of the three lower realms for the sake of sentient beings, we remember your very great kindness. Remembering this great kindness, today we raise the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." So saying, all of them raised the mind set on awakening.

Then the five hundred bandits also said, "You are said to be the best of all and supremely virtuous; why have you committed such a great evil?"

The brahmin's son said, "I have committed a great evil that ought not to be done; and I did it in order to benefit all sentient beings and to protect your bodies and lives."

Then the bandits said to the brahmin's son, "You yourself killed a man; what benefit is there in that for us?"

The brahmin's son said, "Although I knew from the start that you bandits were here, I did not speak of it. I did not report it to the king, nor did I speak of it to my companions. Because I did not tell of it, your bodies and lives have remained safe."

When the bandits heard these words, they thought, "Only now are our bodies and lives truly spared." Having thought this, they joined their palms toward the brahmin's son and said, "Great being, excellent, excellent! You who are endowed with great compassion, please teach us what we should do from this day on."

The brahmin's son said, "Quickly raise the mind set on unsurpassed awakening."

Then the bandits too, in order to repay his kindness, at once raised the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Bodhisattvas who abide in diligence, who adorn awakening and wish to repay the kindness of the buddhas, should always regard all sentient beings as an only child, and keep them in mind. Son of good family, understand this: do not think that the brahmin's son at that time, on that occasion, was someone else. Do not regard it so. The one who

was then the brahmin's son is I myself now. Through that cause and that condition I passed beyond some ninety eons of saṃsāra and swiftly became fully and perfectly awakened in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

Moreover, this is how a bodhisattva who practices great skillful means knows kindness and repays kindness. Once, when the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying in the Bamboo Grove, a certain monk was struck by a disease of sores on his body. Pus and blood flowed continually from all over his body, so that no one wanted him, and he was put in a ruined, wretched hut outside the monastery. At that time the Tathāgata, by the power of his miraculous ability, blessed things so that not one of his large retinue knew of it, and the Tathāgata went alone to the sick monk, intending to wash him with water. Then, to bring good fortune to the gods of the desire realm, Śakra, lord of the gods, surrounded by a retinue of hundreds of thousands of countless gods, let fall divine flowers like rain, played divine music of every kind, and stationed himself in the sky above.

At that time the lord of the gods of the heaven of the Thirty-Three filled an excellent vase, formed from a hundred merits, with the pure water of great compassion, and holding it in his hand he bowed his head at the feet of the Tathāgata, came forward to meet the Tathāgata, and stood to one side. Then the Tathāgata stretched out his hand, endowed with a hundred merits, and from his five soft, long fingers he sent forth great rays of light, illuminating the gods and that whole great assembly. While that great assembly stayed where it was, the Tathāgata himself went up to the sick monk, sent forth rays of light from the crown of his head, and illuminated the sick monk. The instant the light touched the sick monk, the suffering of his illness was eased. With his body still covered in the pus and blood of his sores he begged for refuge, but he could not bow to the Tathāgata with his body. So the Tathāgata took the jeweled vase from Śakra, lord of the gods, with his right hand and poured the water over the crown of the sick monk's head, and with his left hand he washed and anointed the sores on the sick monk's body; and wherever the Tathāgata's hand passed, all the sick monk's sores were healed.

When all his sores were healed in this way, the monk was overjoyed, delighted and glad, and he said, "Homage to the Buddha Śākyamuni! Homage to the father of great compassion! Homage to the supreme, unsurpassed king of physicians! Today the illnesses of my body have been healed, but the illness of my mind alone is not yet healed. I beg the Tathāgata, out of his loving

concern, to grant me the medicine of the Dharma and to heal the illness of my mind as well."

Then the Tathāgata spoke these words to the sick monk: "Because the Tathāgata regards your kindness as very great, the Tathāgata has repaid your kindness."

At that the sick monk became exceedingly joyful. The Tathāgata inspired him, gladdened him and encouraged him, and the sick monk attained the fruit of an arhat and came to possess the three knowledges, the six superknowledges and the eight liberations.

Śakra, lord of the gods, and all the divine assembly were in doubt, and they said to the Tathāgata, "Why did the Tathāgata himself do this cleansing, washing away all the blood from the sores on the sick monk's body, and say that this monk has shown him very great kindness? Please explain and expound the meaning of this to us."

The Buddha spoke these words to Śakra, lord of the gods, and to the great assembly of gods: "Listen well and keep it well in mind, and I shall explain these matters. Śakra, lord of the gods, long ago in the past, countless, measureless eons ago, there was an evil king who acted against the Dharma and was given to plundering everyone. At that time that evil king summoned five hundred ministers, made a secret plan with them, and binding them to secrecy, ordered those ministers as follows: 'Whoever breaks the law, I empower you to punish him. Whatever wealth you obtain, you are to share it with me.' At that time those five hundred constantly carried out floggings; those from whom they got much wealth they let go accordingly, while those who had no wealth they harmed, even to the point of losing their lives.

"At that time a certain layman committed a small breach of the law, and he was led before the five hundred to be flogged. But because they had heard that this layman was very virtuous, they released him without doing him harm, and on that account the layman too was overjoyed.

"Kauśika, understand this: the five hundred at that time, on that occasion, were this sick monk. The one who at that time, on that occasion, was the layman is I myself now. Therefore a bodhisattva repays even a light kindness from countless eons before with a great one, and never forgets it, right up until he is fully awakened."

At that Śakra, lord of the gods, and the great assembly of gods became exceedingly joyful, and some eighty-four thousand of the divine assembly raised the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Having raised the mind set on awakening, they played divine music and went back each to his own abode.

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "A son of good family or a daughter of good family who knows kindness and repays kindness should devote himself to these four things. What are the four? Relying on a spiritual friend, listening to the Dharma with a one-pointed mind, attending to the meaning, and practicing just as one has been taught.

"Moreover, one should rely on four things. What are the four? Rely on the Dharma, not on the person; rely on the meaning, not on the letter; rely on wisdom, not on consciousness; rely on the sūtras of definitive meaning, not on the sūtras of provisional meaning. One who devotes himself to these eight things is called one who knows kindness.

"Moreover, one who possesses eight things is called one who repays kindness. What are the eight? They are not to heed gain, profit, disparagement, praise, fame, ridicule, suffering or happiness.

"Moreover, one who devotes himself to these four things is called one who knows kindness, and is also called one who repays kindness. What are the four? They are these: through having cultivated loving-kindness, when one sees evil sentient beings, one gives rise to a mind of love and tender affection; through having cultivated compassion, when one sees suffering sentient beings, one looks on them without weariness and does not abandon them; through having cultivated joy, when one sees teachers, masters, parents and those endowed with good qualities, one gives rise to a joyful mind; and through having cultivated equanimity, when one sees sentient beings who have become one's enemies, one does not give rise to a mind of anger."

Then Ānanda arranged his robe and spoke these words to the Buddha:

"Blessed One, when the Tathāgata first raised the mind set on awakening, how did he devote himself to the four things that have to do with knowing kindness and repaying kindness?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "Long ago in the past, countless, immeasurable, measureless eons ago, there appeared in the world a buddha called Vipaśyin, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed

with knowledge and conduct, a sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, the Teacher, the Victor, and he acted for the benefit of the fortunate. Having acted for the benefit of the fortunate, he passed into parinirvāṇa. When the sublime Dharma, and the practice of its semblance as well, had died out, in the land called Vārāṇasī the people were happy and at ease, the harvests were good, and the king governed the country according to the upright Dharma.

"In that land there was a mountain called Noble Sage Mountain, and on that mountain five hundred pratyekabuddhas always dwelt. Besides them, many sages endowed with the five superknowledges also dwelt there. At that time many wild animals and beasts of prey lived on that mountain as well. Among them was a lion called Firm Vow, the fur of whose body was the color of gold. He was of great might and splendor; when he roared, even the birds fell to the ground and the wild animals fled. As he roamed about that mountain, he met a pratyekabuddha who had the appearance and bearing of a renunciant, and a mind of great joy toward him arose in the lion. Day after day he stayed close to him and continually heard him reciting sūtras and teaching the sublime Dharma.

"At that time a great and cruel hunter saw the lion with its golden pelt, and a mind of great delight arose in him. He thought, 'If I kill that golden lion, skin it and present the pelt to the king, I shall certainly obtain a great reward, and for seven generations my family will be free of want.' Having thought this, he thought further, 'This lion called Firm Vow is the king of the beasts of prey, so he cannot be brought down even with bow and arrow, and nothing can be done with snares and nets either. Now I shall use a stratagem like this: since this lion, king of beasts, follows after renunciants, I too shall take on the appearance of a renunciant. I shall hide my bow and arrows under a Dharma robe, lower my eyes, walk with slow steps and sit at the foot of a tree. As soon as he sees me, he will surely come up to me; and if he comes up to me, I shall draw my bow to the full, and if I shoot him with a poisoned arrow, he will surely die.'

"Having thought this, he went back home and said, 'My family has lived by hunting for generations, yet I have never even heard of a beast of prey with golden fur, let alone seen one. Now, in order to kill it, I shall shave my hair and beard.' Then he put on the Dharma robe, went back once again to that mountain, and sat at the foot of a tree.

"Then the lion Firm Vow saw the monk and was overjoyed. Bounding and leaping, he came up close to the monk and licked his feet. Then the hunter shot an arrow at the lion. Stricken with pain by the poisoned arrow, the lion roared and was about to seize him and spring, when he thought, 'This man is wearing the dyed robe of a renunciant, the noble banner of the buddhas of the three times. Though it would not be hard for me to harm him, if I harm him and separate him from his life faculty, I shall have defiled the noble banner of the buddhas.' Having thought this, he stayed where he was and did nothing.

"Before long the poison took effect, and the pain became all the more unbearable. Again he thought, 'Shall I devour him and tear him apart?' But then he thought, 'That would not be hard; yet if I harm him, the buddhas and the noble ones will censure me, saying that in the world there is no difference between those who do good and those who do evil. This man is evil, for he came to kill me; but if I do not show patience toward him, I shall be no different from that evildoer. Whoever cultivates patience, everyone will come to love; whoever is impatient, everyone will come to hate, and afflictions will arise in him. When afflictions have arisen, he circles in the saṃsāra of birth and death. Circling in birth and death, he is born in states without leisure. Born in states without leisure, he is parted from spiritual friends. Parted from spiritual friends, he does not hear the sublime Dharma. Not hearing the sublime Dharma, he is caught in the net of doubt. Caught in the net of doubt, he is parted from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Therefore I shall not give rise to an evil mind.' Having thought this, he spoke these verses:

'Better that my body and life should perish
Than that I give rise to an unwholesome, evil mind.
Even though I should be parted from my life,
I shall not harm one who wears the saffron robe.
Toward those who have gone forth
I shall never give rise to an evil thought.'

"Having spoken these verses, he died. Heaven and earth shook six times. The beasts of prey and wild animals fled in terror in the four directions. Rain fell without clouds, and even the sun lost its light.

"Then the hunter took off the robe, took up a knife, skinned the lion and went back home. Having gone back home, he presented the pelt to the king. When the king saw the pelt he was overjoyed, and he said to his ministers, 'Since I was born I have never heard that there was any animal whose pelt had fur the

color of gold. Now to see it here directly with my own eyes is a great wonder, a great wonder!' And he asked the hunter, 'By what means did you obtain such a pelt?'

"Then the hunter said to the king, 'Great king, if you grant me immunity, I will speak truthfully.' The king commanded, 'It is granted to you, just as you wish,' and the hunter told him just what had happened.

"When the king heard these words, he was overwhelmed with grief, and like a man with something stuck in his throat that he can neither swallow nor spit out, he was ill at ease. He gathered together all the great ministers, the vassal kings and the whole great assembly, and commanded as follows:

"All of you, understand this. Long ago I heard learned and wise men say, 'If, among those born in the animal realm, one has body hair the color of gold, it is without doubt a bodhisattva.' If even a single ordinary person gives rise to the mind set on unsurpassed awakening, he accomplishes the great aim of benefit and happiness for all sentient beings. Why did this evil hunter use such a means and kill a bodhisattva? If I were to give him a minister's post, or a reward, or a Nepalese elephant, or a horse, or the seven precious things, or clothing, or food, or wealth, or grain, or riches of this kind, I would be in league with that evil man and would become his accomplice." Having thought this, he cut off the hunter's life.

"Having thus cut off the hunter's life, he took the lion's pelt and went to that mountain. There he piled up gośīrṣa sandalwood and cremated the lion's pelt together with its body. When he had thus cremated the lion's body, he gathered up the bones, built a stupa, and made offerings to it."

The Blessed One then said to Ānanda, "Sons of noble family, at that time, on that occasion, the lion called Firm Vow was none other than I myself, now Śākyamuni. Therefore, because he relies on a spiritual friend, a bodhisattva would sooner let body and life perish than give rise to an evil thought. Why is that? Because he knows kindness and repays kindness. And how is that so? By relying on a spiritual friend, a bodhisattva swiftly attains unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"Son of noble family, a bodhisattva constantly and diligently relies on spiritual friends, and in order to conquer and crush the afflictions of the three realms, he strives earnestly to hear even a single word of the Buddha's Dharma, or a single verse, or even a single point of meaning. When a bodhisattva thus seeks the Buddha's teaching single-mindedly, he is so fully possessed by the

longing for the Dharma that, not sparing even body and life, he would make his way across iron glowing with embers, or crawl along the very ground, without a thought for the harm. If a bodhisattva does not spare body and life even for the sake of a few verses, what need is there to speak of the twelve divisions of the scriptures? If he does not spare body and life even for a single verse, what need is there to speak of anything else, of outward material things?

"Through hearing the Dharma, his body and mind become deeply at ease, and as a mind of great faith arises, he attains the mind of right view. When he sees one who teaches the Dharma, it is as if he were seeing his father and mother, and no pride arises in him. He listens to the Dharma for the sake of sentient beings, not for gain and fame. He works for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings, not for his own benefit. For the sake of the true Dharma he has no fear of kings, of hunger and thirst, cold and heat, of tigers, wolves and other fierce beasts of prey, of thieves, enemies and the like. First he subdues the afflictions of the senses, and only then listens to the Dharma; he does not listen at the wrong time, but listens single-mindedly. Showing reverence to the Dharma, he serves the teacher of the Dharma with respect. This is called the bodhisattva's knowing kindness and repaying kindness.

"How does a bodhisattva listen to the Dharma single-mindedly? There are four ways of listening to the Dharma: with a true mind, with a one-pointed mind, with a mind given wholly in every respect, and with a virtuous mind. These four are called the bodhisattva's diligence in seeking the twelve divisions of the scriptures. Why is that? He keeps in mind the weighty kindness of the buddhas in order to spread the true Dharma of all the buddhas everywhere, in order to make the true Dharma of all the buddhas arise and increase, in order that worldly people may have faith in the Buddha's Dharma, and in order to bring all sentient beings to unsurpassed awakening. Therefore the bodhisattva keeps in mind the countless sentient beings of the ten directions. In order to repay the weighty kindness of all the buddhas, the bodhisattva strives to seek the twelve divisions of the scriptures.

"When a bodhisattva diligently seeks the Buddha's Dharma, he studies the treatises on the science of reasoning so that all sentient beings may give rise to faith. Moreover, the bodhisattva studies the treatises on the science of reasoning in order to know all faults and flaws, to demolish the doctrines of the wrong views of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), to know the skillful means for taming sentient beings, and to distinguish the meaning taught by the

Tathāgata from the meaning of worldly speech.

"Why does a bodhisattva study the treatises on the science of language? Because speech is adorned by fully correct words, and the meaning cannot be clearly shown with incorrect words; in order to know and comprehend every meaning; so that, correct speech not declining, he is not undone by pride; and in order to turn others back from wrong views and know the skillful means for taming sentient beings. For these reasons the bodhisattva studies the treatises on the science of language.

"Why does a bodhisattva study the treatises on the science of medicine? In order to free sentient beings from the hundred and four unwholesome diseases; out of love and tender care for all sentient beings, in order to make sentient beings give rise to faith; in order that, being thus freed from disease, they may give rise to joy; so that, joy having thus arisen, they will always keep the Buddha in mind; and in order, through great compassion, to bring sentient beings across to the far shore. For these reasons the bodhisattva studies the treatises on the science of medicine.

"Why does a bodhisattva study the worldly arts and crafts? In order to benefit sentient beings; so that, since wealth and goods are then easily obtained, sentient beings may be brought to faith; in order, by knowing every kind of worldly activity, to overcome pride; in order to tame sentient beings; and in order to clear away every obscuration brought about by the things of worldly existence. For these reasons the bodhisattva studies the arts and crafts.

"If a bodhisattva has not trained in the five fields of knowledge, he will never be able to attain the wisdom of omniscience in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Therefore, in order to attain unsurpassed awakening, one should train in the five fields of knowledge.

"A bodhisattva's knowing kindness and repaying kindness means that he should explain and teach sentient beings what is to be explained. How should he explain it? In order that they may attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he should explain in a way endowed with the five fields of knowledge. Explanation, moreover, is of two kinds: gradual explanation and completely pure explanation.

"What is gradual explanation? First one explains the perfection of generosity, and after that one explains everything from the perfection of moral discipline up to the perfection of wisdom; and, in order to know kindness and repay kindness, one attends to the meaning and abides in accordance with the

Dharma. This is called gradual explanation.

"What is called completely pure explanation? If the listener is sitting while the one who explains is standing, one should not explain to him. If the listener looks for faults in the Dharma or looks for faults in the explanation, one should not explain to him. If the listener relies on the person and does not rely on the Dharma, then, since he does not rely on the Dharma, one should not explain to him. If the listener relies on the letter and does not rely on the meaning, one should not explain to him; and so on, up to: if he relies on the provisional meaning and does not rely on the definitive meaning, one should not explain to him. Why is that? Because such a person has no respect for the completely pure Dharma of the buddhas and bodhisattvas. When the one who explains and teaches also honors the Dharma, and the one who listens to the Dharma listens one-pointedly with a respectful mind and without any pride, that is called completely pure explanation.

"Furthermore, what is called gradual explanation is explaining everything. What is called explaining everything is explaining the twelve divisions of the scriptures, down to a single word, a single verse, or half a verse; and this, too, is endowed with the sound of the words, with meaning, and with the Dharma. In teaching the Dharma and its meaning, at the proper time one teaches so as to inspire, to praise and uplift, and to gladden; at certain times one rebukes and scolds; at certain times one teaches straightforwardly and directly; at certain times one teaches with examples, in whatever way suits the listener; at certain times one teaches in a way closer to them and easier than that; and at certain times one teaches what is easy to enter, in accordance with their inclinations. This is called the supreme gradual explanation of the Dharma, in which the bodhisattva is skilled in knowing kindness and repaying kindness.

"Furthermore, what is called completely pure explanation is this. The bodhisattva, the great being, cultivates a mind of loving-kindness toward enemies and those hostile to him, and with a mind of loving-kindness he teaches the Dharma through many kinds of means to sentient beings who commit misdeeds, to careless persons and to the lazy; through many kinds of means he teaches the Dharma to the arrogant and haughty, and so on, down to persons who are poor and destitute; and he does so not to praise himself or disparage others, nor for the sake of food and drink, gain and fame. This is called the completely pure explanation of the Dharma, in which the bodhisattva is skilled in knowing kindness and repaying kindness.

"How, then, does one abide in accordance with the Dharma? One cultivates the virtuous qualities of the actions of body, speech and mind, and is endowed with complete purity; and knowing kindness and repaying kindness is, moreover, the full revealing of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

"Furthermore, the bodhisattva, the great being, who knows kindness and repays kindness attends to the meaning. In order to obtain dhāraṇī through great learning and to make the lamp of the Dharma blaze, he should strive, for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, in generosity, moral discipline and great learning. He should make offerings to and serve the one who teaches and explains the Dharma. He does not ascribe faults to the Dharma, and he does not ascribe faults to the one who teaches and explains it. To give fearlessness to sentient beings with a mind free of harm and violence is called knowing kindness. To enjoy the pleasures of gods and humans and to attain the path that passes beyond sorrow is called knowing kindness and repaying kindness.

"Furthermore, the bodhisattva cultivates patience by four factors and completely abandons impatience. In order to adorn awakening, he gathers many sentient beings and sets them in the cultivation of patience; he himself practices patience, and he also establishes others in practicing patience; and he is free of fear. This is called knowing kindness. Because he has practiced patience in this way, no angry thought arises in him, and so he has an excellent retinue. Since no suffering or affliction arises, he has no remorse. And when he has left this body, he enjoys the pleasures of gods and humans and attains nirvāṇa. This is called repaying kindness.

"Son of noble family, furthermore, the bodhisattva undertakes diligence by four factors. Having completely abandoned laziness, he gathers sentient beings in order to adorn awakening. Because he undertakes diligence for the sake of the path to awakening, he is at ease when he sleeps and at ease when he wakes; being free of afflictions, happy qualities arise and increase in him, and he enjoys happiness in his body. This is called accomplishing his own benefit. Though the bodhisattva undertakes diligence, he does not harm sentient beings; he does not beat, abuse or revile them. This is called accomplishing the benefit of others. And when he has left this body, he enjoys the pleasures of gods and humans and is endowed with power and might, and by attaining the path to awakening he will attain the great fruit. These are called the four factors of the bodhisattva's undertaking of diligence.

"By cultivating meditative absorption, the bodhisattva completely abandons the agitated mind and gathers sentient beings in order to adorn awakening. Because he has cultivated meditative absorption for the sake of the path to awakening, even in this life he experiences worldly happiness, and his body and mind are secluded and at peace. This is called knowing kindness. Since his body and mind are thus secluded and at peace, he does not harm sentient beings. This is called repaying kindness. And when the bodhisattva has left this body, he obtains a completely pure body, enjoys perfect bliss, and attains complete nirvāṇa. These are called the four factors of the bodhisattva's cultivation of meditative concentration.

"Furthermore, the bodhisattva who knows kindness and repays kindness destroys ignorance by being endowed with wisdom, and in order to adorn awakening completely he gathers sentient beings through the four means of attraction. Because, by cultivating wisdom for the sake of awakening, he knows and realizes the expanse of phenomena, he enjoys happiness in his body; this is called accomplishing his own benefit. Bringing about the worldly benefit and the world-transcending benefit of sentient beings is called accomplishing the benefit of others. Because he has completely abandoned the two obscurations, the afflictive obscuration and the obscuration to the knowable, it is called the great fruit. These are called the four inconceivable factors of wisdom of the bodhisattva who knows kindness and repays kindness.

"Furthermore, through the higher knowledge that recollects former lives, the bodhisattva realizes with wisdom the things of the past. He examines the virtuous and evil deeds of sentient beings, and for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings who belong to the virtuous side, the bodhisattva, the great being, through skillful means was born in the Tuṣita heaven with a perfect span of life. There he possessed three supreme things: supreme life, supreme form and supreme fame. When first he descended from that abode, he sent forth great rays of light that illuminated the ten directions, and he knew the time of entering his mother's womb, how long he would remain in the womb, and the time of his birth from the womb. Toward each of the ten directions, unsupported by anyone, he took seven steps, and proclaimed: 'This present body of mine is the very last.' The gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras and great mahoragas made offerings to him with flowers, incense, music, cymbals, banners and excellent parasols.

"Because he was endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great being, there was no body more supreme than his. By the force of loving-kindness he vanquished the armies of Māra. Each of his joints had the strength of a mighty wrestler. When he was a young boy, without having studied the affairs of the world, he understood and knew them all. Without a teacher, seeking by himself, he spontaneously accomplished unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Urged by Brahmā, lord of the gods, he turned the wheel of Dharma for sentient beings. Resting evenly in meditative absorption, he did not move even when thunder roared. Beasts of prey came close to him and regarded him with affection, as if he were their father and mother. When an animal offered him alms, the Buddha knew its intention. Gods and nāgas sent down rain and bathed his body. The branches of the trees bent toward him and sheltered him with their shade. Even after he had become fully awakened, for six years the wicked Māra constantly sought an opening, but found none. Because he constantly rested evenly in meditative absorption, his mind of close mindfulness was perfected, and he was supremely skilled in the arising and ceasing of conceptual thought. This is called the inconceivable common birth of the bodhisattva.

"The uncommon birth is this: for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings, for example, madmen regain their former minds through the condition of seeing the Tathāgata, the blind come to see, a child lying head-reversed in the womb is safely delivered, the deaf come to hear with their ears, and those possessed of attachment, aversion and delusion are purified of the three poisons. Such a thing is called the inconceivable uncommon birth.

"Furthermore, what is called the common birth is the inconceivable conduct of the Tathāgata: he always lies down on his right side; like the king of lions, he does not stir, as a clump of grass stirs; even the Vairambha wind, king of winds, does not move so much as the hem of his robe; his gait as he walks is like that of the lion, king of beasts, or of the king of geese; when he sets out, he puts his right foot forward first; wherever he goes, the ground, high or low, becomes level; his alms food has no fault of foul smell, and none of it falls back from his mouth. This is called the inconceivable common birth.

"Furthermore, the inconceivable common birth is as follows. The soles of his feet are level and full. On the soles of his feet are wheels with a thousand spokes. His fingers are slender and long. His heels are round and full. The spaces between his fingers are joined by webbing. His hands and feet are soft and supple. His calves are round and tapering, like those of the eṇa antelope,

king of deer. His ankle bones do not protrude. His hands reach to his knees. Like the king of horses, his private parts are withdrawn within a sheath. Like the nyagrodha tree, the proportions of his body are perfect. The hairs of his body point upward. Each hair curls to the right. The color of his body is like refined gold. He has a constant halo of light a fathom wide. His skin is supple and smooth, and is not stained by dust or dirt. Seven places of his body are full. The upper part of his body is like a lion's. His forearms are round and tapering. His collarbones are evenly full. He has the mark of a broad upper and lower body. He has forty teeth. His teeth are well set and even. His teeth are white. His cheeks are full like those of the lion, king of beasts. He has the supreme sense of taste. He has the mark of the fleshy protuberance. His tongue is long and broad. He has the voice of Brahmā. His eyes are the color of sapphire. His eyes are like those of the king of bulls. Between his eyebrows is a white curl of hair.

"In the same way he is endowed with the eighty inconceivable excellent minor marks, and each excellent minor mark has some hundred thousand supreme and sublime excellences. For the sake of each of those excellent minor marks, the bodhisattva, from the time he first gave rise to the mind set on awakening, being utterly steadfast in awakening, practiced those sublime deeds in order to know kindness and repay kindness, and therefore he attained unsurpassed awakening.

The Buddha said: "Because, long ago, for countless and immeasurable eons, the Tathāgata kept moral discipline completely pure, he came to have the mark of soles that are level and full. Through the condition of having made offerings to and honored his father and mother, his teachers, his lamas and persons endowed with good qualities, he came to have the mark of wheels on the soles of his feet. He did not harm sentient beings and had no thought of robbing or stealing; he went out from afar to greet his father and mother, his teachers, his lamas and persons endowed with good qualities, and escorted them on their way; he spread out seats for them, and, abandoning pride, served them, honored them and bowed to them. By that cause and that condition he came to have the mark of fingers that are slender and long. Because he possessed the three deeds mentioned above, he came to have the mark of heels that are round and full.

"Because he gathered many beings through the four means of attraction, by that cause and that condition he came to have the mark of the spaces between his fingers being joined by webbing. Because he anointed and

massaged with butter and sesame oil the bodies of his father and mother, his teachers, his lamas and persons endowed with good qualities, by that cause and that condition his hands and feet are supple, long and soft. Because he never tired of cultivating virtuous qualities, by that cause and that condition his shoulders are even and his forearms round and tapering. If one delights in hearing the Dharma, is eager also to teach the Dharma to others, and runs errands for the sake of the Dharma, then by that cause and that condition one has the mark of ankle bones that do not show. By the cause and condition of having kept his three doors completely pure, of having tended the sick and given the gift of medicine, of being without pride and content with food and drink, his hands reach to his knees when he stands upright.

"If one reconciles with gentle words those who have fallen into enmity, and oneself practices the qualities that go with a sense of shame and leads others to practice them too, then by that cause and that condition one's private parts are withdrawn within a sheath, like those of the king of horses. Because he kept his own three doors completely pure and purified those of others as well, and healed with medicine sentient beings who had fallen ill through the disturbance of the four great elements, by that cause and that condition the marks of his body are complete.

"Because he delighted in hearing the Dharma and was eager to teach the Dharma to others, he has the mark of the hairs of his body pointing upward. If one reflects on the profound meaning of the Dharma, is eager to cultivate virtuous qualities, makes offerings to one's father and mother, one's teachers, one's lamas and persons endowed with good qualities, and clears away the stones, pebbles, thorns and filth that lie on the roads and paths at the stupas of the Buddha and the dwellings of the Saṅgha, then by that cause and that condition one comes to have the mark of each hair curling to the right. If one gives food, drink, ornaments and the like to others and has no thought of hatred, then by that cause and that condition one has the color of refined gold and the characteristic of a constant radiance.

"If one asks by what deed he has the mark of a single hair growing from each pore, it arises from that very same deed as its cause; and by that very same karmic cause he has the mark of a body that is supple and smooth and is not stained by dust or dirt. Because he constantly gave sentient beings the goods they needed, by that cause and that condition he has the mark of the seven places being evenly full. If, having destroyed one's own pride and arrogance, one attunes oneself to the minds of sentient beings with a mind that is by

nature gentle and mild, acts in accordance with the Dharma, and teaches virtuous qualities so that unvirtuous ones may be abandoned, then by that cause and that condition one has the mark of an upper body like that of the lion, king of beasts, the mark of the space between the brows and the collarbones being evenly full, the mark of long fingers, and the mark of the body's outline being broad and smooth.

"Because he completely abandoned slander and reconciled those in dispute and enmity, by that cause and that condition he has the mark of forty teeth, the mark of well-set teeth, and the mark of even teeth. Because he cultivated loving-kindness in the desire realm, by that cause and that condition he has the mark of white teeth. Because, when he saw beggars, he greeted them and saw them on their way with a joyful mind, by that cause and that condition he came to have the mark of cheeks like a lion's. Because he regarded all sentient beings equally, as one's only child, by that cause and that condition he has the mark of the supreme sense of taste.

"If one constantly gives sentient beings the taste of the unsurpassed Dharma, reminds those who have forgotten and do not remember, oneself keeps the five precepts and urges others to keep them too, and with a mind of loving-kindness makes the great gift of the Dharma, then by that cause and that condition one has the mark of the fleshy protuberance on the crown and the mark of a tongue that is long and broad. Because he spoke truthful words, words that bring delight in the Dharma, and gentle and mild words, and did not speak untimely words, by that cause and that condition he has the voice of Brahmā. Because he cultivated a mind of compassion and regarded sentient beings as his father and mother, by that cause and that condition he has the mark of eyes like sapphire and eyes like those of the king of bulls. Because he did not conceal the merits of those endowed with good qualities, but praised and extolled them, by that cause and that condition he has the mark of the white curl of hair.

"Although the causes and conditions of these thirty-two marks have been explained one by one, their true cause and condition are moral discipline and diligence. Why is that? If, without keeping moral discipline and without practicing diligence, one cannot obtain even a human body, what need is there to speak of obtaining the thirty-two marks? The crown of the head that cannot be seen and the mark of the fleshy protuberance on the crown are not two different things. Furthermore, the causes are not fixed one to each: if in whatever one does there is no regret, by that cause and that condition one

obtains the mark of soles that are level and full.

"Again, if one acts single-mindedly, by that cause one has the mark of wheels with a thousand spokes, the third mark and the fourth, the joining of the fingers, the seven places being evenly full, suppleness and smoothness, round shoulders, full collarbones, an upright body, and the mark of a tongue that is long and broad. Again, if one acts with careful consideration, by that cause one obtains the mark of long fingers, the mark of the hands reaching to the knees, the mark of a constant halo a fathom wide, and the mark of teeth that are well set and not crooked. If one acts with complete purity, by that cause one will obtain the remaining marks.

"Furthermore, because he gave rise to nothing but wholesome thoughts toward sentient beings, by that cause he obtains the mark of hands and feet that are supple and smooth, and of skin that is supple and smooth and is not stained by dust or dirt. Because he meditated and practiced step by step, and meditated and practiced at the proper time, by that cause he obtains the second, third and fourth marks. Because he was eager to cultivate virtuous qualities and had no regret, by that cause he obtains the mark of a body the color of gold, a constant radiance, white teeth, and the curl of hair between the eyebrows. If, even when praised and extolled, one does not grow proud, but conceals one's own merits and has no conceit, then by that cause one obtains the mark of private parts withdrawn within a sheath, like a horse's. If one dedicates to awakening whatever virtuous deeds one has done, then by that cause one obtains the mark of a single hair growing from each pore, hairs pointing upward, forty teeth, and the mark of the supreme sense of taste. If one is constantly diligent, then by that cause one obtains the mark of rounded cheeks and of an upper body like a lion's. Because he regarded all sentient beings with affection, as one's only child, by that cause he obtains the mark of teeth well set and even, eyes like sapphire, and eyes like those of the king of bulls. Because he had no weariness or fatigue in accomplishing virtuous qualities, he obtains the remaining marks.

"When the bodhisattva, the great being, practices and abides in the characteristics, he performs the deeds for the thirty-two marks. When he abides in pure conduct, he has the thirty-two marks, but they are neither complete nor clear. When he abides in the thirteenth stage of conduct, the marks too become manifestly clear and complete. Although the marks of the Buddha's qualities are countless, they would not suit sentient beings, for beings are of superior, middling and inferior capacity, and those marks are

inconceivable. Therefore the Buddha spoke of thirty-two excellent marks.

"If all the merit that all sentient beings possess were gathered together in one place and heaped up, it would equal the mark of a single hair of the Tathāgata. If all the merit of all the pores were gathered and heaped together, it would equal one excellent minor mark. If all the merit of all the excellent minor marks were multiplied a hundredfold, it would equal one major mark, apart from the mark of the white curl of hair between the eyebrows and the mark of the crown of the head that cannot be seen. If all the other marks besides these were gathered together and multiplied a thousandfold, they would amount to those two higher marks. If all the merit of the thirty-two marks and the eighty excellent minor marks were gathered and heaped together and multiplied ten million times, it would equal the mark of the Tathāgata's voice, deep like thunder and resounding far. That voice of his resounds through buddha fields as numerous as the atoms of the immeasurable, boundless, inconceivable buddha fields. Because he practices loving-kindness and great compassion for the sake of sentient beings, this knowing kindness and repaying kindness of his is inconceivable.

"Thus, through each of those marks and excellent minor marks, he benefited and brought happiness to immeasurable, countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of ordinary beings, as many as the atoms of the great earth, and led them to give rise to the mind set on awakening. Having thus gradually brought his practice to completion, he obtained both the marks and the excellent minor marks. When the marks and excellent minor marks were complete, he went to the foot of the tree of awakening, subdued the armies of Māra, became fully awakened, and truly turned the wheel of Dharma. For the benefit and happiness of ordinary beings he delivered them from the river of desire and set them on the shore of the perfection of wisdom, and so brought to completion the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Ānanda, to the bodhisattvas, the great beings, and to all the great assembly: "Sons of noble family, which of you, ever mindful of the Buddha's kindness and in order to protect the true Dharma, will write in volumes, read and recite this most profound sūtra, the Great Skillful Means Sūtra on Repaying Kindness? Who, in the evil times to come, will rouse great diligence and protect and uphold this unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? Who, to protect the Dharma, is able to spread this sūtra far and wide and to work for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings?"

When he had spoken thus, some hundred thousand myriads of bodhisattvas, great beings, who were in that very assembly rose from their seats, arranged their robes, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, placed their right knees on the ground, bowed with palms joined, and said to the Buddha: "Blessed One, in the evil times to come we are eager to protect this unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, to uphold the true Dharma, and to work for the benefit of many sentient beings."

Then the bodhisattva Siṃha said, "Blessed One, I too am eager to gather sentient beings through many different means."

The bodhisattva Vajra said, "I am eager to see to it, by whatever means, that sentient beings who would fall into the three lower realms do not fall."

The bodhisattva Mañjuśrī said, "I am eager to fulfill completely whatever sentient beings may wish for."

The bodhisattva Jñānaketu said, "I am eager to give sentient beings the victory banner of the Dharma of great wisdom."

The bodhisattva Dharmaketu said, "Blessed One, I am eager to give the Dharma completely to sentient beings."

The bodhisattva Sūryaprabha said, "Blessed One, I am eager to give happiness to sentient beings."

The bodhisattva Candraprabha said, "Blessed One, I am eager to urge sentient beings to engage in the work of merit."

The bodhisattva Śramaṇa said, "Blessed One, I am eager to urge all sentient beings not to dwell in heedlessness."

The bodhisattva Akṣayamati said, "Blessed One, I am eager to teach all sentient beings to see the meaning of the inexhaustible sphere."

The bodhisattva Moonlight Son said, "Blessed One, I am eager to give unsurpassed happiness to all sentient beings."

Thus each of those bodhisattvas made a pledge. In order to adorn awakening completely, to benefit all sentient beings and bring them happiness, remembering the Buddha's kindness, and in order to repay the Buddha's kindness, they rose from their seats, joined their palms, bowed, and said, "Please entrust this sūtra of the Buddha to us."

At that time the venerable Ānanda said this: "Blessed One, what is the name of this sūtra, and how should we uphold it?"

The Blessed One said to Ānanda, "This sūtra is called The Compendium of All Grounds of Virtue. It is also called The Great Skillful Means. It is also called The Conduct of the Sublime Intention. It is also called The Repaying of the Buddha's Kindness."

The Blessed One then said this to Ānanda and to the bodhisattva great beings: "Practice it diligently, just as it has been taught!"

When this chapter of the Buddha's final instructions had been taught, seventy-two thousand śrāvakas gave rise to the mind set on unsurpassed awakening. Moreover, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, humans, nonhumans and all the others rejoiced at what the Buddha had said.

This concludes the ninth chapter, called Close Attendance, from The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

This completes the sūtra called The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness.

## Translator's Notes

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and the title line gives the Chinese title in Tibetan letters. Many of the bodhisattva names are Tibetan renderings of Chinese names whose Indian forms cannot be identified with confidence; these, and the disciple's name rendered "Fair Goodness," are translated literally. □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Mahāpanthaka, though the final element is unusual.
• The light is said to go to the east, and the bodhisattvas there see it coming from the west, which is consistent: from that eastern world, the Sahā world lies to the west. The world system, its buddha and his field (Highest Supreme, King of Joy, Perfectly Arrayed) are translated literally, since their Indian forms cannot be determined with confidence from this text, which was translated from Chinese.
• The names of the world system, its buddha and his field (Light of Qualities, Attending to Signs, Utterly Pure) are translated literally, since their Indian forms cannot be determined with confidence in this sūtra translated from Chinese.
• The name of the buddha □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ has been rendered literally as "Sun, Moon, and Lamp Light"; this sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and a confident Sanskrit form cannot be established. "The Great Skillful Means by Which the Buddha Repays Kindness" renders the sūtra's own title as given in the passage.
• The names of the world system □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("King of Mighty Renown"), the buddha □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Crimson Lotus Light"; □□□□□□□ denotes a vermilion or deep red color), and the buddha field □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Stainless") are translated by meaning, since this sūtra was rendered into Tibetan from Chinese and their Sanskrit forms cannot be established with confidence.

• Here the buddha's name appears as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, a slight variant of the form in the previous passage; it has been kept as "Crimson Lotus Light" for consistency.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ appears to stand for the standard □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the ten entanglements (paryavasthāna); it is rendered "entangled by the ten entanglements."
• The prince's name □□□□□□□□□ is a phonetic transcription; since this sūtra was translated from Chinese, it is taken to represent the Chinese transcription of Sujāti, the prince of the parallel Chinese story, and rendered "Sujāti". The phrase rendered "no one could be said to go without" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is somewhat obscure in the Tibetan.
• In this piece the prince is named both □□□□□□□□□ (rendered Sujāti, as earlier) and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Prince Good Aim"). The narrative makes clear they are the same boy, and □□□□□□□ appears to be a Tibetan semantic rendering of his name, so it is given as Sujāti throughout. The sentence beginning "If they rested even a little" reads □□□□□□□□; it is taken as "rest, stop" (□□□□ / □□□□), which fits the context.
• "Measures" renders □□□□□, a unit of weight (corresponding to the Chinese jin, "catty," of the source of this sūtra, which was translated into Tibetan from Chinese). The prince's list names "eleven merits" but the items given do not clearly number eleven; the list is translated as it stands. In the final lines □□□□□□ is read as □□□□□ (□□□□□□□) □□□□, "as before."
• In this piece the prince is called □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Prince Accomplished Aim," the usual Tibetan for Siddhārtha), where earlier pieces called him □□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□; since the narrative plainly concerns the same prince, Sujāti is kept throughout. The mother's name □□□□□□□ ("Beautiful Goddess") is taken as the Buddha's mother Māyā, as the parallel identification with Śuddhodana requires; the Tibetan form is not the usual one for her name. In the comparison of lights, "or like night compared with the light of a precious jewel" renders a compressed phrase (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

sūtra's own sequence, which differs from the usual eight hot hells.
• The hell guardian's name □□□□ is a transcription, apparently of the Chinese name of the ox-headed hell jailer in the Chinese original of this sūtra; it is given here as Abang. The king's name □□□□□□□□□ is taken as Udayana, the king traditionally credited with the first sandalwood image of the Buddha. The disciple □□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is translated by meaning as "Near Protector"; the one described as supreme in the divine eye is usually Aniruddha. □□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□ "iron hammer" with the instrumental. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered loosely as "hundreds of thousands of myriads," a large indefinite number.
• Here □□□□□□□□ is plainly the Bodhisattva, son of Śuddhodana, and is given as Siddhārtha, unlike the Sujāti of an earlier chapter. Several names are Tibetan transcriptions of the Chinese forms in this sūtra, which was translated from Chinese: □□□□□□□ is taken as Agnidatta, the king who gave the Buddha horse fodder; □□□□□□□ as Dravya, the monk in charge of seating; □□□□□□ as Panthaka; □□□□□□□□□ as Subhadra, the aged last disciple. The daughter's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning as "Taste of Nectar." In this text the bride given to Siddhārtha is called □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, Prajāpatī, and is kept as such. □□□□□□□□□□□□ "snake-seller" is read as □□□□□□□□□□ "courtesan." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is unclear; "until the observance begins" is a tentative rendering. □□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□ in Cunda's description are read as "feeble" and □□□□□□ "child." The low-caste sweeper □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence (possibly Nītī) and is translated descriptively.
• The gandharva youth's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is translated by meaning as "Garland of Dharma." The prince's name □□□□□□ is likewise given in English as "Forbearance." In the list of Vipaśyin's epithets, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ stands where the stock list has "teacher of gods and humans, buddha, blessed one"; it is rendered as written, "the Teacher and King." □□□□, rendered "bane," means a calamity or misfortune.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "with one voice." □□ at the start of the sentence explaining the mountain's name is read as introducing the reason ("because"), not as "I." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "wool elephant," is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ "royal elephant." The mountain's name □□□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning, since the text itself explains it.
• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and the narrative follows the Chinese story of the deer-born girl and her five hundred sons. The text reads "set her upon a wool (bal) elephant," which makes no sense here; it is taken as a slip for "royal (rgyal) elephant," matching the royal elephant the king rode in the preceding passage. The phrase "Thinking that what was said of the queen must be true" interprets a terse clause that literally says "thinking the queen would come out true," that is, believing the charge that she was born of an animal.
• The clause rendered "even the gods will follow their lead" is terse in the Tibetan and its sense is somewhat uncertain. "I take no notice of it" renders a phrase that literally says "I have no awareness of it."
• The text says that "the girl herself" went in search of food; since the context shows it was the mother who went foraging while the girl guarded the orchard, this is read as referring to the mother. "Semblance period" renders the phrase "practicing the Dharma with a semblance (gzugs brnyan)," that is, the period of the semblance Dharma after a buddha's passing.
• The steward's reply literally reads "we are gza'," which makes no sense here; it is read as gzhi, "the residents" (the resident community, as against the visiting monks). "Leave it the dry and take the wet for themselves" renders a compressed idiom describing the parents' self-sacrifice in caring for an infant.
• The young monk is said to be learned in the "mātṛkā," here the Abhidharma matrices (the third basket, alongside the Sūtras and the Vinaya), not the class of goddesses. The old monk's name, Mahala, is given as written; it seems to be a transcription and is not further identified. The mountain is rendered Īśvara from the Tibetan "Lord's Mountain"; its identification is

uncertain.
• The princes' names, dge don and ngan don, are translated by meaning as "Good Purpose" and "Evil Purpose"; the parallel Chinese sūtra calls them "Good Friend" and "Bad Friend," and I could not identify a securely attested Sanskrit form. The king's name is given in transliteration as Mahārāja. "Nepalese elephants" renders bal gyi glang po che; bal could alternatively mean "wool," and the sense is uncertain.
• "Fowlers and fishermen" renders bya dang nya shor ba, literally "birds and fish lost/escaped"; the sense is taken from context as those who catch birds and fish.
• "The color of the waters" renders chu'i mdog literally; it may refer to dangerous discolored waters among the ocean's hazards.
• Several gem names in the description of the castle are uncertain: kekeru is kept as a gem name, and "agate" renders spug tentatively. "Crystal maidens" renders shel gyi bu mo literally.
• Lishibar renders the transcription li shi bar, which I cannot identify with a Sanskrit name; it is given in phonetic form. In the last sentence the Tibetan reads "Prince Lishibar" (rgyal bu), evidently a slip for "King" (rgyal po), as elsewhere in the passage.
• The instrument □□□ is rendered "lute"; it appears to be a stringed instrument (possibly reflecting the Chinese zheng, since this sūtra was translated from Chinese). The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "host and guest"; □□□ could alternatively be read as "spouse", but that sense does not fit the context. □□□□□□ is taken as "provisions, means of support."
• □□□□□□□□□□□ here is an ordinary verb phrase describing the king's joy, not the proper name used earlier, and is translated as such. The final sentence (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ... □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is somewhat compressed; it is read as King Lishibar complying with the message and staging the prince's return as if a messenger were announcing it.
• □□□□□□□ is read as "men and women alike" (as if □□□□□). In the prince's words to the people, □□□□□□□□ is used in its ordinary sense of hardship, not as the technical term for mental affliction. The last line gives the name of this section of the sūtra, not the title of the whole text.
• □□□□□ (literally "mist") in the list of the Buddha's chief disciples could not be identified with confidence and is translated literally as "Mist". The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Rājagṛha, the land of Vārāṇasī") is translated as it stands, though Rājagṛha and Vārāṇasī are normally distinct cities. The "mighty elephant" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the "fragrant elephant" (gandhahastin) of exceptional strength.
• □□□□□□□□□□ in the king's reflection is unclear; it is taken in the sense of "cherish one another," which the following clause supports. The name of the past buddha, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, could not be identified with a known Sanskrit name and is translated literally as "Rightly Teaching". The sentence about the Buddha's wounded toe shifts abruptly into the Buddha's own first-person speech, and is rendered as his words.
• □□□□□□ here is the old Tibetan word for "elephant" (literally "Nepalese ox"), not the place name Nepal; it is rendered "elephant" accordingly. The two fields of merit, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, are rendered "conditioned" and "unconditioned"; the text does not say which of the listed recipients belongs to which field. □□□□□□□ in Śāriputra's lament is an exclamation of grief here, rendered "ah me". The piece ends at the start of Śāriputra's speech, which continues in the next piece.
• The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be confidently identified with a Sanskrit form (the sūtra is translated from Chinese), so it is rendered by its meaning, "Great Radiance". □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the old Tibetan expression for "elephant", not a reference to Nepal. "The six observance days" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as the six monthly fast days. The king's reflection continues into the next piece.
• In the opening sentence, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read in context as "if I were to break that vow"; the wording is unusual. The tree god's act, □□□□□□□□□□□□□, is rendered "struck"; the exact sense of the expression is uncertain, but the result, the brahmin falling senseless, is

clear.
• □□□□□□□□□ is taken as Mount Gandha ("Fragrance"), fitting the sandalwood grove; the Tibetan spells it ga na dha. The emanated man's four-line verse is terse and its exact sense is uncertain: it seems to say that the "arrow" is drawn out not by strength but by much hearing of the Dharma; □□□□□□□□ is read as "cannot remove it". □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□ are the old Tibetan words for "elephant", not references to Nepal.
• The king is called □□□□□□□□ (Vaiḍūrya) in this text, which was translated from Chinese, where the king usually known in Sanskrit as Virūḍhaka is called "Lapis King"; the text's form is kept. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Kapilavastu, the Śākya homeland. In the trampling passage the text says □□□□□□□□□□□ ("the oxen's hooves") although the animals were elephants; it is rendered neutrally as "the beasts". □□□□□□□□□□□, "the god of the Śākyas", is an epithet of the Buddha.
• □□□□□□□ (twice) is read as □□□□□□□, "to contend, dispute," which the context plainly requires. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure as written; it is rendered by sense as the armor "falling loose," in line with the following sentence where the Śākyas leave the soldiers naked. □□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "as their life ebbs away." In the girls' praise, □□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "loving father and mother," not as the name Maitreya.
• The narration in this piece shifts between "we" and "they" for the Śākya daughters, as the Tibetan does; the shifts are kept. In this passage □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is not a name but Utpalavarṇā's "great rays of light," and □□ in □□□□□□□□□□□□ is the verb "to pluck, tear out" (her hair), not the place name Nepal. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "does not compare."
• The first part of this piece continues Utpalavarṇā's own story; from the Śākya daughters' attaining the Dharma eye, the narrative returns to the frame, and Gautamī then speaks, recounting her own request in the first person. The quotation marks reflect this reading. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as a list ("divine māras, those with evil views"); the comparison it introduces is somewhat abrupt in the Tibetan and is kept as it stands. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "open to," reading □□□□ as "opening, opportunity."
• The eight rules of respect (gurudharmas) are the special conditions under which Mahāprajāpatī Gautamī was admitted. The exchange beginning "Most excellent!" is spoken by Gautamī to Ānanda; the Tibetan does not mark the change of speaker. Here □□□□□□, "teacher," is applied to Ānanda, not to the Buddha. □□□□□□□□□□□ is used here as an ordinary phrase for joy, not as a name.
• □□□□□, glossed elsewhere as "feeling," is here the etymological gloss of "buddha" as "awareness, being awake" (rendering the Chinese jue), and is translated accordingly. The four "collections" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□) are identified as the four Āgamas, following the Chinese original from which this sūtra was translated. "The three close applications of mindfulness" are the Buddha's three special applications of mindfulness, by which he is unmoved by disciples who listen, do not listen, or are mixed.
• This Kangyur text is a translation of a Chinese scripture (the Sūtra on Skillful Means and Repaying the Buddha's Kindness), and this passage is a scholastic question-and-answer. The monk named by the Tibetan "Ribs" or "Flank" is taken as Pārśva, the Sarvāstivāda master, whose Sanskrit name means "side, flank." The reasoning about which knowledge is "shared" by the three vehicles and by the two vehicles is obscure in the Tibetan; it has been translated as it stands. "Falling back" renders phyir ldog pa, regression or retrogression.
• The "path of contemplation" renders bsam pa'i lam, which here corresponds to the path of cultivation (bhāvanāmārga) set against the path of seeing. "The ninefold defilement" renders dgu pa'i kun nas nyon mongs pa as written; the count is unclear beside the seventy-two of the higher realms. The monk "Ever Chewing," who chews the cud like an ox, is very likely Gavāṃpati, but the Tibetan name is not the standard rendering of that name, so it is translated literally. In the mirror example, sbrul 'tshong ma ("snake-seller") is taken as a slip for smad 'tshong ma, "a woman who sold herself, a prostitute." The question about "Thus have I heard"

refers to Ānanda's request to be taught what the Buddha had said in the twenty years before Ānanda became his attendant.

• "Manifest ritual" and "unmanifest ritual" render cho ga bstan pa and cho ga bstan pa med pa, which correspond to the Abhidharma pair of manifest and unmanifest action (vijñapti and avijñapti). In "he even set himself up against the Buddha," the verb sngo ba is unclear as written; the sense of rivalry or boasting is inferred from context. The sentence on Ajātaśatru's seven days in the Black Line hell is obscure in the Tibetan, and its comparison with heavy evil experienced among humans has been rendered as closely as the wording allows. The names "Kalandaka" and "city" in the gloss on place names are given as the Tibetan states them.

• "A wheel of speech" renders ngag gi 'khor lo literally; it appears to mean that the phrase "going for refuge" is a verbal formula whose real object is then specified. The faculty "of coming to know what was not known" and the faculty "of final knowledge" are the first two of the three undefiled faculties (anājñātamājñāsyāmīndriya and ājñendriya). "The ending of one's own body" renders bdag gi lus mthar phyin pa, apparently one's own final nirvāṇa as against that of others.

• De wi and Pa ri, given the three refuges before there was a Saṅgha, are taken as the two merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika; the Tibetan forms reflect the Chinese transcriptions of their names. "The formal act of a motion and three proclamations" renders zhu ba dang gsol ba bzhi'i las, the Vinaya procedure for full ordination. "The four supports" and "the four root offenses" render gnas bzhi and rtsa ba bzhi, the four niśrayas and the four pārājikas.

• "The formal act of a motion and proclamations, four in all" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the jñapticaturtha karman used for full ordination. "Probation that satisfies the Saṅgha" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (mānatva), and □□□□□□□□□ here is the penalty act of the saṅghāvaśeṣa procedure, not "annihilation". "Wrongs by nature" and "wrongs by prescription" render □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□ (prakṛtisāvadya and pratikṣepaṇasāvadya). The animal in the simile, □□□□□□, is uncertain; it is taken here as a bull elephant, as in the comparison of a drunkard to a maddened elephant, but it may mean an ox or bull.

• In the opening line the Tibetan spyan du rung ba is read as spyad du rung ba, "can be engaged in", as in the parallel phrase of the previous passage. "Manifest form" renders rnam par rig byed kyi gzugs, the Abhidharma vijñaptirūpa. The word rngub, "draught, sip", is taken as each measure of alcohol one refrains from drinking. The answer on the supreme discipline names meditative concentration first but then gives reasons for the prātimokṣa discipline's distinctiveness; it is translated as it stands.

• "Action" and "path of action" render las and las kyi lam (karman and karmapatha); "manifest form" renders rnam par rig byed kyi gzugs (vijñaptirūpa). The sentence on the first instant reads literally "is accompanied by the rite and is not without the rite either"; from the following sentence, the sense seems to be that the first instant has both aspects, the one tied to the rite and the one without it, while later instants have only the second. The "seven kinds" are presumably the seven assemblies of the Buddha's followers named at the start of the passage. The clause rendered "they are distinct" reads literally "is contradictory" and is taken as introducing the distinction drawn in what follows.

• "A small part," "a large part," and "the whole" render the three classes of layman, those of partial, greater, and complete practice. The sentence rendered "is not obtained in a twofold ranking" is obscure; the text goes on to give two ways of ranking the precepts, by sequence and by the quality of mind, and says they do not correspond. The place name ga bu sha is taken as Kapiśa, but the identification is uncertain.

• "The fast" renders phyem red, which is not a normal Tibetan word; it is taken here as a sound-spelling of a Chinese term for the fast of not eating after midday. The place name yog sha could not be identified and is given in phonetic form. The monk ig zhi is taken as Koṭikarṇa,

whose story of meeting hungry ghosts and being guided by Kātyāyana this passage recalls; the Tibetan form looks like a sound-spelling from Chinese.

• This sūtra is a translation from the Chinese (Da fangbian fo bao'en jing), which explains some phrasing. In Maudgalyāyana's thought the Tibetan reads "I" (□□□□) where "now" (□□□□) is plainly meant; translated as "now". In Śakra's speech the subject "as for me" is supplied from context for the elliptical "sport and delight" (□□□□□□□□□□). The "pleasure grove of Supreme Delight" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is probably the Nandana grove, but is translated literally. "Noble ones would dwell in assembly" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure; the Chinese parallel has the Buddha predicting that Piṇḍola would dwell in Godānīya, which may lie behind it. In the sentence on later buddhas the Tibetan as transmitted lacks a negative (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), but both the conclusion ("not equal") and the Kāśyapa example (□□□□□□□) require "do not obtain"; translated accordingly as an evident omission. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ here means "caused to pass into nirvāṇa," not mantra recitation. The precepts are said to be obtained "from" (□□) beings, i.e. with respect to them, rendered "with respect to".

• "Appropriated and not appropriated" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is the Abhidharma pair upātta and anupātta, matter bound up with consciousness and matter that is not, here parallel to sentient and non-sentient. The sentence "All the buddhas of the three times are equal..." is somewhat garbled in the Tibetan (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and is rendered by its evident sense. The "Dharma body of five parts" is the fivefold dharmakāya: moral discipline, concentration, wisdom, liberation, and the knowledge and vision of liberation. The second "I am a butcher" is spelled □□□□, a variant of □□□□□. "Moral discipline" for non-restraint (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, asaṃvara) is rendered "discipline" since it is a binding commitment to harmful livelihood, not ethical conduct. The chapter-opening sentence on bodhisattvas teaching and correcting at the right time is terse and rendered literally.

• "The man who was to carry back the report" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) is taken as the scout sent by the bandit chief; the Tibetan does not state explicitly whether he is the same person as the friend who gave the warning. □□□□□□□□□□ is the idiom "to disregard, to make light of." In the final sentence □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("to bring good fortune") most naturally attaches to Śakra's offering, though the clause order leaves its scope slightly open.

• "Kauśika" (□□□□□□□) is Śakra's clan name. In the list of eight things not to be heeded, the Tibetan gives gain (□□□□□□) and profit (□□) as separate items, and the list is translated as it stands rather than as the usual eight worldly concerns. "Floggings" renders □□□□□□□□, literally "beating with a bow," evidently meaning corporal punishment.

• The lion's name □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered by its meaning, "Firm Vow" (Chinese parallel: Jianshi, "firm vow"); no Sanskrit form is confidently attested. The mountain □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is likewise translated literally as "Noble Sage Mountain." In the hunter's words at home, the Tibetan places the shaving of hair and beard within his speech and the donning of the robe in the narrative; the division is followed as written.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□ is the idiom "without doubt", not the graha spirit of the glossary entry. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; rendered as crawling along the ground. The number of diseases is given as written, □□□□□□□□□□ "one hundred and four", though the usual figure in this tradition is four hundred and four. The Buddha addresses Ānanda but uses the plural "sons of noble family", as the Tibetan has it. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the medicine section is taken in its literal sense, "bring across to the far shore", rather than as "perfection".

• In this passage □□□□□□ is the quality loving-kindness, not the name Maitreya. The text speaks of "four factors" for patience, diligence and concentration but does not number them off explicitly; the translation follows the Tibetan without supplying a count. In the section on concentration the text moves between □□□□□□□□□□ (meditative absorption) and □□□□□□□ (meditative concentration), and both renderings are kept as written.

• The paired terms □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "common birth" and "uncommon birth", are unusual and probably reflect the Chinese source of this sūtra; their exact intended sense is uncertain. In the proclamation, □□□□□□□□□□□ (literally "last of mornings") is taken as the familiar "this is my last birth"; □□□ may be a slip for a word meaning "birth" or "existence". □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the fleshy protuberance on the crown (uṣṇīṣa), the mark expected at this point in the list. The list gives exactly thirty-two marks, in its own order, and the eyes (not the eyelashes) are compared to the king of bulls, as written. In this passage □□□□□□ is the quality loving-kindness, not Maitreya, and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is "great rays of light", not the name Great Radiance.
• In this passage □□□□□□ is the quality loving-kindness, not Maitreya. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("loving-kindness in the desire realm") is translated as written; its precise intent, perhaps loving-kindness directed toward beings of the desire realm, is unclear. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read with □□□ "broad" for □□, matching the mark of a broad body. The final sentence (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is taken to mean that a mark does not have only one fixed cause.
• The "second", "third" and "fourth" marks are referred to by number only, apparently by their place in the list given earlier in the sūtra. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "acts with careful consideration"; if □□□□ stands for □□□□, it would mean "acts steadfastly". The phrases "practices and abides in the characteristics" and "the thirteenth stage of conduct" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) follow the Tibetan; the latter probably refers to a scheme of thirteen stages of bodhisattva practice, the last being buddhahood. The bodhisattva names □□□□□□ and □□□□□□□ are given as Siṃha and Vajra. In this passage □□□□□□ is the quality loving-kindness, not Maitreya.
• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and several bodhisattva names in this list cannot be matched with confidence to Indian forms. "Moonlight Son" (zla 'od bu) is a literal rendering, and "Śramaṇa" stands for dge sbyong, read as a name. Jñānaketu, Dharmaketu, Sūryaprabha, Candraprabha and Akṣayamati are the standard equivalents.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.